HOOVER INSTITUTION | Stanford University

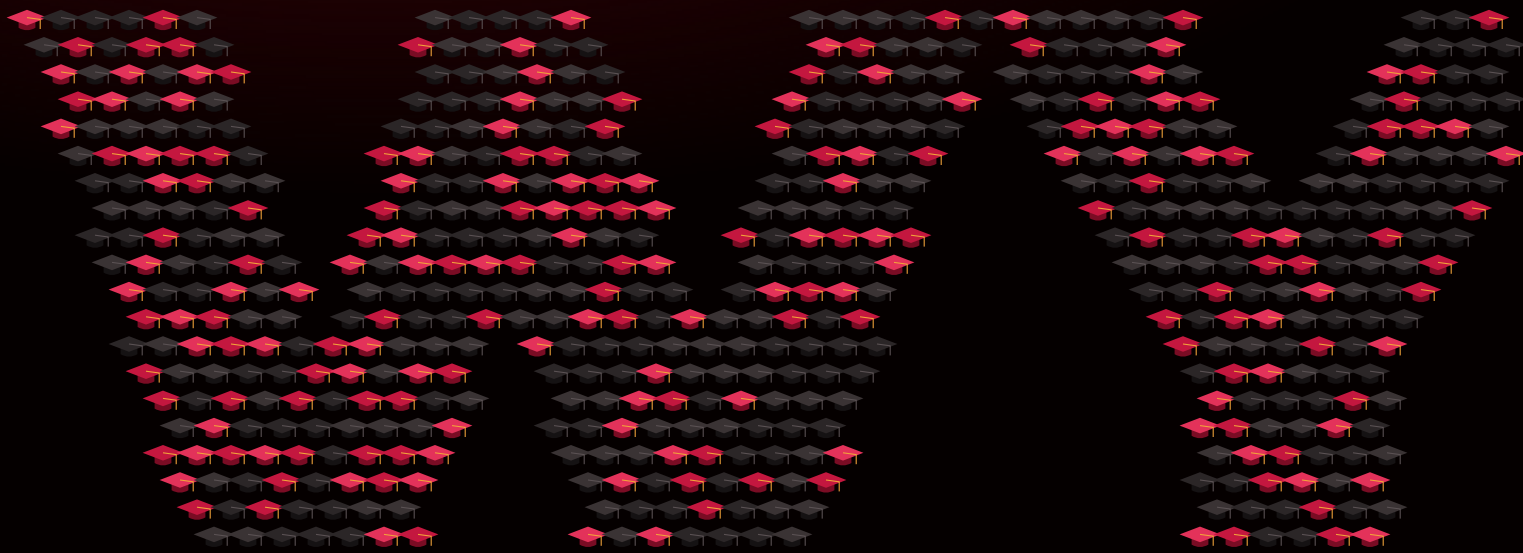
HAI Stanford University Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence

NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Wyoming Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **37 in every 100**, mark the international share of Wyoming's STEM master's degrees.



This page intentionally left blank.

HOOVER INSTITUTION | Stanford University

Stanford University
Human-Centered
Artificial Intelligence

The 2026 Wyoming Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

Table of Contents

OVERVIEW

At a Glance 6

SECTIONS

Section 1 International Dependence 8
Section 2 STEM Degrees 18
Section 3 Where Students Come From 24
Section 4 K-12 Preparation 32
Section 5 Graduate Research 34
Section 6 Do Graduates Stay? 36
Section 7 Research Funding 38
Section 8 H-1B Jobs and Green Cards 40
Section 9 STEM Workforce 44
Section 10 Patents 46
Section 11 Competitors 48
Section 12 Fields of Study 50
Section 13 Students and Money 60
Section 14 Student Outcomes 68
Section 15 Faculty 72
Section 16 Institutions 76

BACK MATTER

About these Data 80
By the Numbers 82
Sources 91

Authors

Emerson Victoria Johnston is a research assistant with the Hoover Institution's Technology Policy Accelerator. A Knight-Hennessy Scholar, she holds a master's in international policy from Stanford University, and is on leave from its master's program in the history of science, technology, environment, and medicine.

Dr. Amy Zegart is the Morris Arnold and Nona Jean Cox Senior Fellow at the Hoover Institution, director of Hoover's Technology Policy Accelerator, and a senior fellow and associate director at Stanford University's Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence.

Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Wyoming: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

How to Cite this Profile

Emerson V. Johnston and Amy Zegart, “The 2026 Wyoming Talent Profile,” Technology Policy Accelerator, Hoover Institution, and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence, Stanford University, Stanford, CA, November 2026.

Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from federal sources: the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, as the backbone, together with NAEP, NSF's surveys of graduate students, doctorates and research funding, USAspending.gov, DHS and ICE SEVIS data, the Department of Labor, USCIS, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, and USPTO PatentsView. Each figure names its source, and the Sources page lists all of them. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Wyoming Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Wyoming's numbers say

1. **International students earn 37% of Wyoming's STEM master's degrees,** 14.7 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 33rd of 51 on dependence. The share is 37% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 1.9% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Wyoming awarded 37 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.0% of the U.S. total and 48th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed +23%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **Among states of similar size,** Wyoming ranks 1st of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Wyoming 37%, Vermont 9.6%, Alaska 16%, Montana 18%, North Dakota 36%.
4. **65% of Wyoming's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 3.6% came from abroad. More students arrived from other states (1.54K) than residents left (1.28K), a net gain of 261; the top destination for those leaving was Utah.

37%

of the STEM master's degrees Wyoming awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

31.1K #50
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · −9.1% since 2015

37 #48
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K**

37% #33
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · +4.0 pp since 2015

16% #18
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · −0.1 pp since 2015

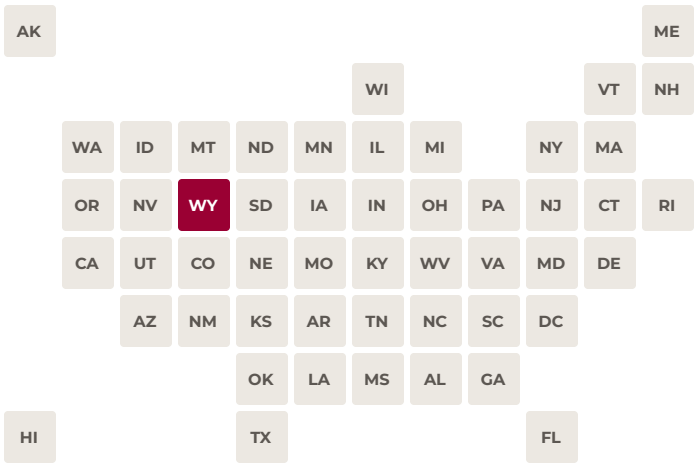
22% #33
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · −1.3 pp since 2015

59% #34
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +3.4 pp since 2015

$21.3K #4
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · −6.7% since 2015

65% #36
First-time students from in state, 2024
−3.4 pp since 2016

$85.4K #38
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −11% since 2016



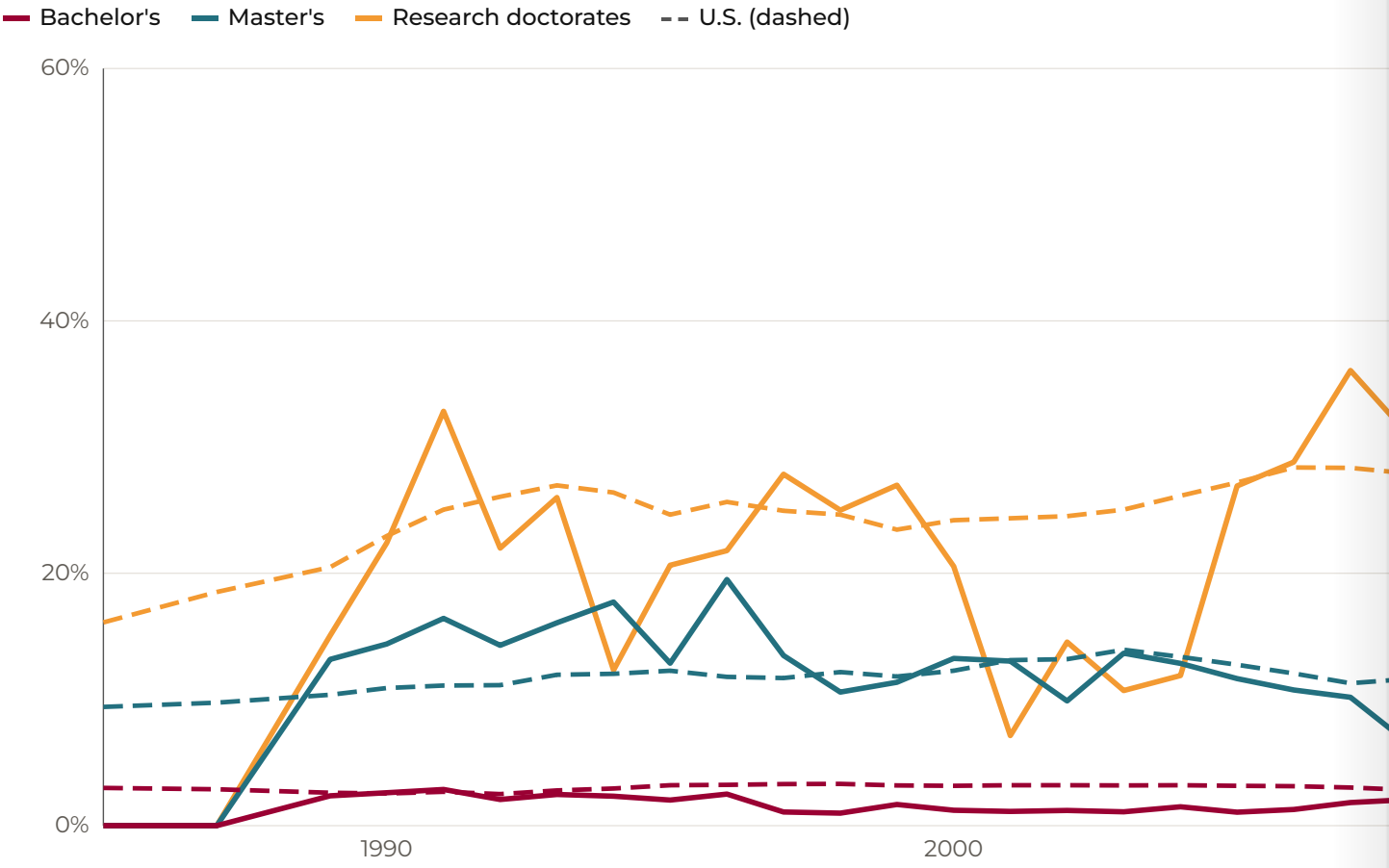
Badges give Wyoming's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

Wyoming ranks 18th of 51 on the international share of graduate enrollment, at 16% in 2024 against 17% for the U.S.

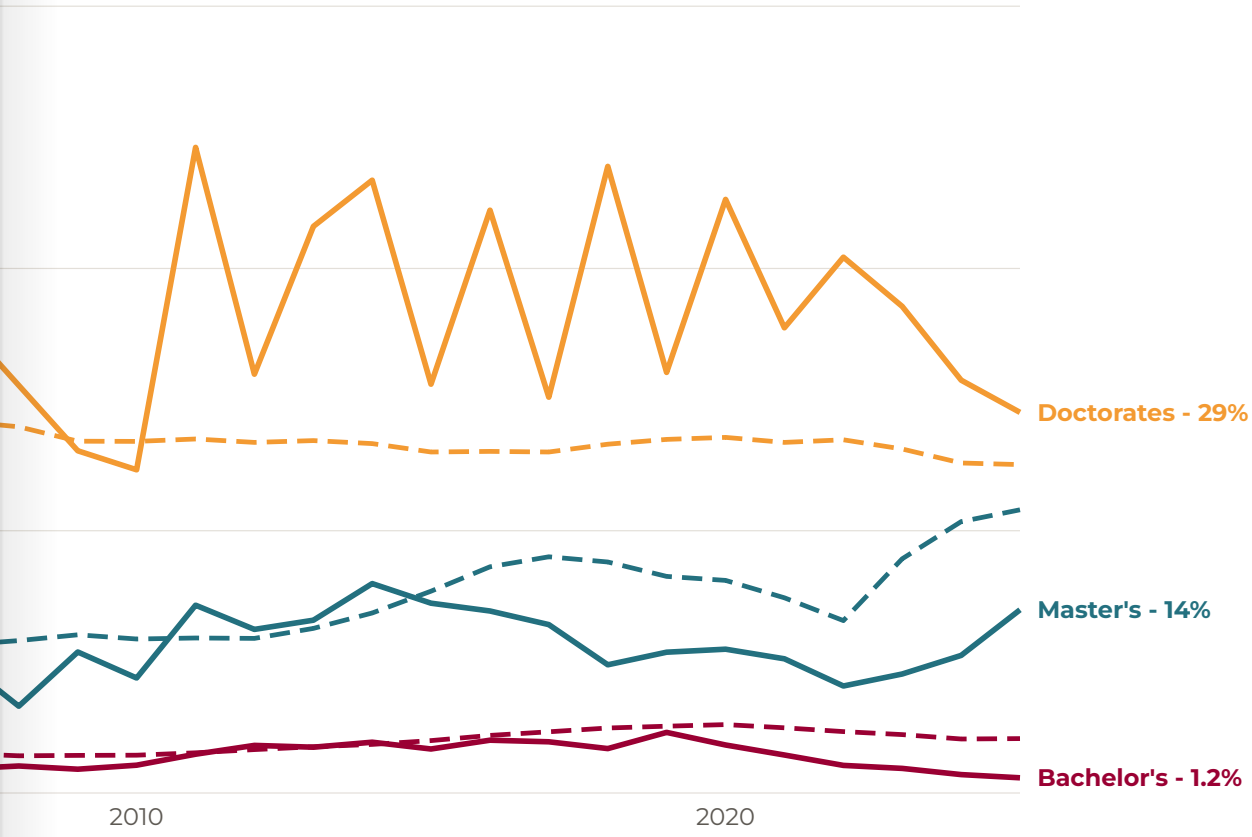
Figure 1 What Share of Wyoming's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025

International students make up 16% of Wyoming's graduate enrollment and 1.7% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 1.2% of bachelor's, 14% of master's and 29% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 1.9% of STEM bachelor's, 37% of STEM master's and 37% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.0% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 48th of 51.



5.

16%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **18th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2015

14%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

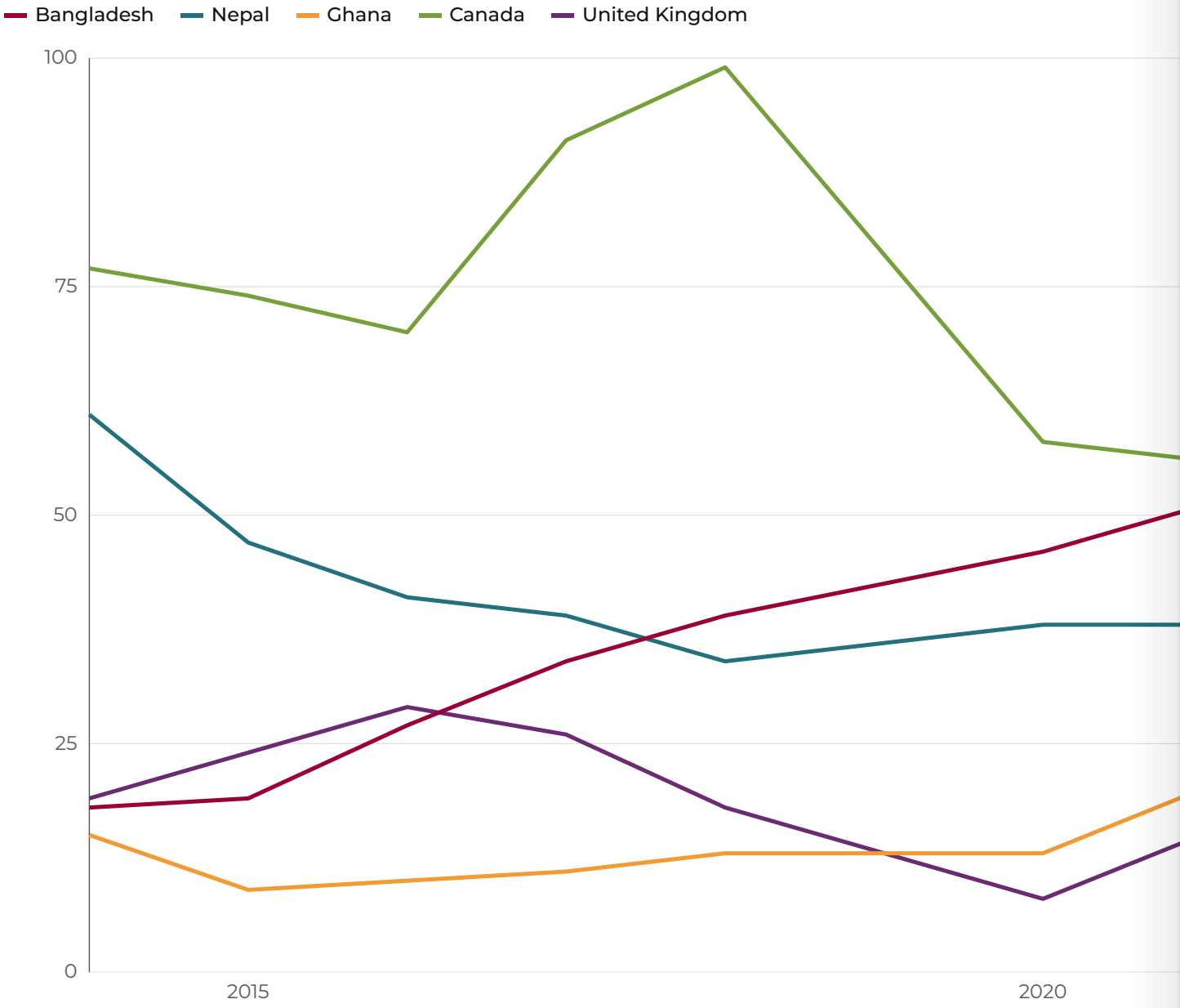
U.S. **22%** · **27th** of 51 · −0.5 pp since 2015

37%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **33rd** of 51 · +4.0 pp since 2015

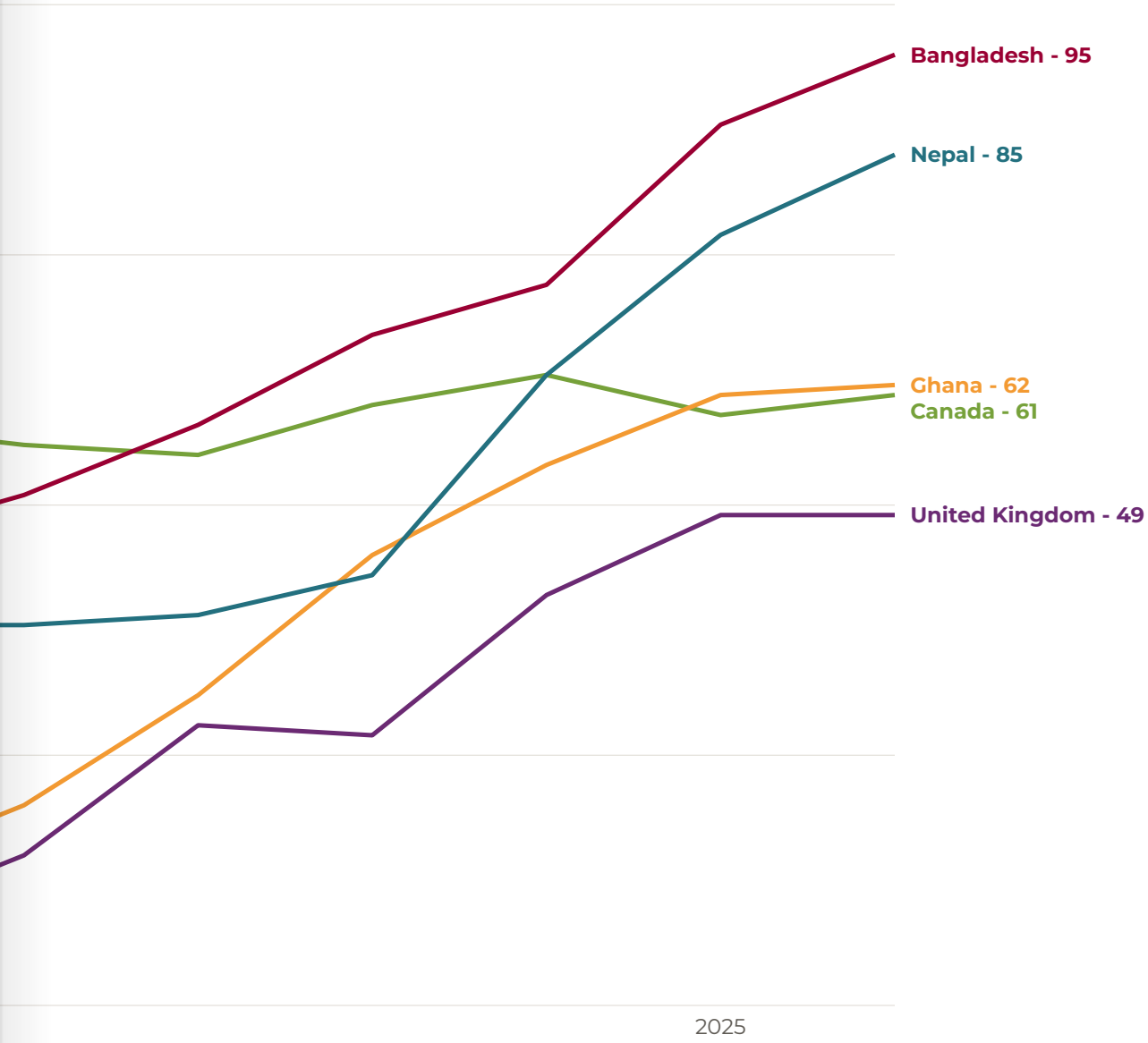
Figure 2 Where Do Wyoming's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the mor

In October 2026, Wyoming had 964 active international students in SEVIS, 49th of 51. Bangladesh accounted for 9.9% of them and Nepal for 8.8%, against 2.3% and 2.9% nationally.

Students came from 96 countries, but the two largest supplied 19%. The state's total is down 8% since 2015, when it stood at 1.05K.



nth closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

964

Active international students, October 2026

49th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

9.9%

From Bangladesh

U.S. **2.3%**

62%

In STEM fields

U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

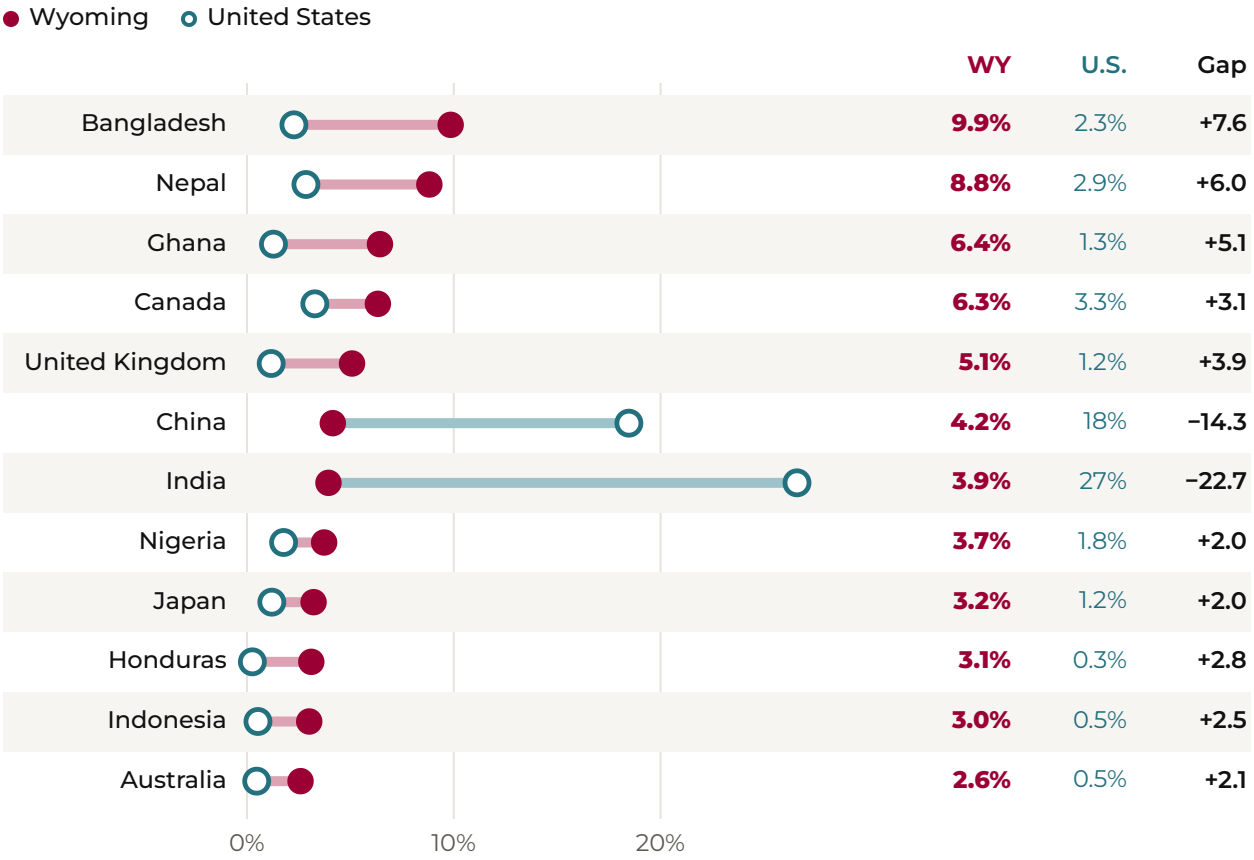
How Does Wyoming's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, Wyoming had **964** active F-1 and M-1 students, 49th among the 50 states and DC and **0.1%** of the U.S. total. They came from 96 countries.

Bangladesh supplied **9.9%** of them, against 2.3% nationally, and Nepal **8.8%**, against 2.9%. Ghana (6.4%), Canada (6.3%), and the United Kingdom (5.1%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **19%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 49th among the states, against 27% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is Wyoming's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

964
Active international students, October 2026
49th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

9.9%
From Bangladesh
U.S. **2.3%**

8.8%
From Nepal
U.S. **2.9%**

96
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is down 1.0% from 2025 and down 7.8% since 2015, when it stood at 1.05K. Its share of all U.S. international students is unchanged since 2015, at **0.1%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from Bangladesh went from 19 to 95, Nepal's from 47 to 85, and Ghana's from 9 to 62.

Over the same years, the number from Canada went from 74 to 61 and the United Kingdom's from 24 to 49. The table gives each country's count for the first, previous and latest years.

Table 1 International Students in Wyoming, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	1.05K	974	**964**	−7.8%	1.19M	49th
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.1%	0.1%	**0.1%**	0.0 pp	–	49th
Countries of citizenship represented	106	97	**96**	−9.4%	219	49th
Share from the two largest countries of origin	27%	17%	**19%**	−8.5 pp	45%	49th
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
Bangladesh	19	88	**95**	–	2.3%	9.9%
Nepal	47	77	**85**	–	2.9%	8.8%
Ghana	9	61	**62**	–	1.3%	6.4%
Canada	74	59	**61**	−18%	3.3%	6.3%
United Kingdom	24	49	**49**	–	1.2%	5.1%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

Figure 4

Which Countries Supply Wyoming's International STEM Students?

594 of Wyoming's international students were in STEM fields in October 2026, **62%** of the total against 63% nationally, down 8.0% since 2015.

Doctoral students were the largest group, **289**. Bangladesh supplied 19% of them and Ghana 12%.

STEM doctoral students went from 257 in 2015 to **289**, and STEM master's students from 86 to 176.

594

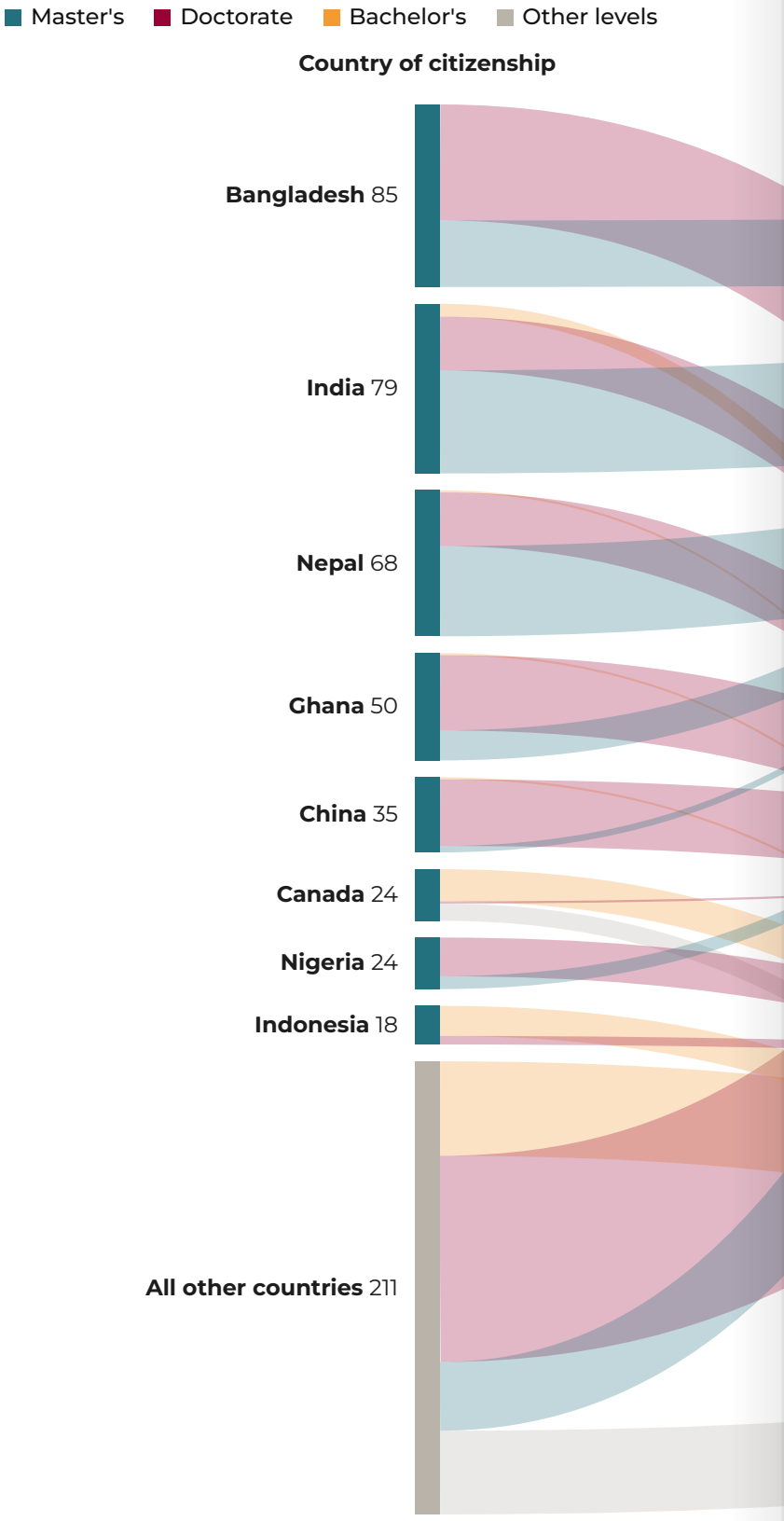
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students, 2026
U.S. **749K** · **49th** of 51 · −8.0% since 2015

62%

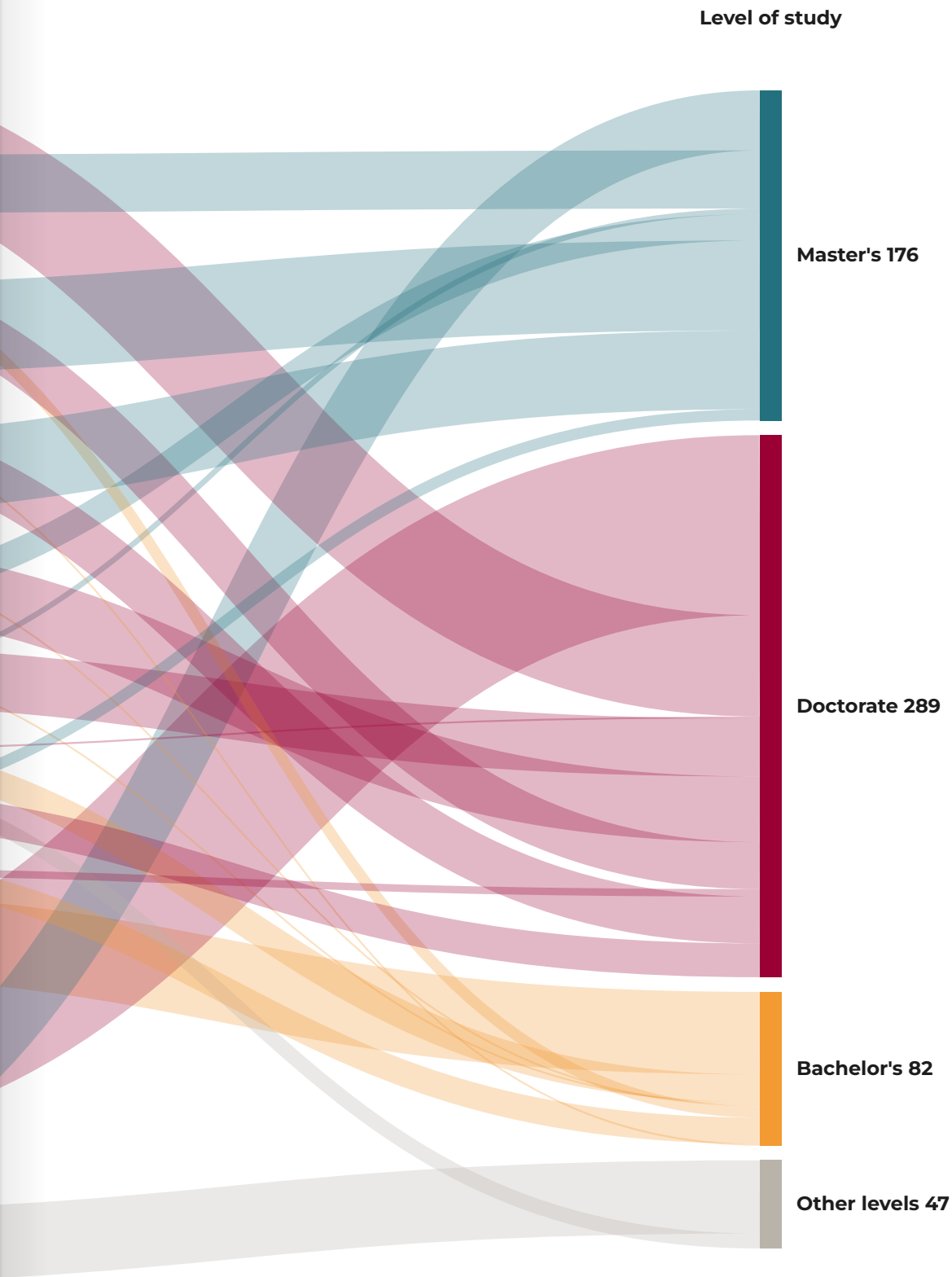
Share in STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

176

Active STEM master's students, 2026
U.S. **393K** · **48th** of 51 · 2.05× since 2015



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship an
basis as its all-student pages, so the STEM count here exceeds the all-



d level of study, October 2026; the eight largest countries are shown. DHS does not draw its STEM pages on the same evel count for India (79 against 38). Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are Wyoming's Master's Fields?

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Wyoming first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

International share of STEM bachelor's. The share was 1.9% in 2025, against 6.6% for the U.S., 48th among the states, down 0.5 points from 2.4% in 2024 and down 6.7 points since 2015, when it was 8.6%.

Table 2 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	8.1% / 8.6%	**– / 65%**	– / 56%
Engineering	1.4% / 7.2%	**59% / 49%**	– / 55%
Engineering technology	– / 4.5%	**– / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	– / 17%	**– / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	2.2% / 6.0%	**41% / 33%**	– / 38%
Biological sciences	0.7% / 3.4%	**– / 23%**	23% / 23%
Natural resources	0.0% / 2.0%	**– / 17%**	– / 27%
Architecture	– / 7.3%	**– / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in Wyoming / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

14%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **27th** of 51

37%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **33rd** of 51

59%
Int. share of engineering & eng. technology master's, 2025
U.S. **50%** · **8th** of 50

International share of STEM master's. The share was 37% in 2025, against 52% for the U.S., 33rd among the states, up 10.5 points from 27% in 2024 and up 4.0 points since 2015, when it was 33%.

International share of STEM research doctorates. The share was 37% in 2025, against 43% for the U.S., 36th among the states, down 13.0 points from 50% in 2024 and down 2.5 points since 2015, when it was 40%.

Table 3 Wyoming at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
International share of all master's	14%	10% 2024	**14% 2025**	−0.5 pp	22%	27th
International share of STEM master's	33%	27% 2024	**37% 2025**	+4.0 pp	52%	33rd
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	34%	42% 2024	**59% 2025**	+25.1 pp	50%	8th

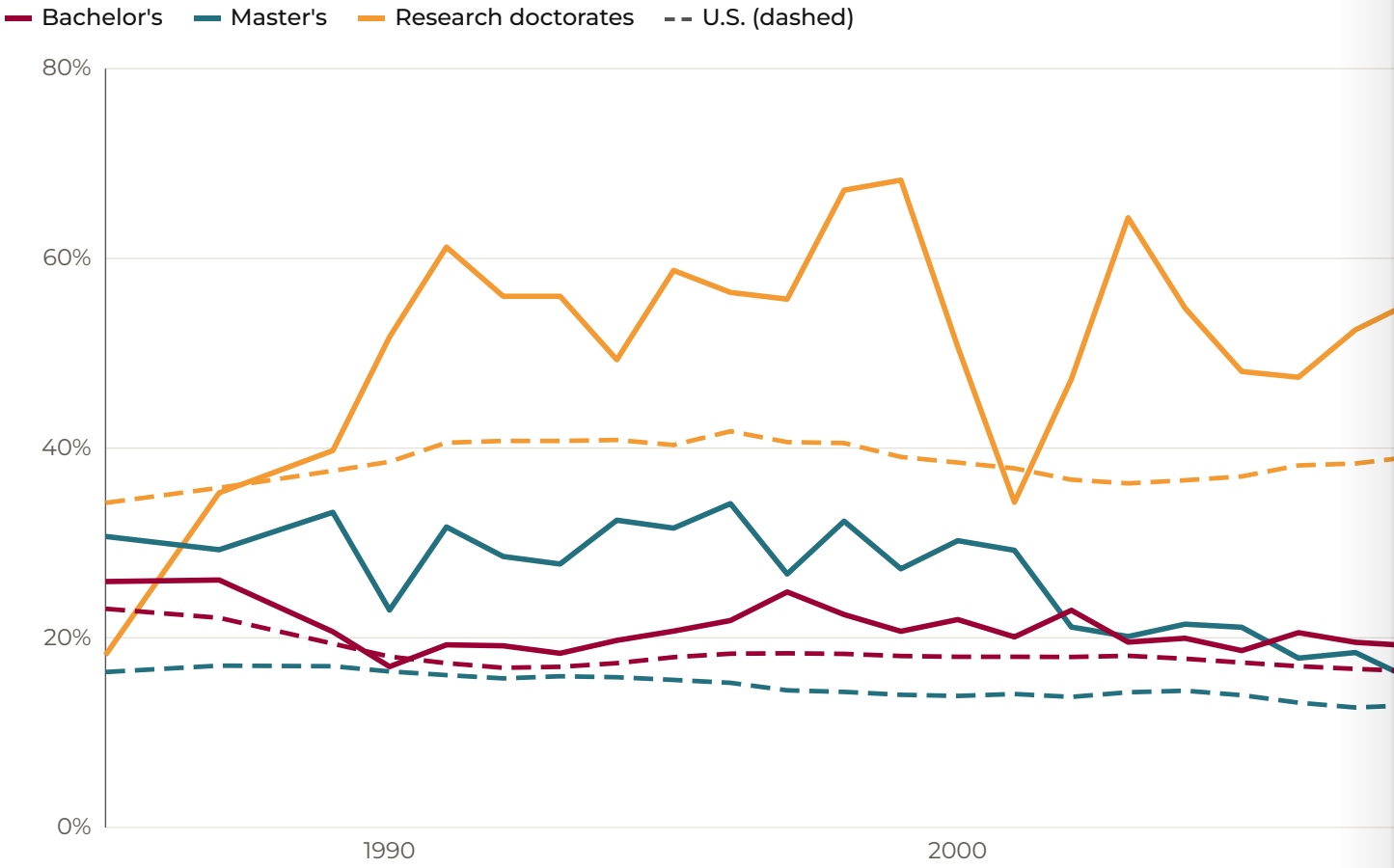
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

Wyoming ranks 3rd of 51 on the STEM share of research doctorates, at 58% in 2025 against 39% for the U.S.

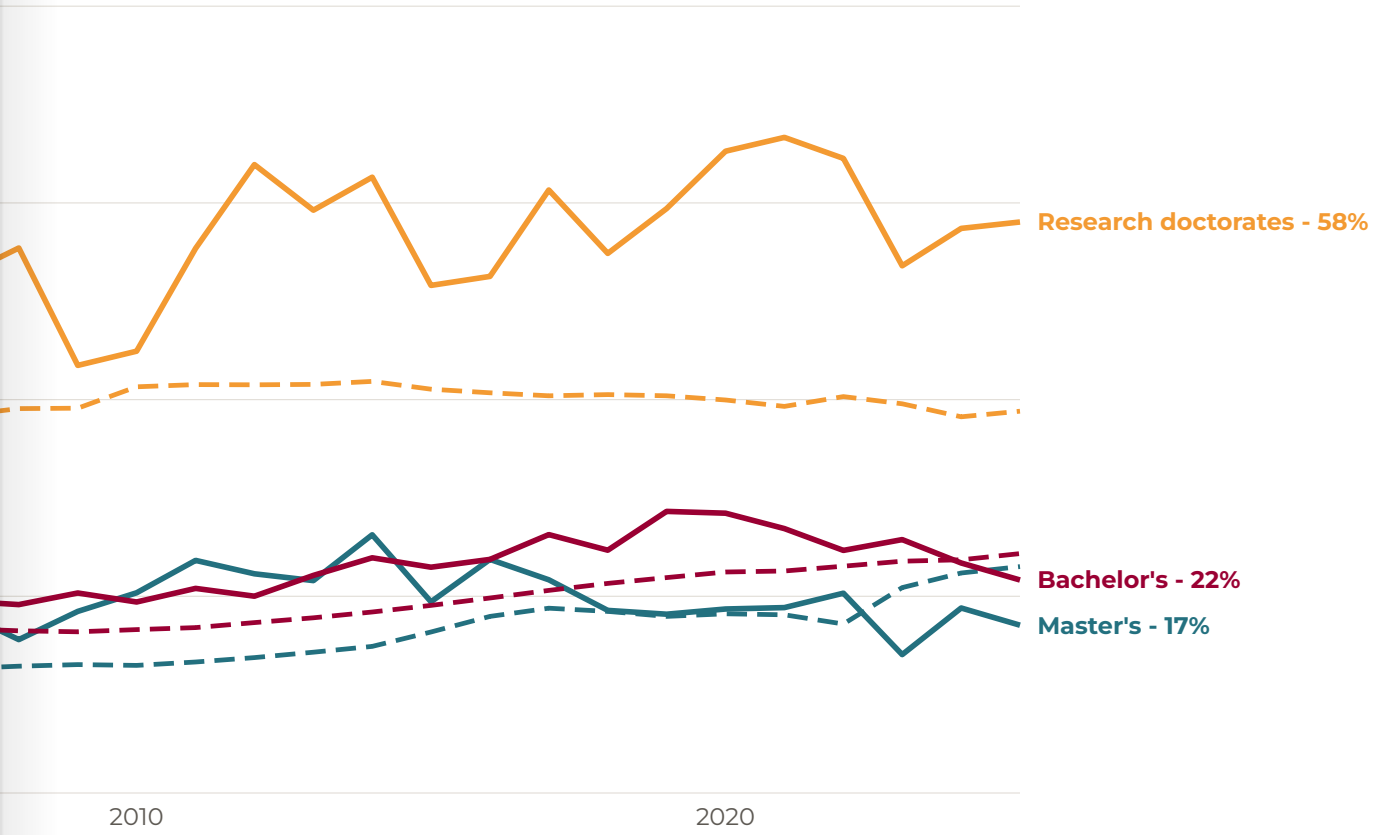
Figure 5 How Much of Wyoming's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 22% of Wyoming's bachelor's degrees, 17% of its master's and 58% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is down 2.4 points since 2015, and the state ranks 34th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 33rd of 51.



22%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **33rd** of 51 · −1.3 pp since 2015

17%

STEM share of master's, 2025

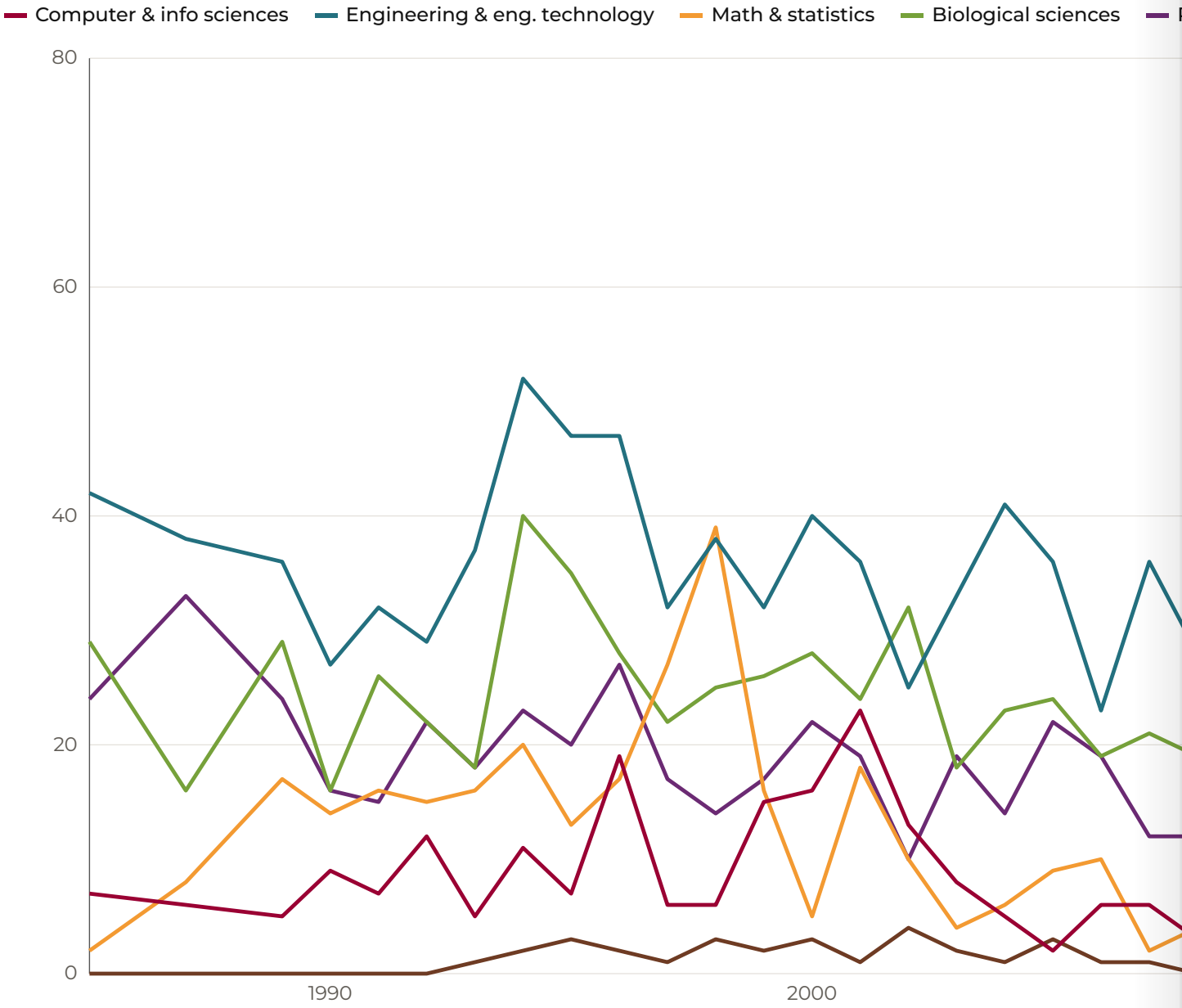
U.S. **23%** · **34th** of 51 · −2.4 pp since 2015

58%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **3rd** of 51 · +6.5 pp since 2015

Figure 6 Which STEM Fields Produce Wyoming's Master's Degrees?

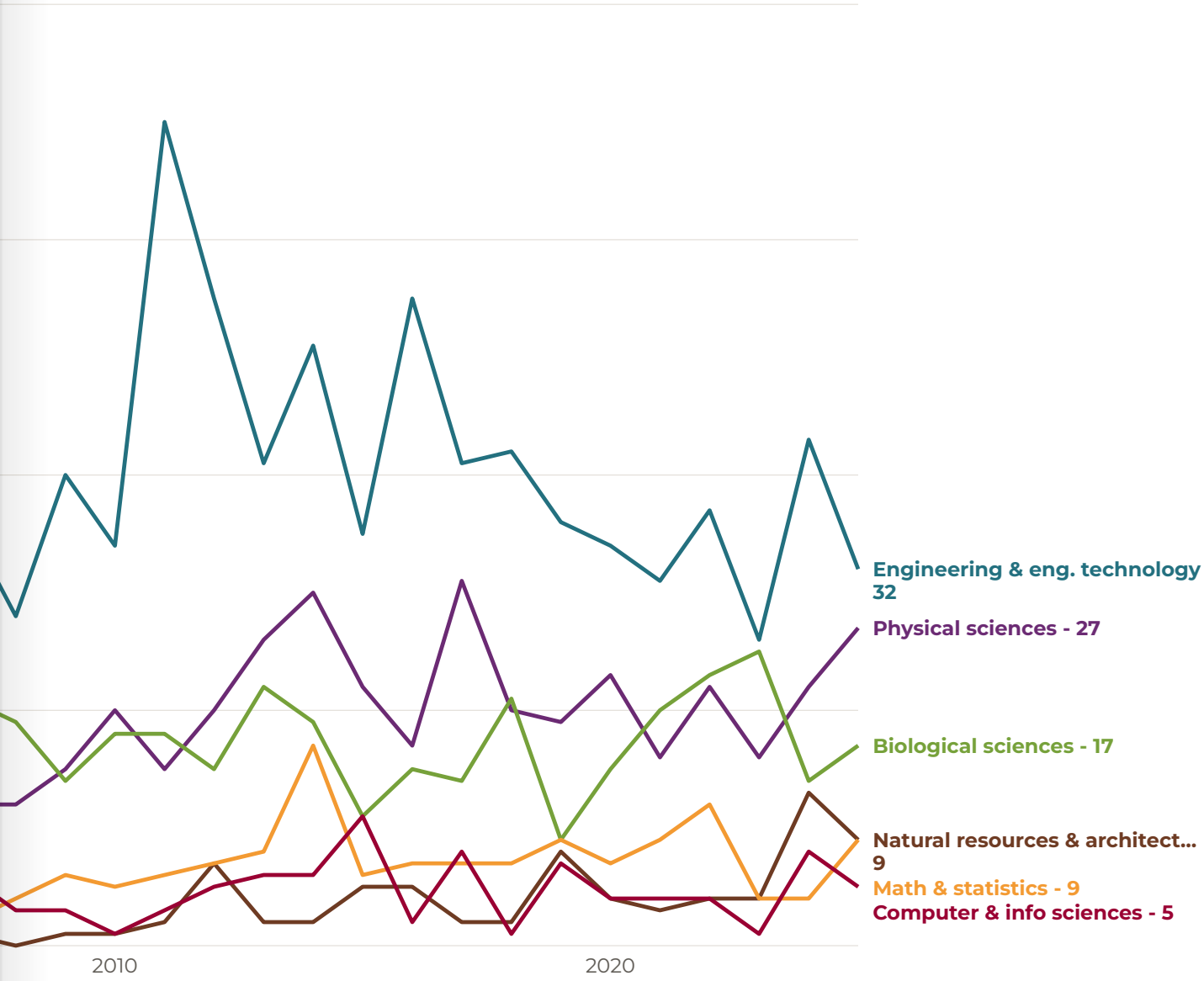


STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Engineering & eng. technology produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 32, followed by physical sciences (27) and biological sciences (17). Master's degrees in engineering & eng. technology are down 9% since 2015.

International students earned 37 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.0% of the national total (48th of 51).

Physical sciences — Natural resources & architecture



37

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **48th** of 51

0.0%

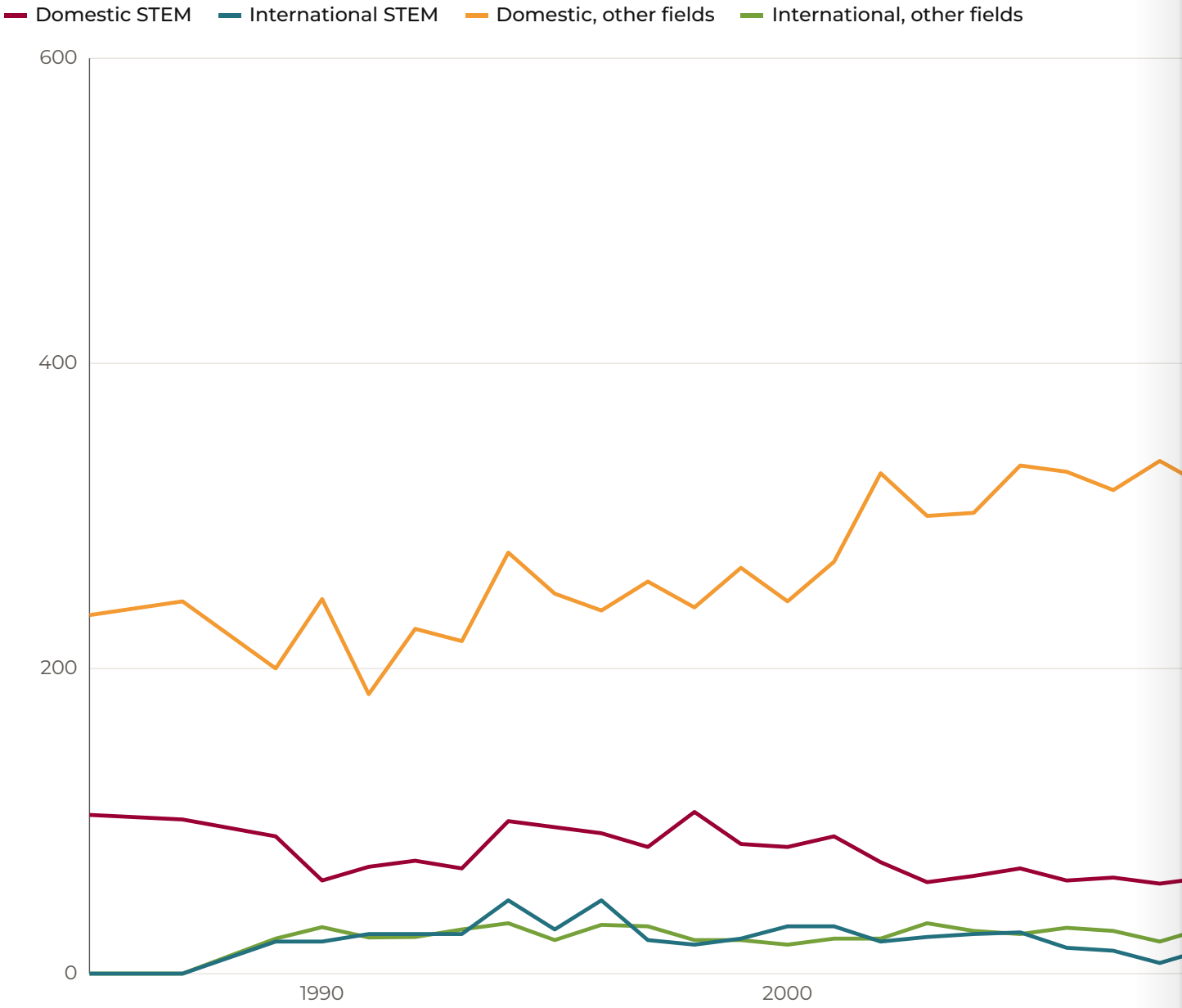
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

48th of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

–

Int. share of CS master's, null

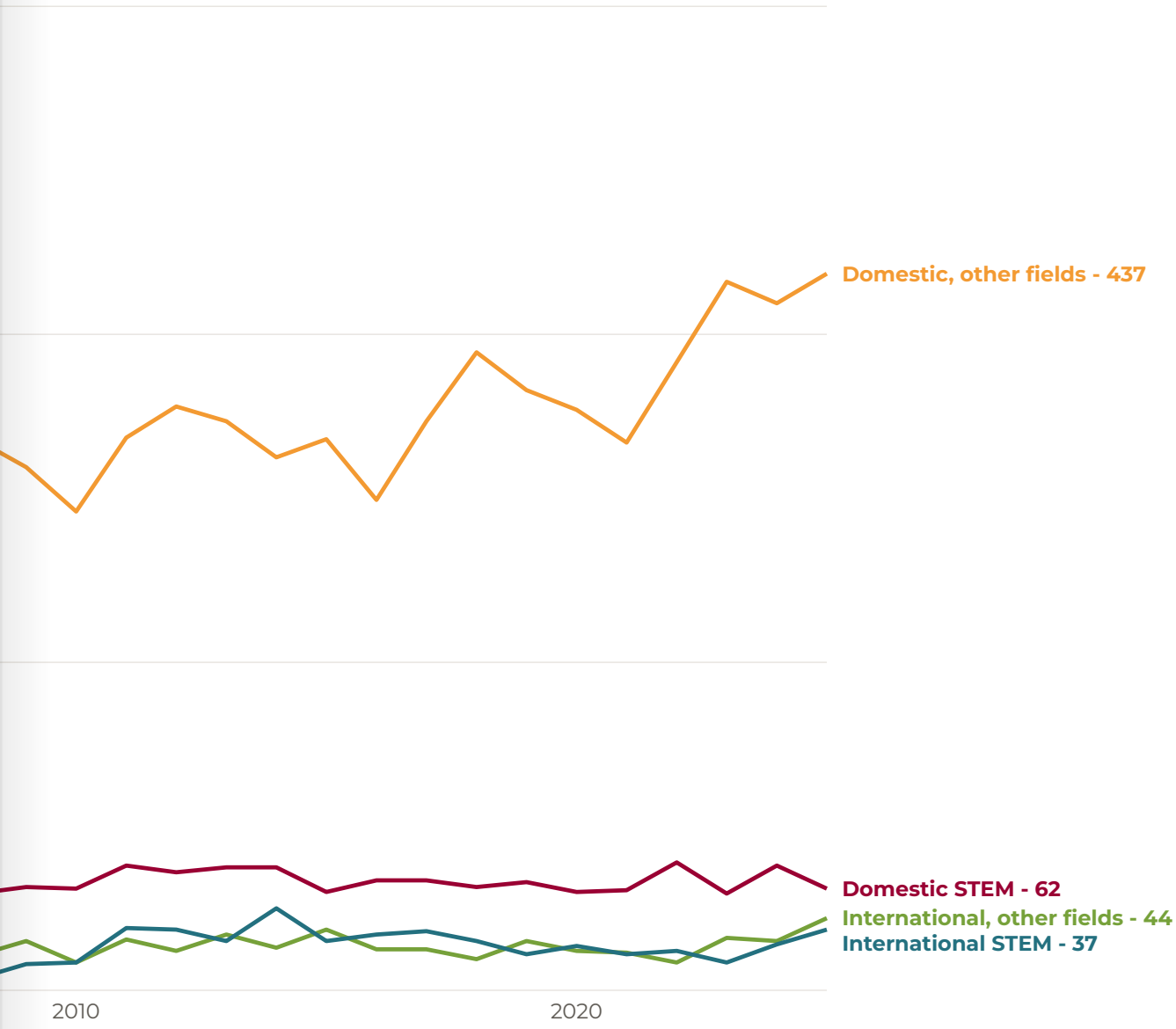
Figure 7 Who Earns Wyoming's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 7 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 2 more to domestic students.

International students earn 37% of Wyoming's STEM master's but 9.1% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).



14%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **27th** of 51 · −0.5 pp since 2015

37%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **33rd** of 51 · +4.0 pp since 2015

1.8

STEM master's per STEM research doctorate (IPEDS), 2025

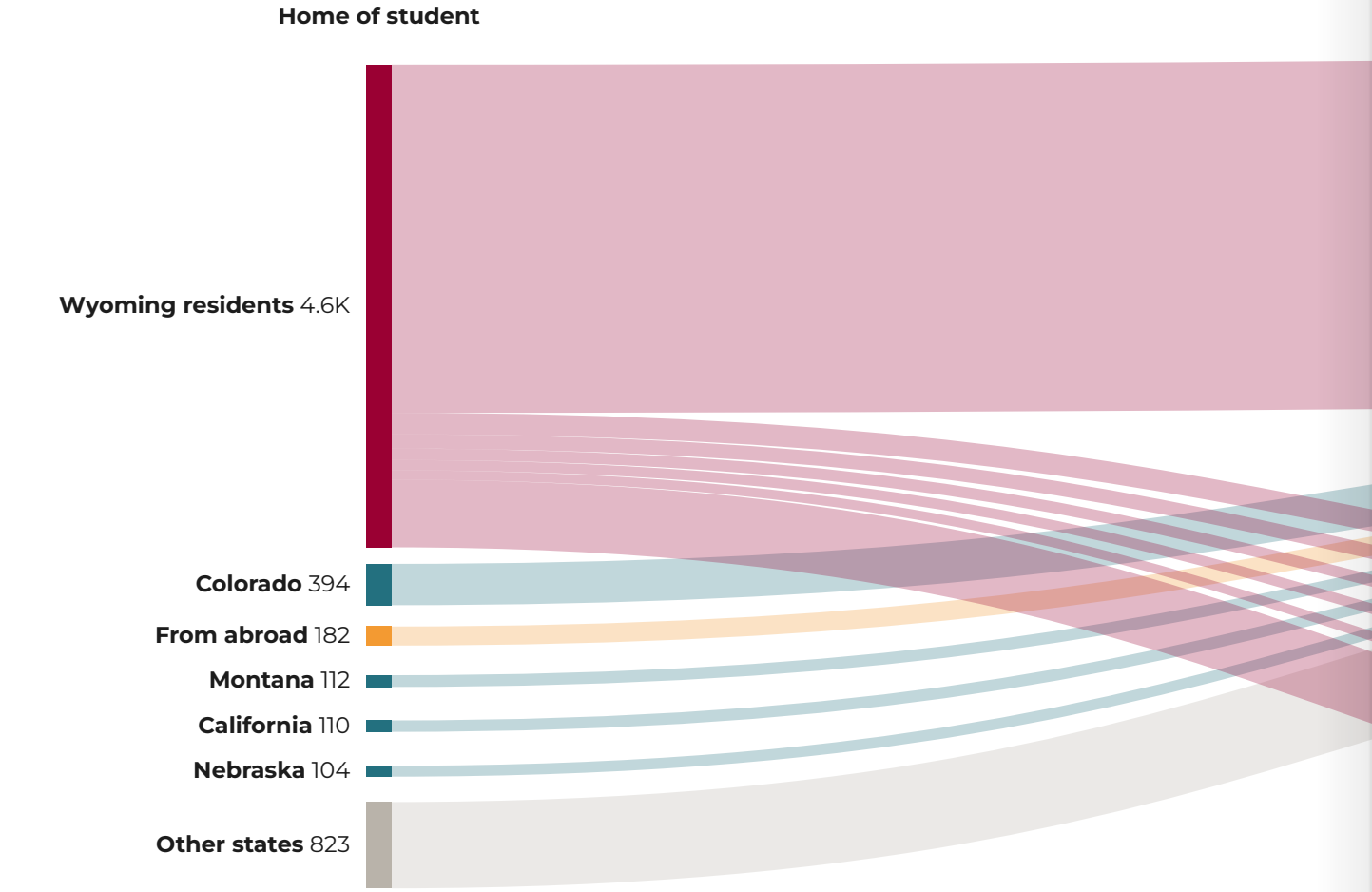
U.S. **6.4** · **51st** of 51 · 0.0 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

Wyoming ranks 14th of 51 on the share of first-time students whose home is outside the US, at 3.6% in 2024 against 3.1% for the U.S.

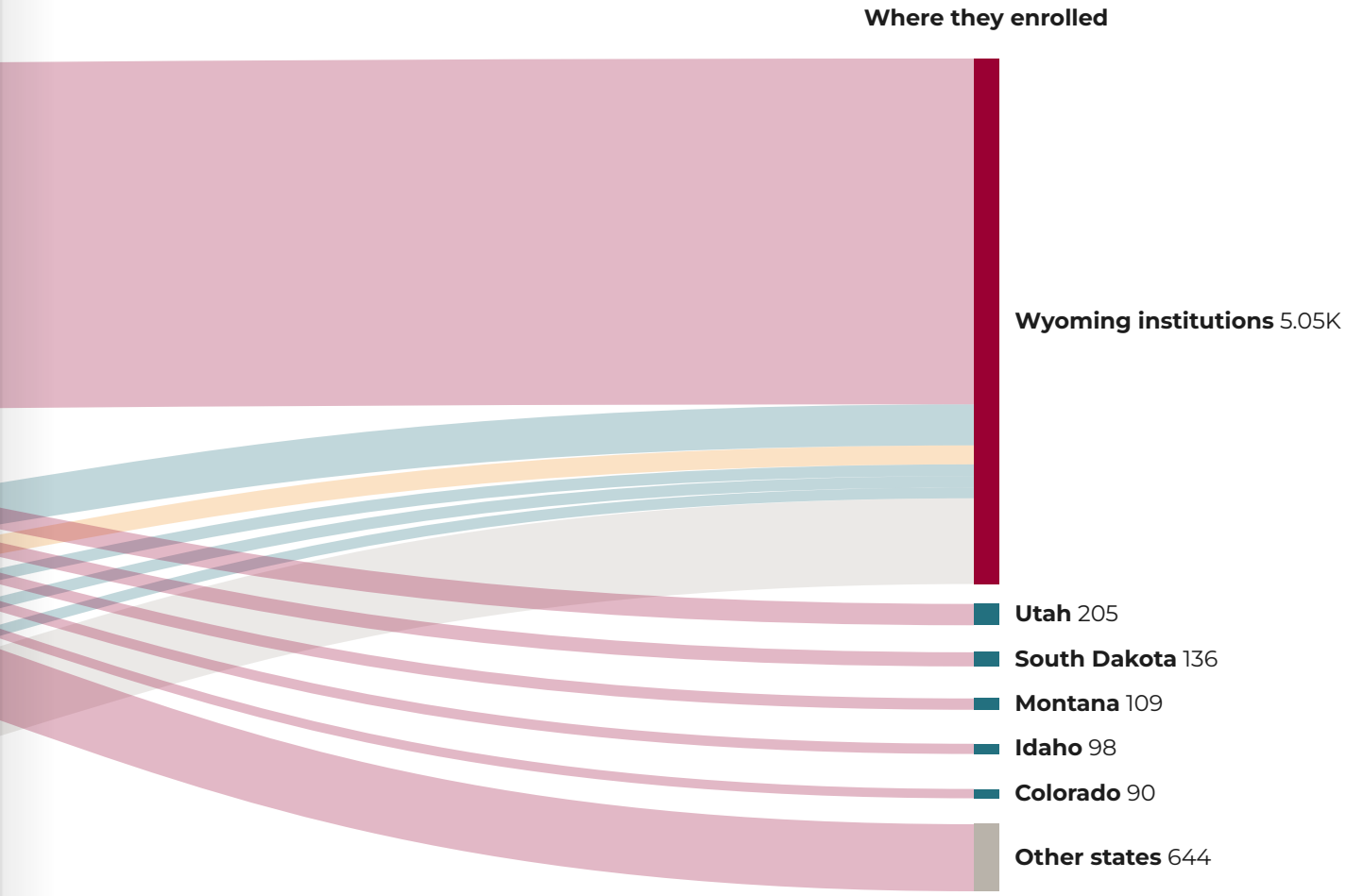
Figure 8 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest s
Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

3.32K residents stayed in Wyoming for college in fall 2024; 1.54K students arrived from other states and 182 from abroad, while 1.28K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 65% of the state's first-time students are residents.



ources and destinations (more when states tie at the printed figure), the rest grouped; ties are ordered by exact count.

65%

First-time students from in state, 2024

36th of 51 · −3.4 pp since 2016

3.6%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

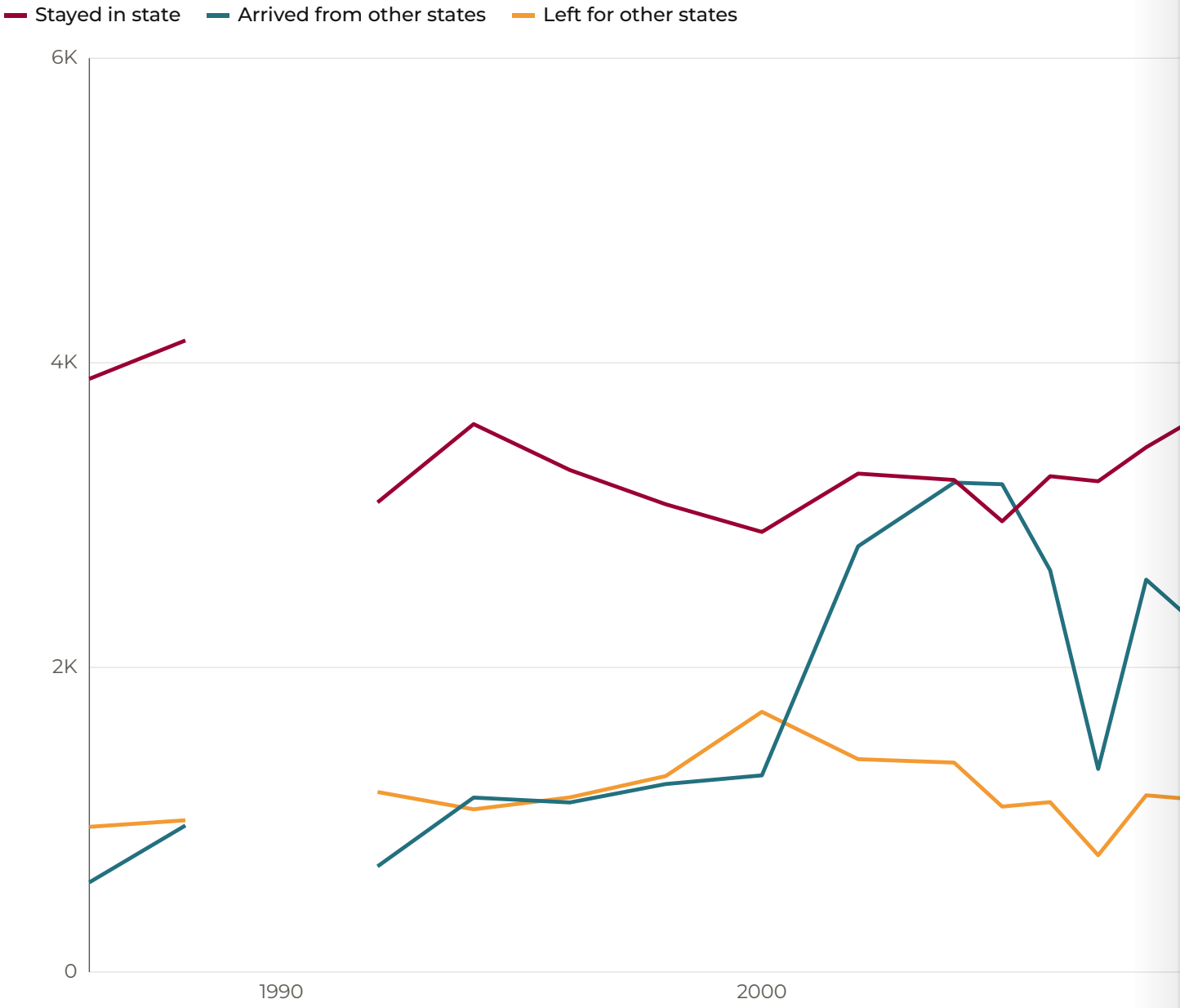
U.S. **3.1%** · **14th** of 51 · +1.3 pp since 2016

+6

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

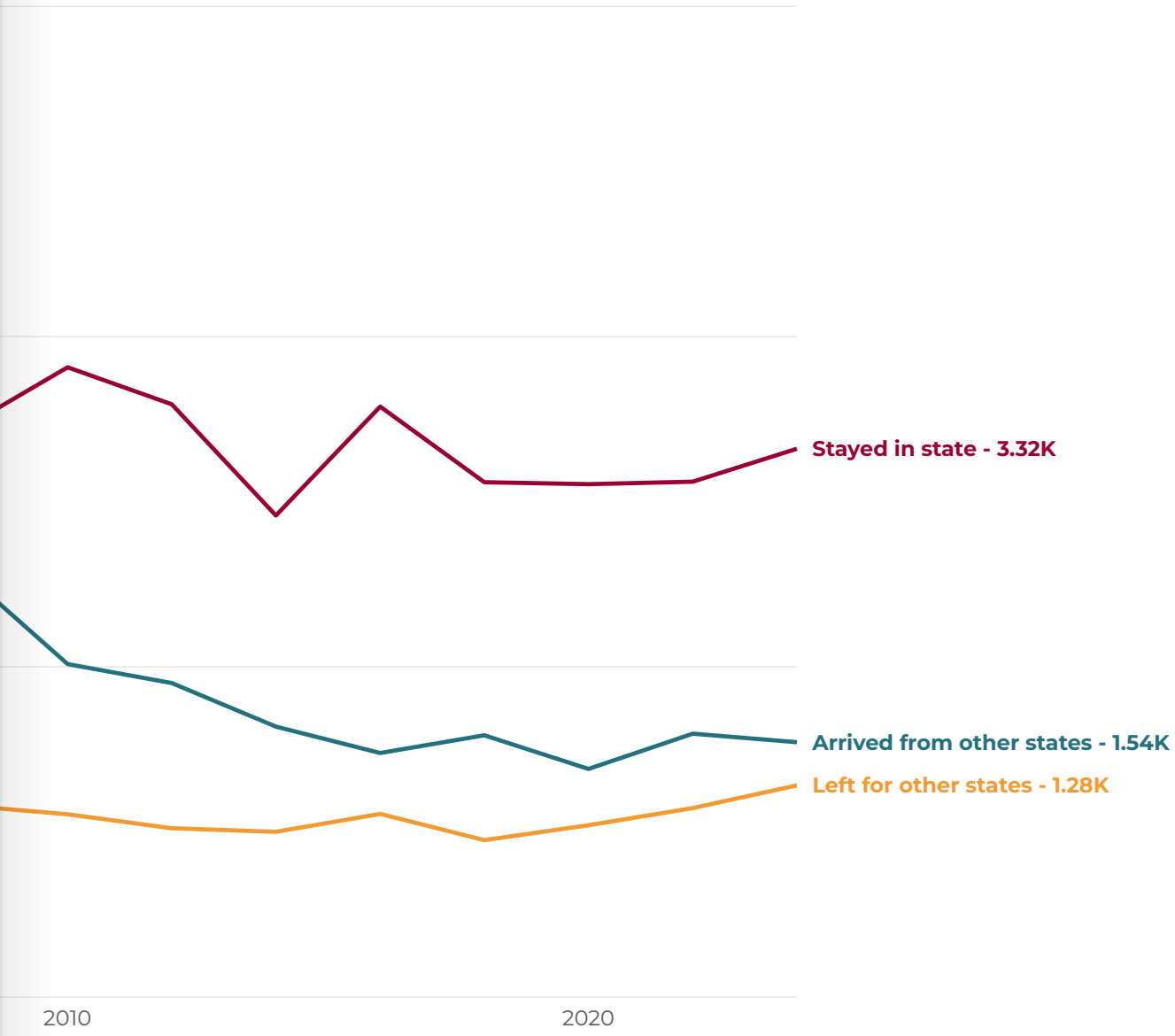
26th of 51 · −2.2 since 2016

Figure 9 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is down 7%, arrivals from other states are up 4%, and residents leaving are up 16%.



Net migration was +6 per 100 resident first-time students (26th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Utah (205).

Figure 10

Where Do Wyoming's Newcomers Come From?

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Wyoming's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

1.73K

First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024

Abroad **182**

3.6%

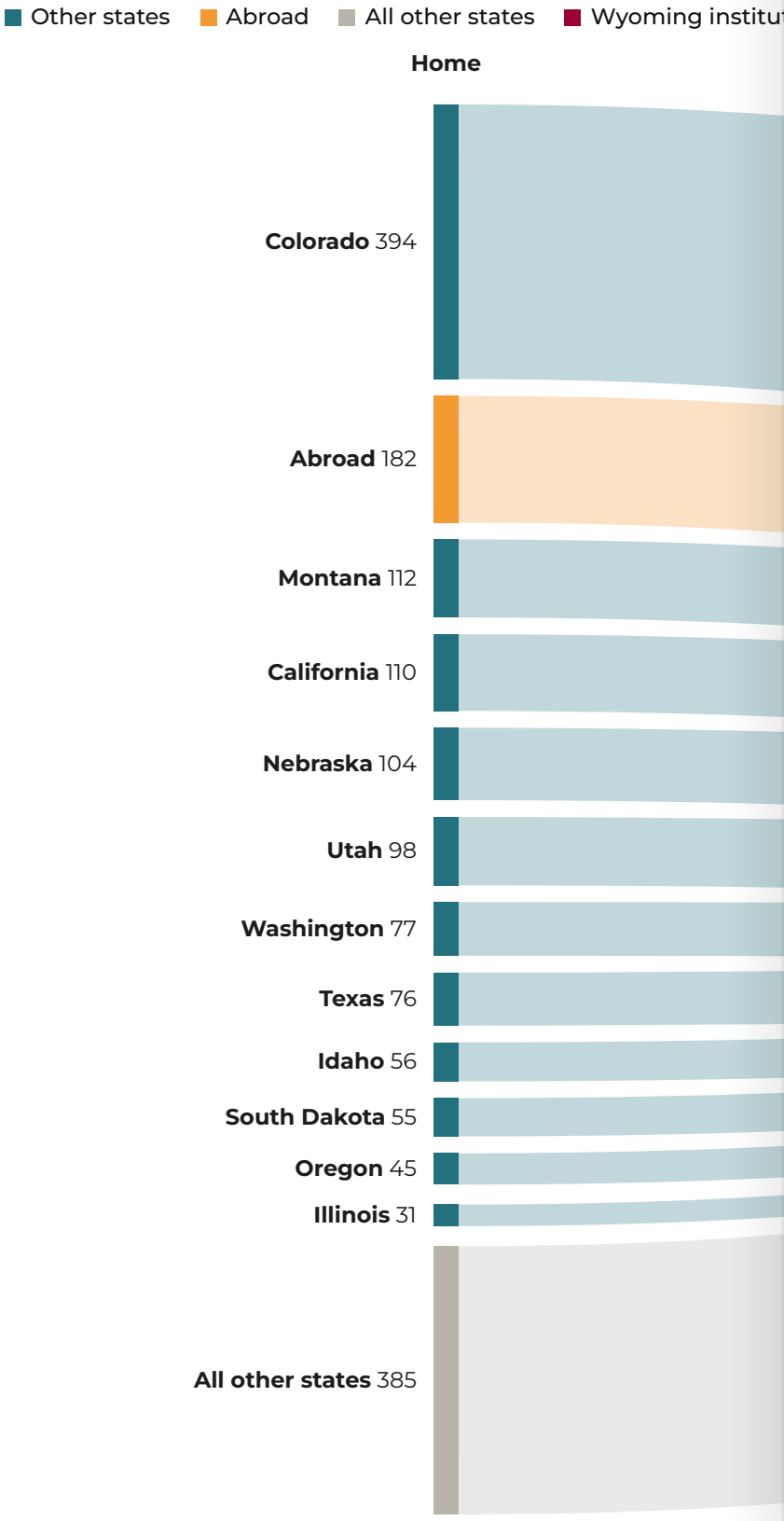
First-time students from abroad, 2024

U.S. **3.1%** · **14th** of 51 · +1.3 pp since 2016

65%

First-time students from in state, 2024

36th of 51 · −3.4 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flow

tions

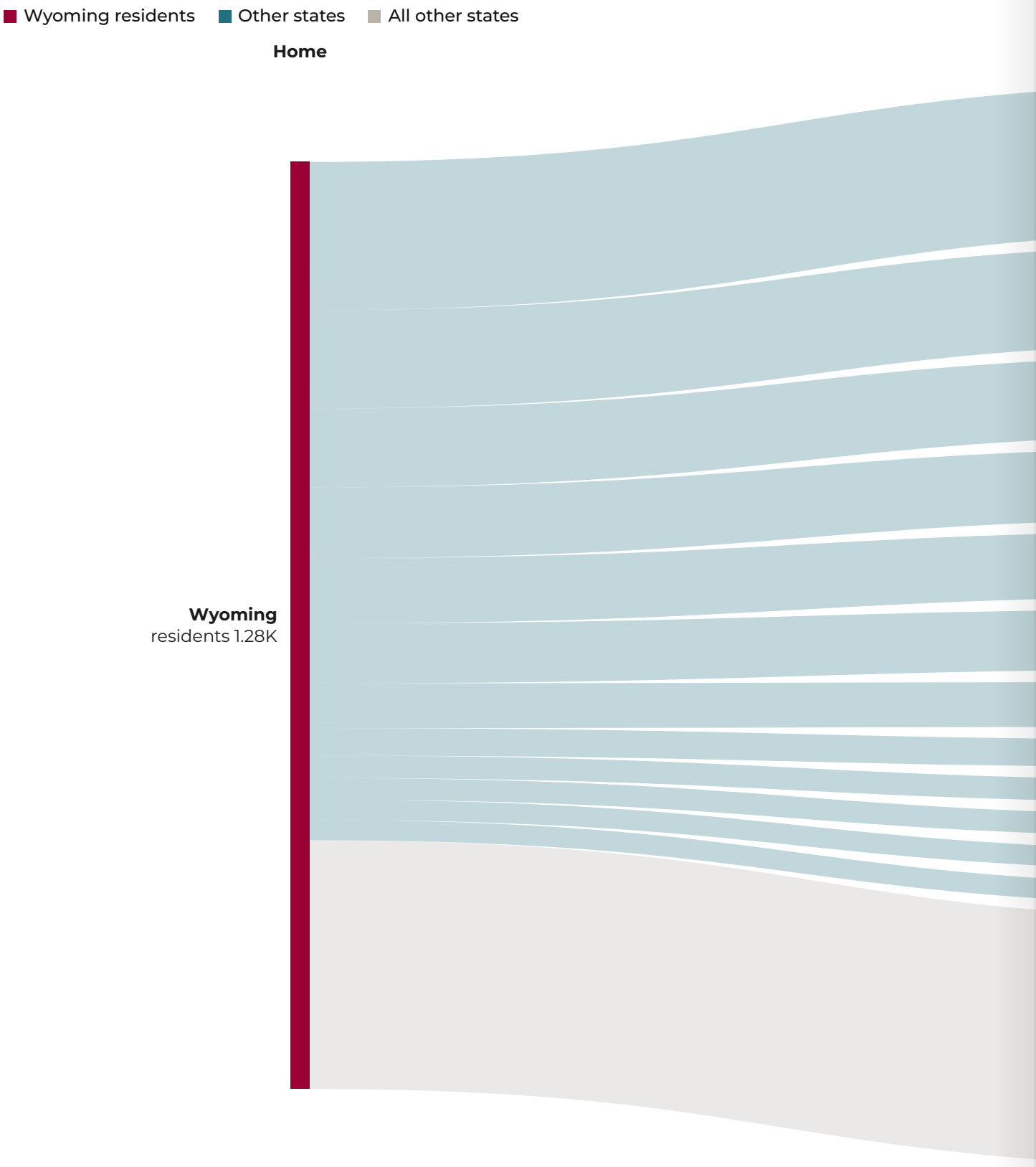
Enrolled in



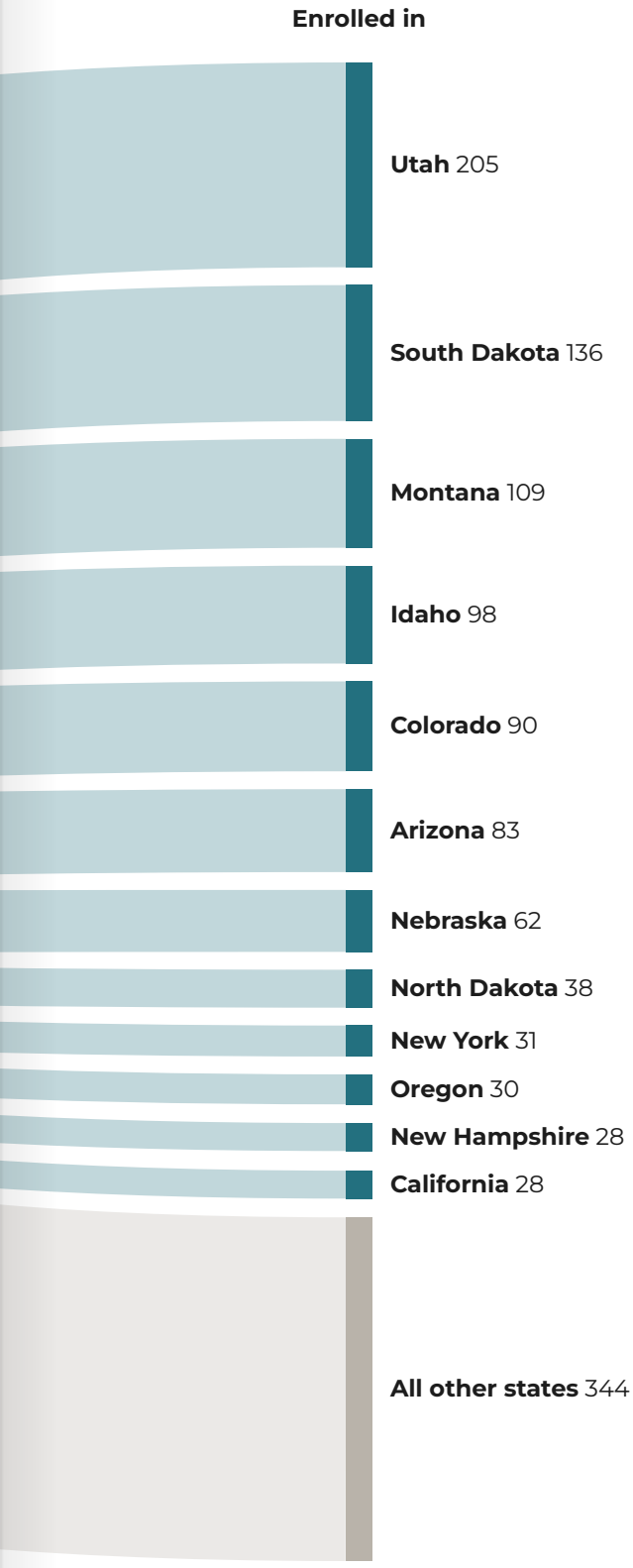
Wyoming
institutions 1.73K

3

ws (more when states tie at the printed figure), ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows (more when states tie at the printed figure), ord



ered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 11

Where Do Wyoming's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where Wyoming residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 1.28K in fall 2024, up 12% from 1.14K in fall 2022 and up 16% since fall 2016, when it was 1.11K.

1.28K
Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024
Arrived from other states **1.54K** · **1.73K** with abroad

+6
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
26th of 51 · −2.2 since 2016

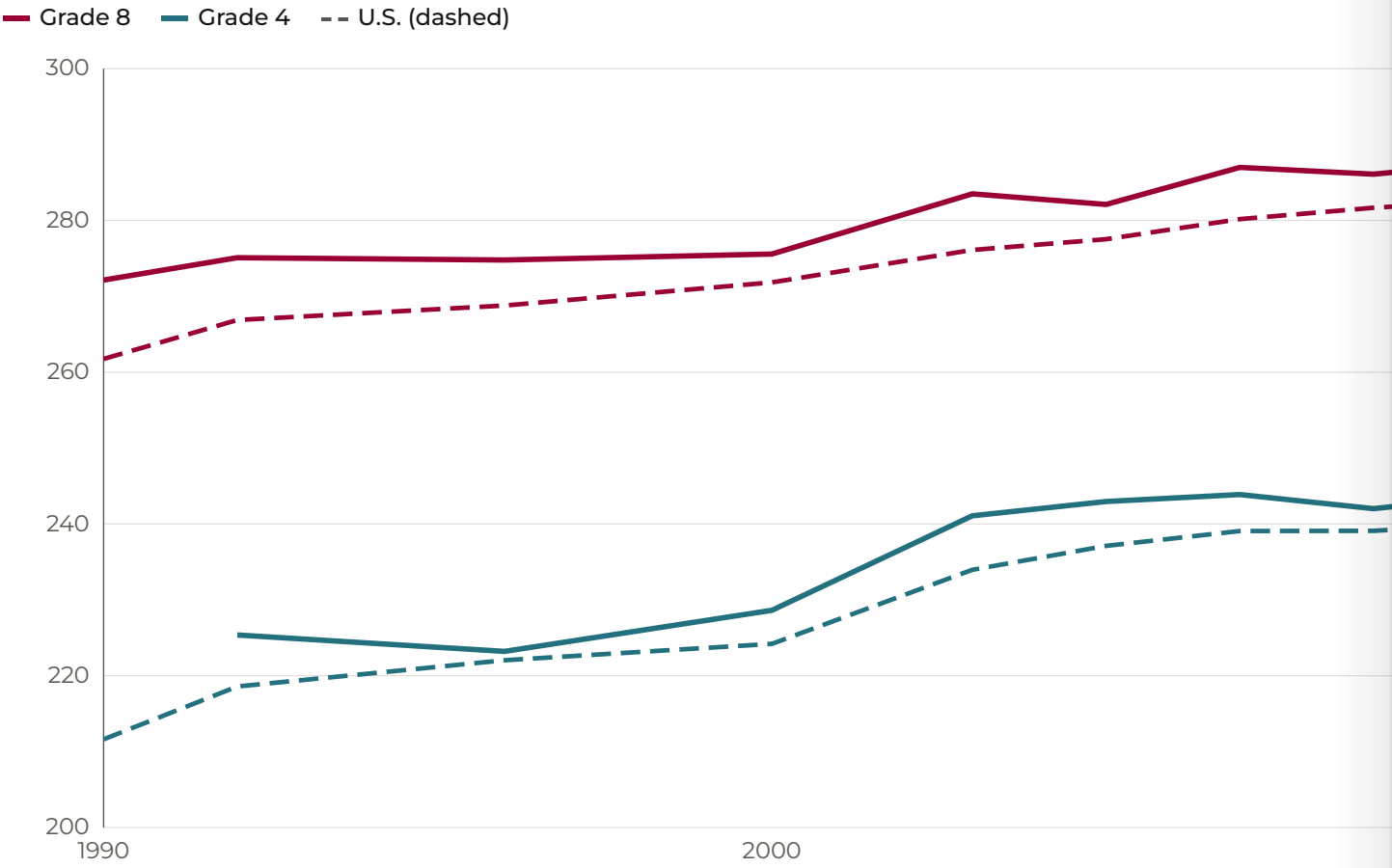
205
Went to Utah
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

Wyoming ranks 12th of 51 on the average grade 8 mathematics score, at 278 in 2024 against 272 for the U.S.

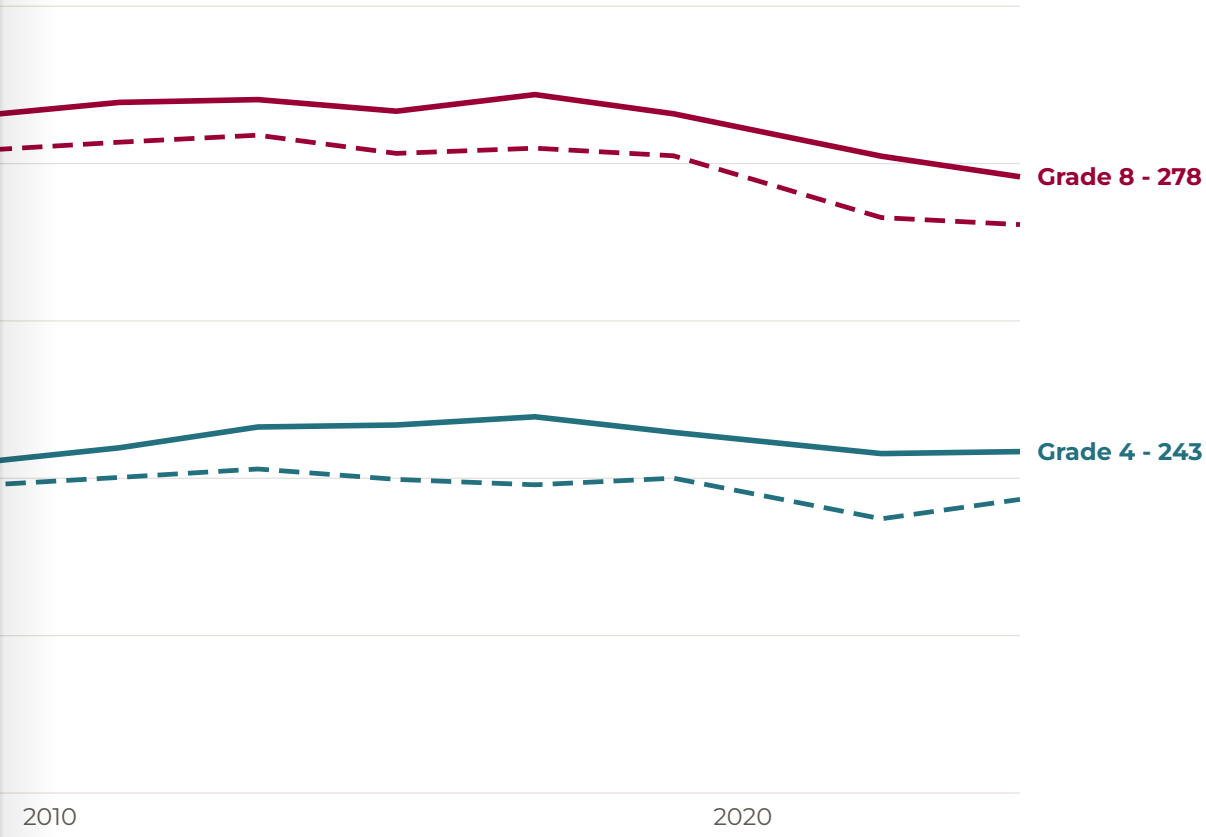
Figure 12 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Wyoming's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, N

The talent pipeline starts in school. Wyoming's eighth graders averaged 278 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 12th of 51 among the states.

30% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.



lational Assessment of Educational Progress.

278

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **12th** of 51 · −8.4 since 2015

30%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **19th** of 51 · −5.2 pp since 2015

260

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **257** · **15th** of 51 · −8.8 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Wyoming ranks 50th of 51 on research doctorates awarded, at 81 in 2025 against 59K for the U.S.

Figure 13 How Many of Wyoming's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold T



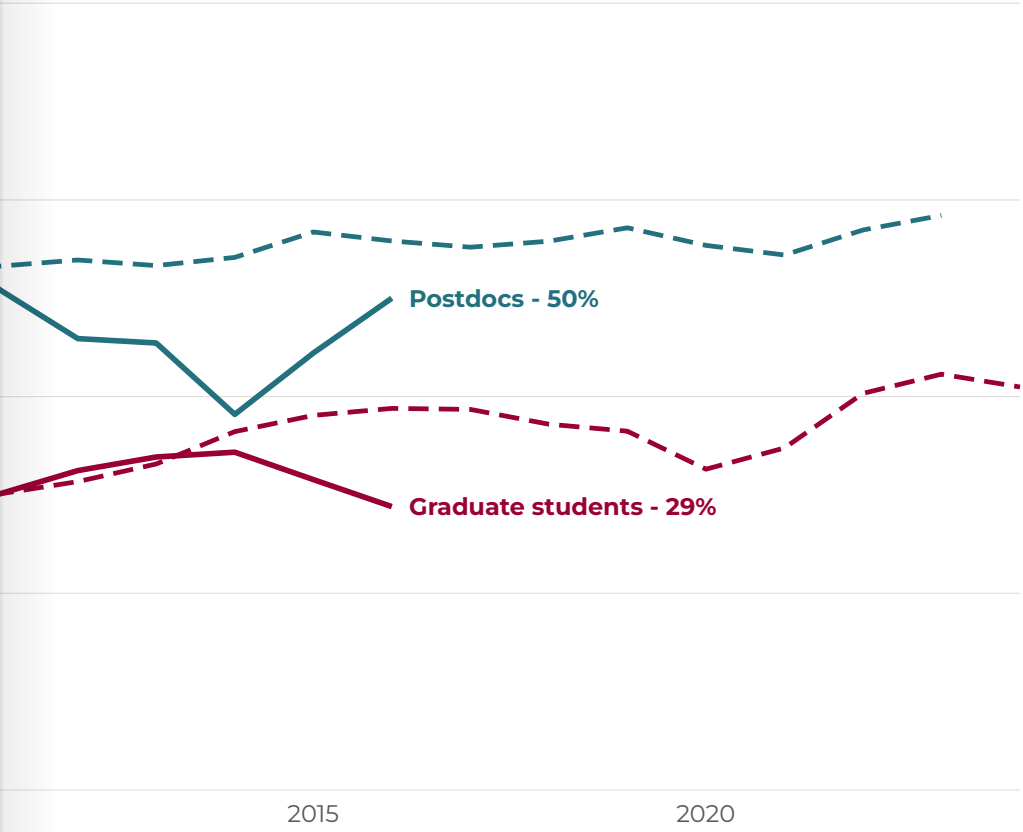
Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's sta
Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 29% of Wyoming's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 35th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 50% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 81 research doctorates in 2025, 0.1% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

Temporary Visas?



te; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate

29%

S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **39%** · **35th** of 51 · −2.7 pp since 2015

50%

S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **56%** · **32nd** of 51 · +5.6 pp since 2015

81

Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025

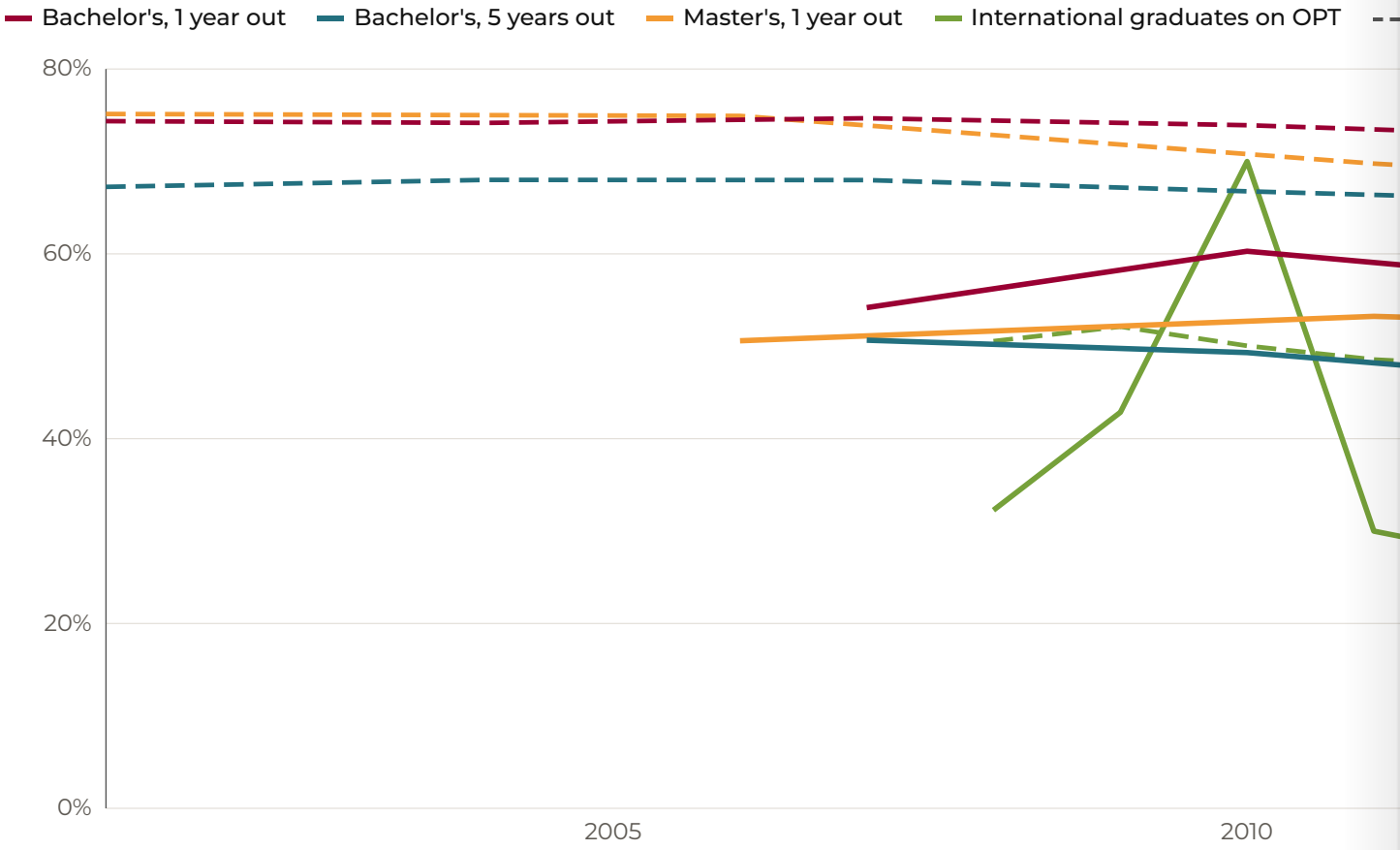
U.S. **59K** · **50th** of 51 · −4.7% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Wyoming ranks 23rd of 33 on the share of bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating, at 57% in 2019 against 72% for the U.S.

Figure 14 How Many of Wyoming's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?

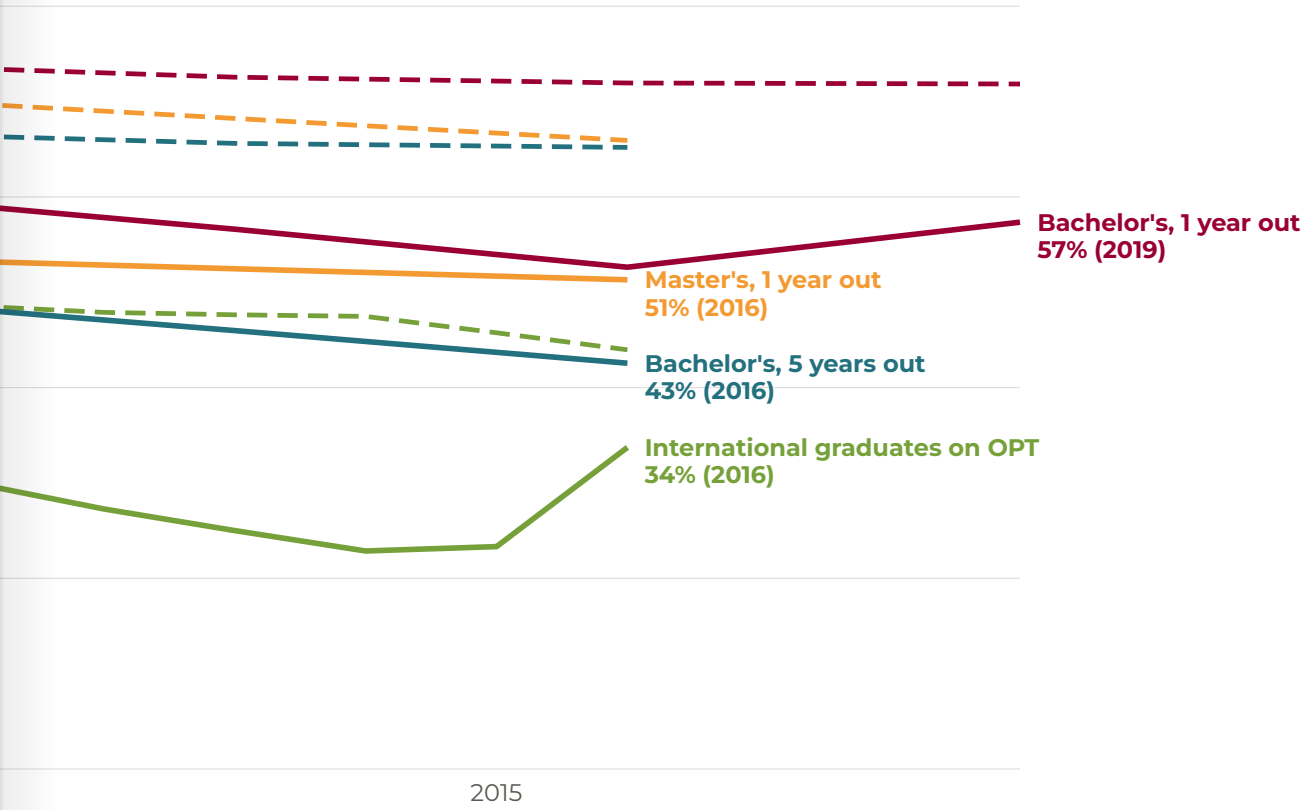


Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Burea state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or particip

Of Wyoming's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 57% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 43%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 34% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). That is the last year the released records cover, before most of the growth in international STEM master's degrees since 2015. Through migration between states, the state gained 3.9 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

U.S. (dashed)



au, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the
pating states dashed.

57%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2019

U.S. **72%** · **23rd** of 33 · +4.7 pp since 2016

34%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **29th** of 51 · +10.4 pp since 2015

+3.9

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

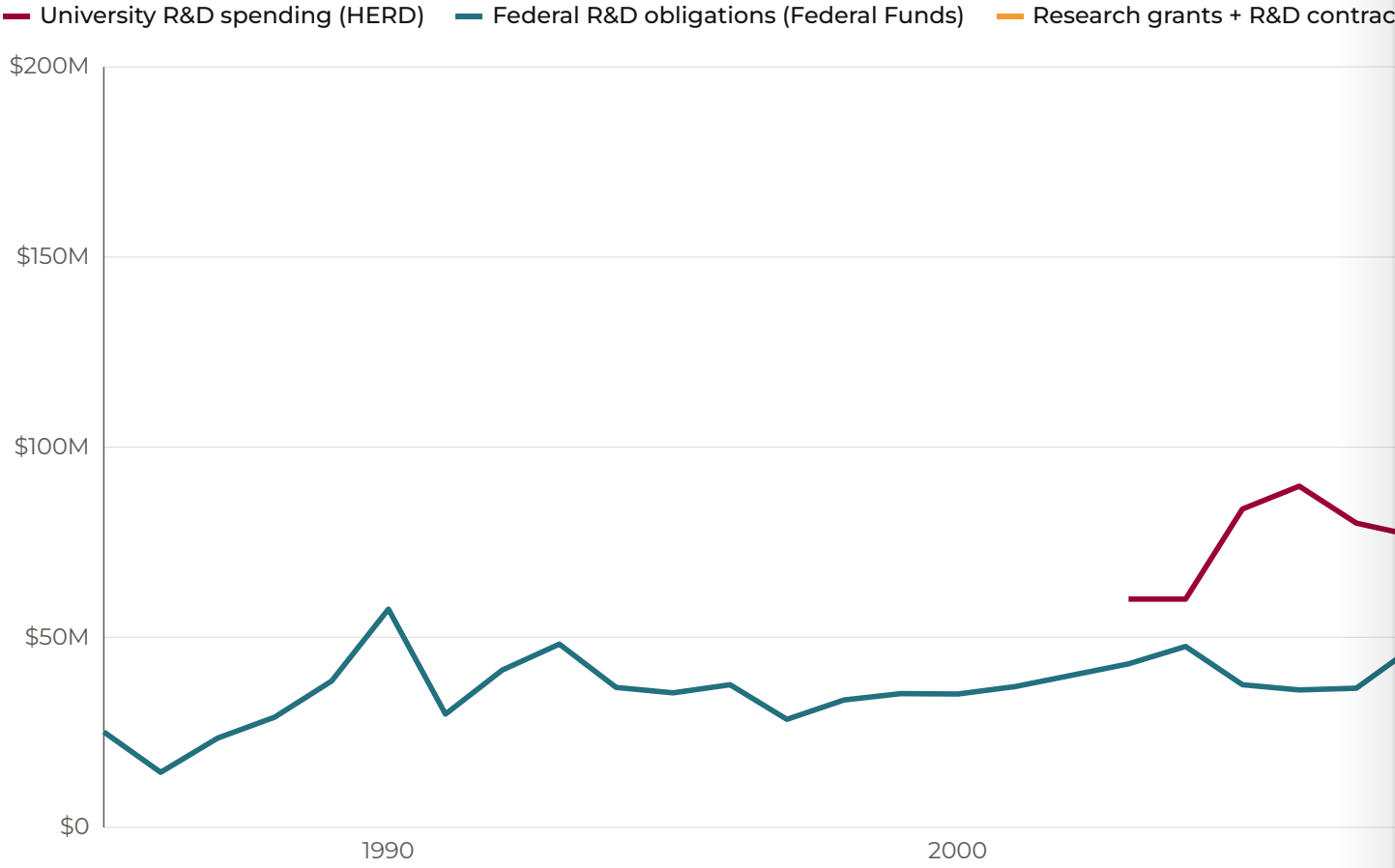
17th of 51 · +30.8 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Wyoming ranks 51st of 51 on federal R&D obligations to the state, at $111M in 2024 against $193B for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Much Research Money Flows Into Wyoming?

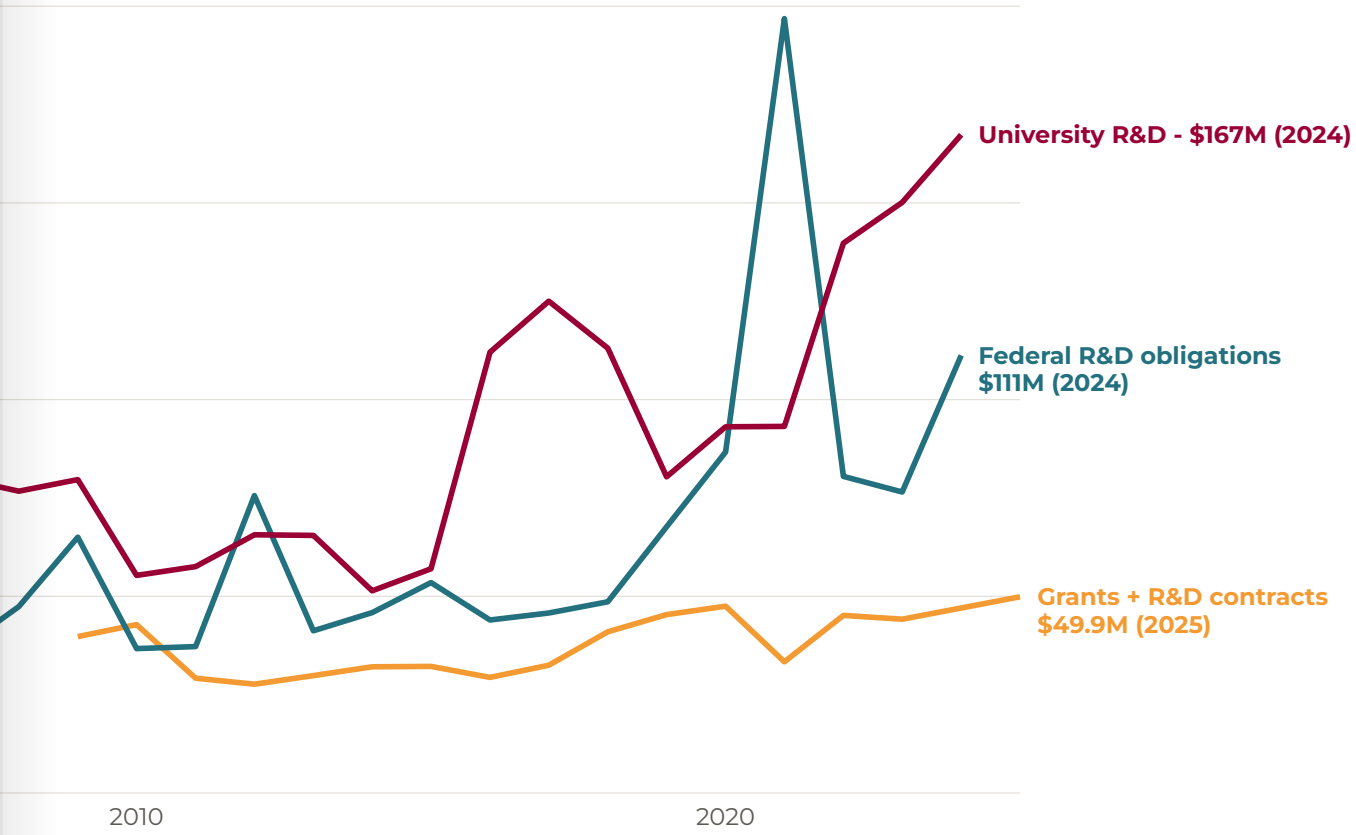


Nominal dollars (not adjusted for inflation), fiscal years; a line ending before the others is labeled with its last year. Univers
Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage wide

Wyoming's universities spent $167M on research and development in FY2024, 50th of 51 among the states; 44% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $111M for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

ts (USAspending)



sity R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey).
ens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

$167M

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **50th** of 51 · 2.94× since 2015

44%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **46th** of 51 · −41.8 pp since 2015

$111M

Federal R&D obligations, 2024

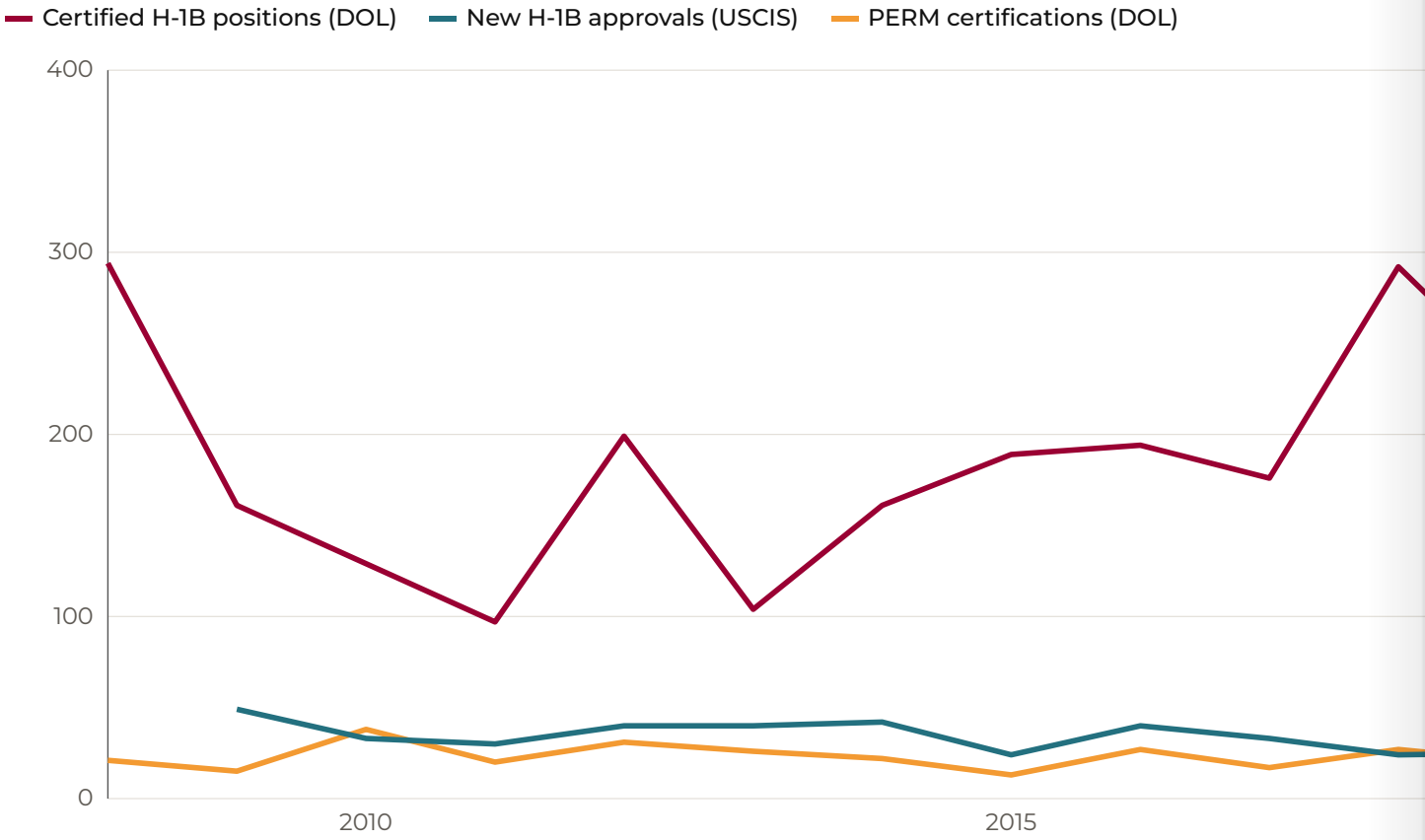
U.S. **$193B** · **51st** of 51 · 2.08× since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Wyoming ranks 51st of 51 on certified H-1B positions, by worksite, at 258 in 2025 against 914K for the U.S.

Figure 16 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Wyoming G

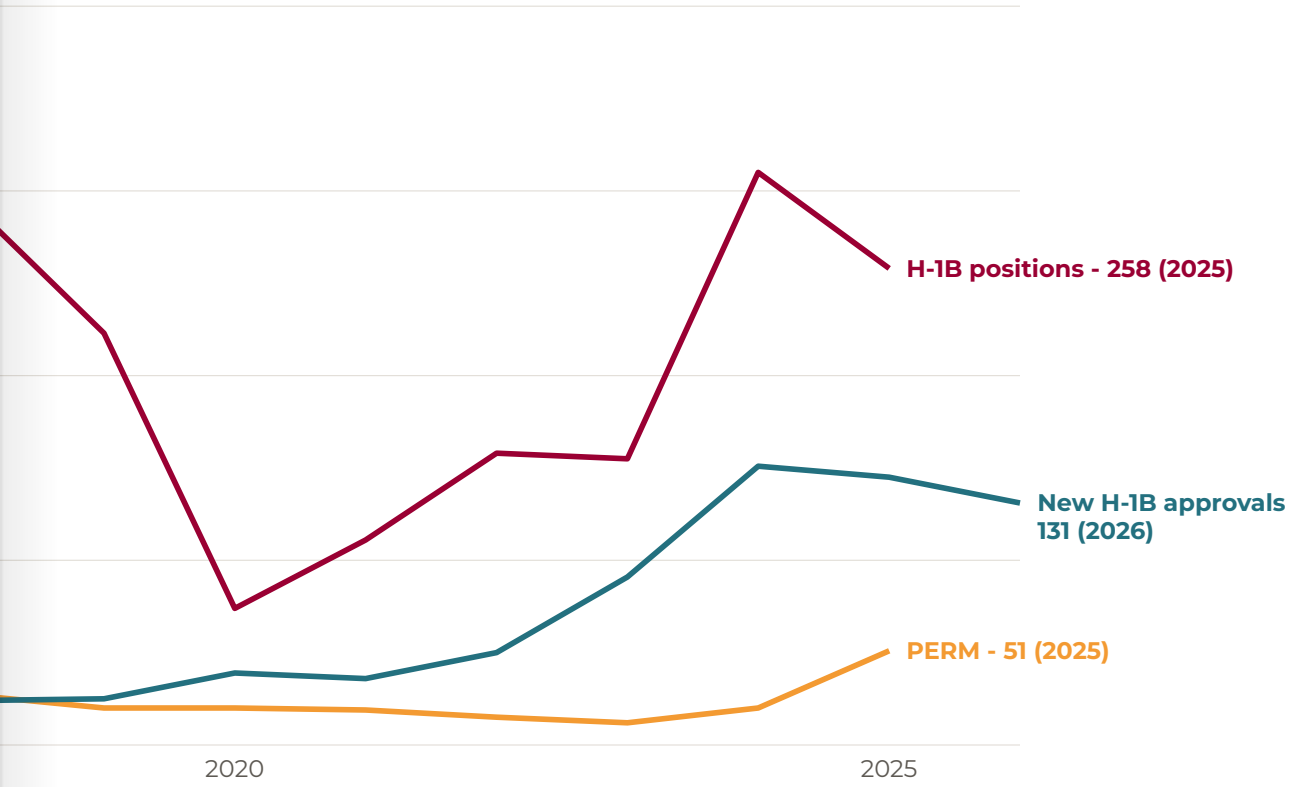


Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 258 H-1B positions at Wyoming worksites in FY2025, 51st of 51 among the states. A labor condition application comes before the petition and covers renewals and job changes as well as new hires, by the worksite's state, so it runs well above approvals. USCIS approved 131 new H-1B petitions in FY2026 and 64 continuing ones, counted by the employer's address.

DOL certified 51 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 7.1% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

enerate?



year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data

258

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **51st** of 51 · +37% since 2015

51

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

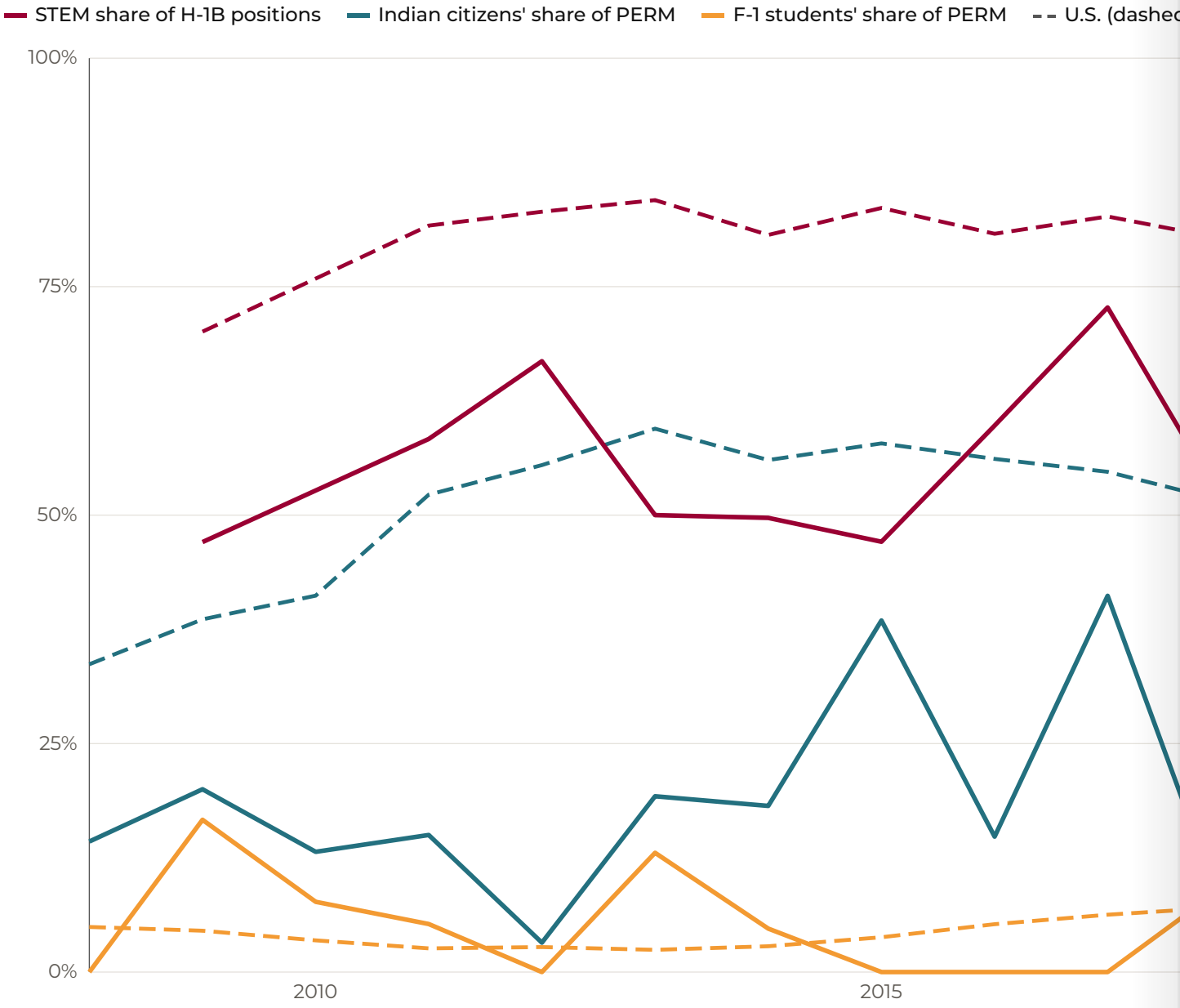
U.S. **138K** · **51st** of 51

7.1%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **37th** of 51 · +7.1 pp since 2015

Figure 17 Who Holds Wyoming's Skilled-Visa Jobs?

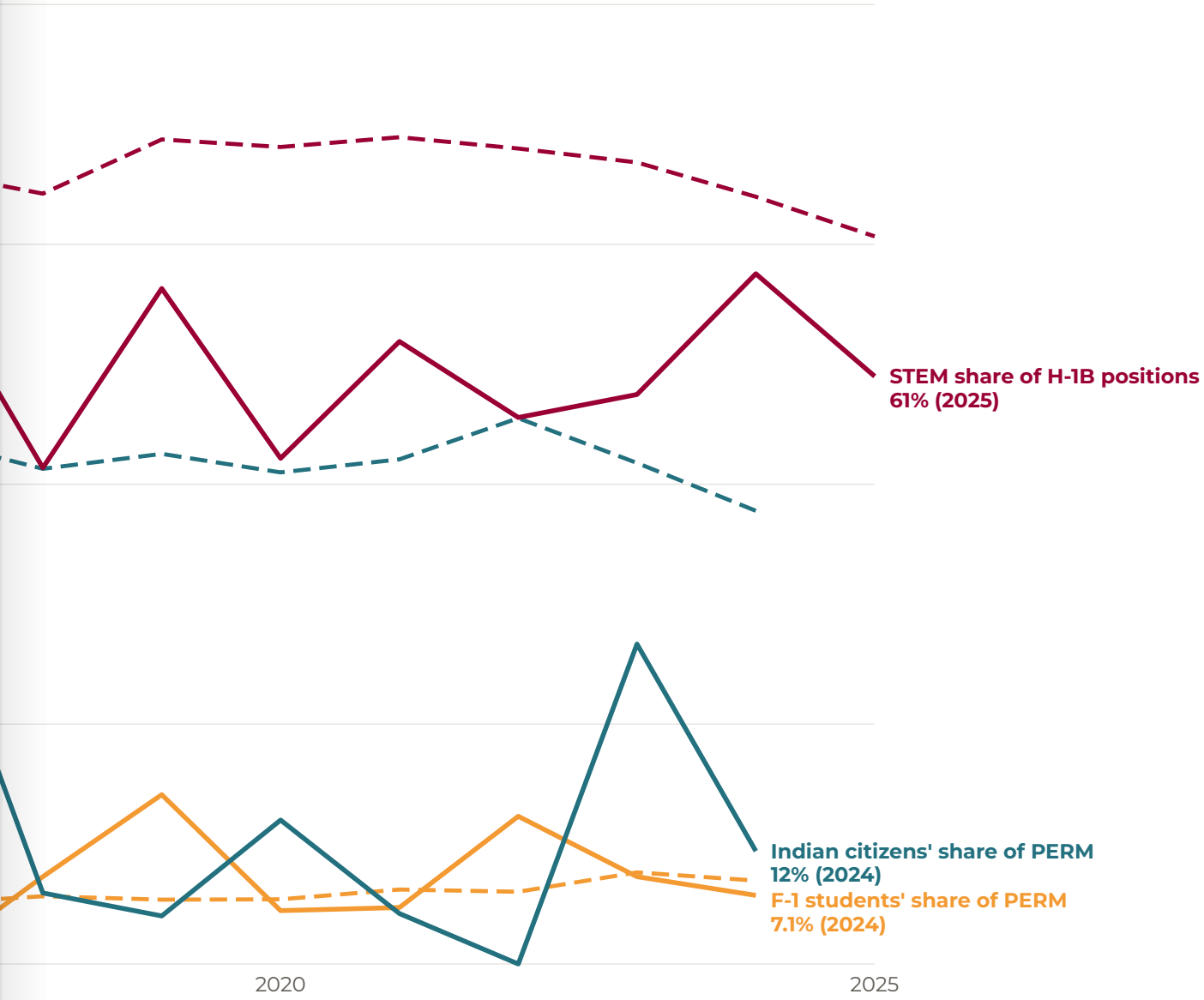


State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from D

61% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 12% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

d)



OL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

61%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **30th** of 51 · +14.2 pp since 2015

12%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **44th** of 51 · −26.7 pp since 2015

$82.8K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

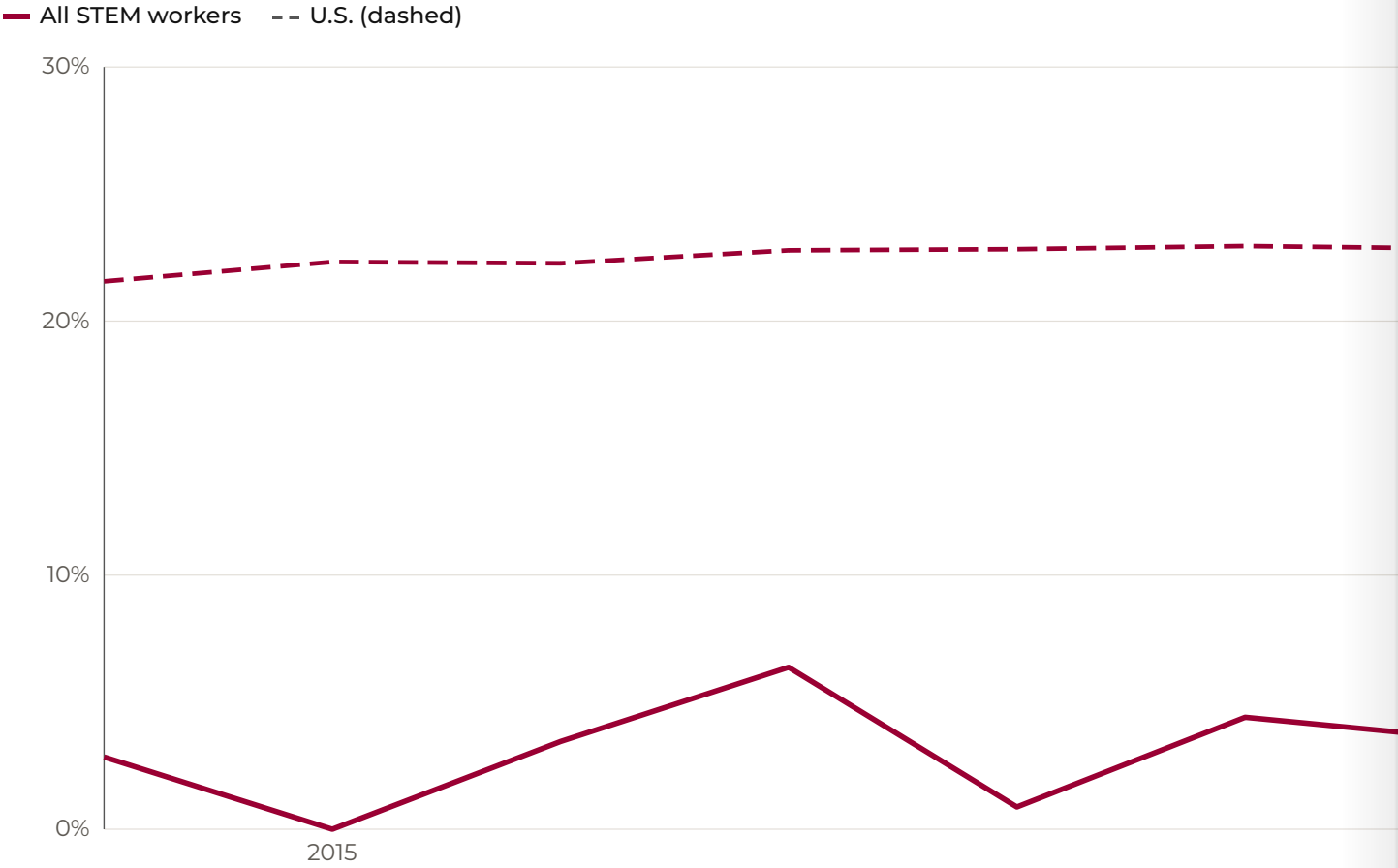
U.S. **$119K** · **46th** of 51 · +18% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

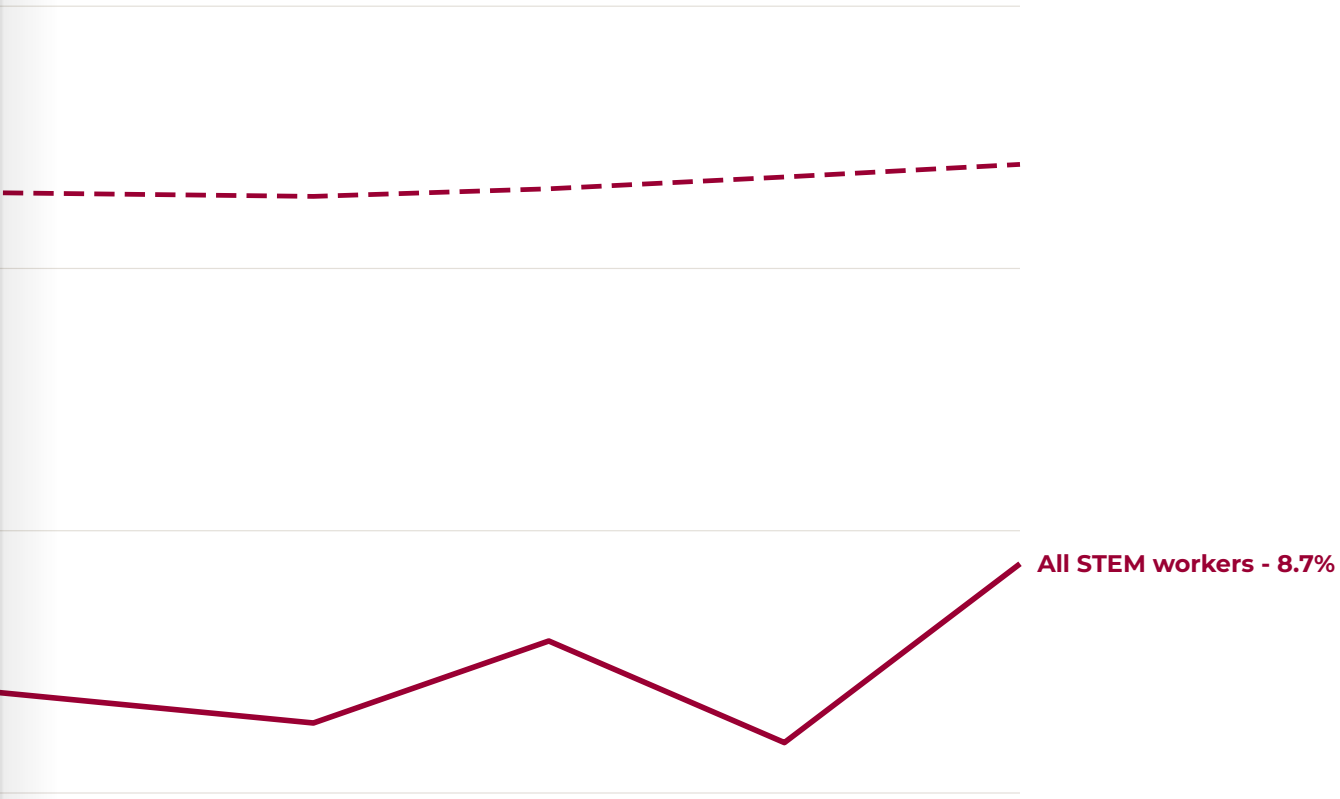
Wyoming ranks 43rd of 51 on the foreign-born share of STEM workers, at 8.7% in 2024 against 24% for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Much of Wyoming's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resti
Community Survey.

In 2024, 8.7% of the people working in STEM occupations in Wyoming were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 43rd of 51).



ng on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American

8.7%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **43rd** of 51 · +8.7 pp since 2015

4.3%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

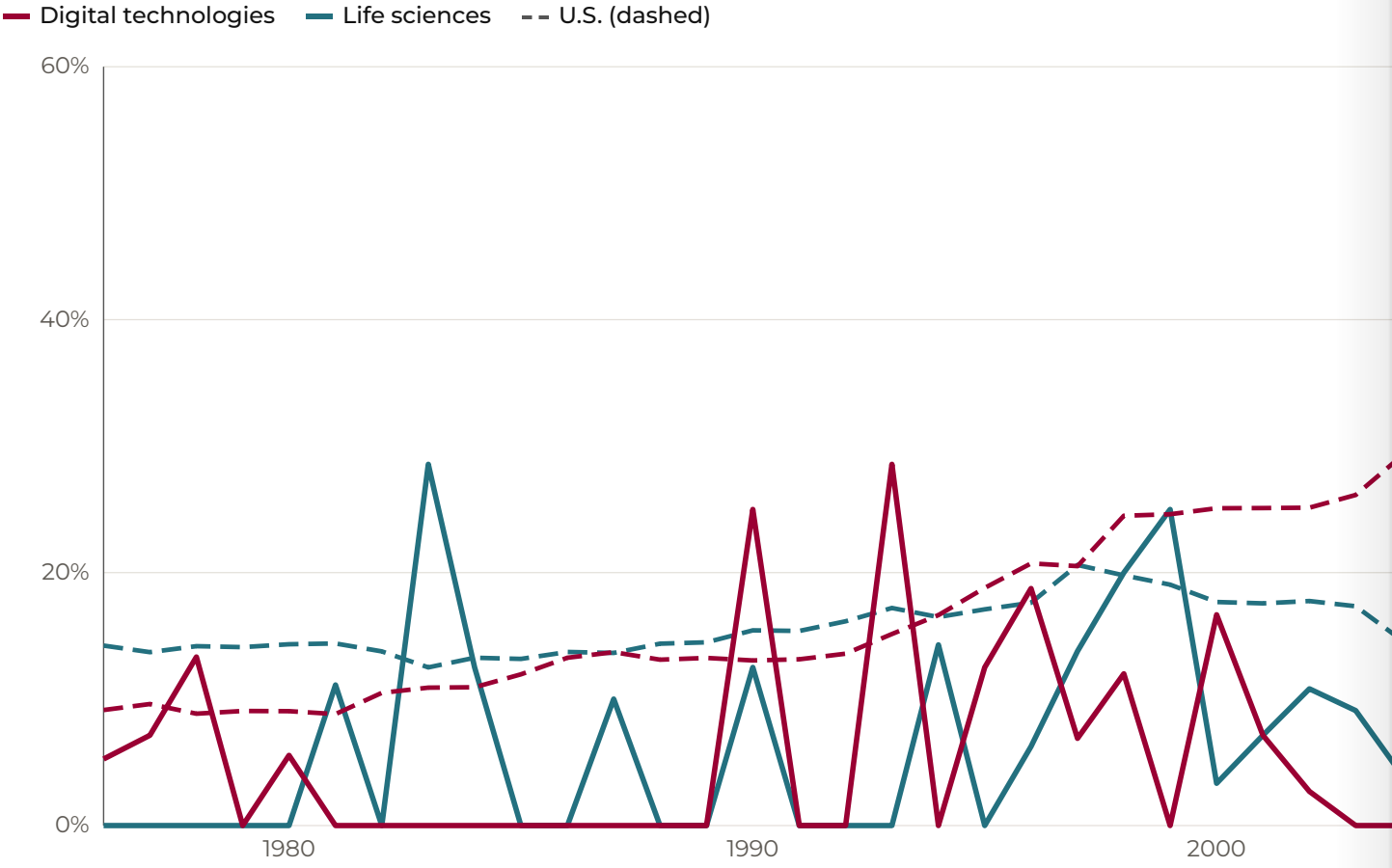
U.S. **11%** · **43rd** of 51 · +4.3 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

Wyoming ranks 43rd of 51 on patents granted to assignees in the state, at 162 in 2025 against 135K for the U.S.

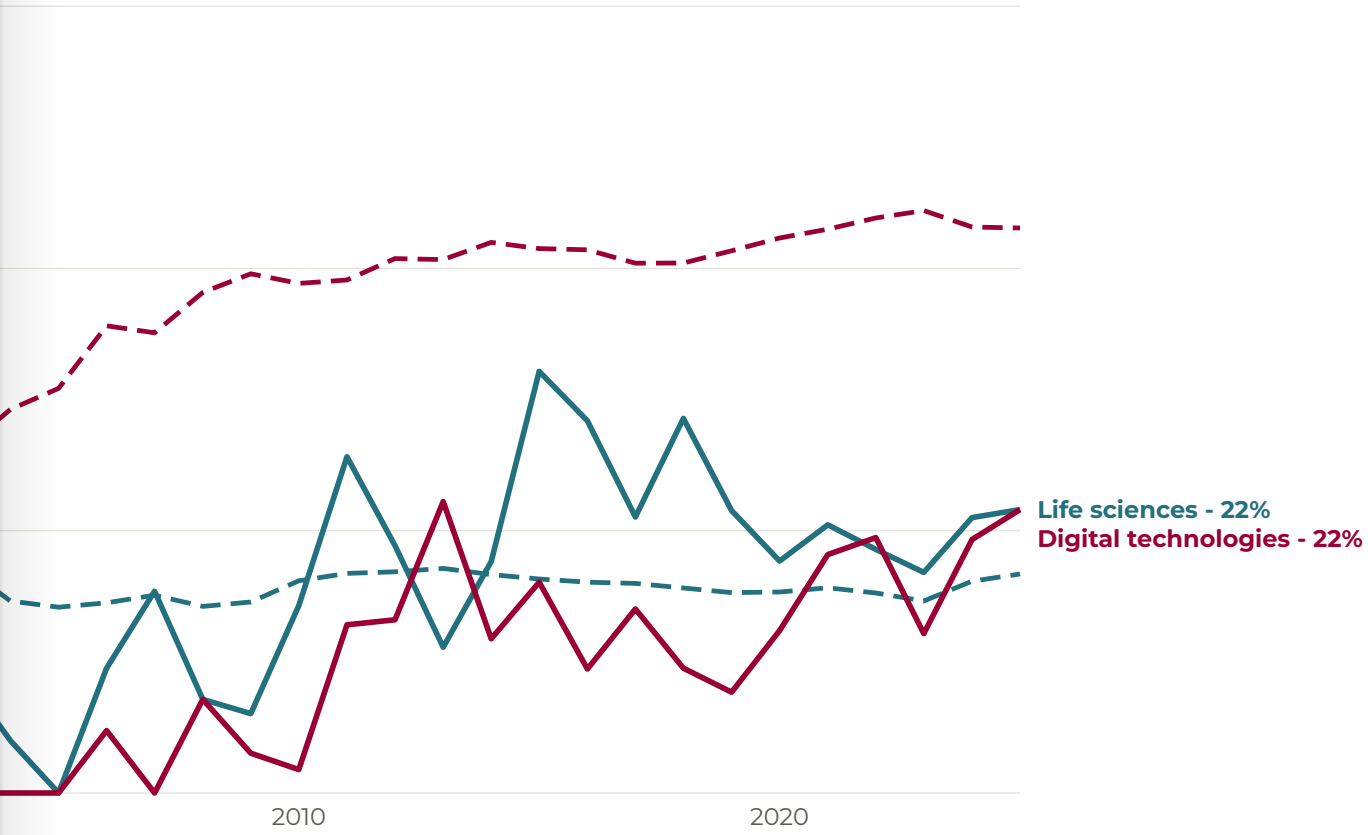
Figure 19 What Kinds of Technology Does Wyoming Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed

Organizations and people in Wyoming were granted 162 U.S. patents in 2025, 0.1% of all patents with a U.S. owner (43rd of 51).

22% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 22% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).



d. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

162

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **43rd** of 51 · 2.88× since 2015

22%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **28th** of 51 · +5.5 pp since 2015

22%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

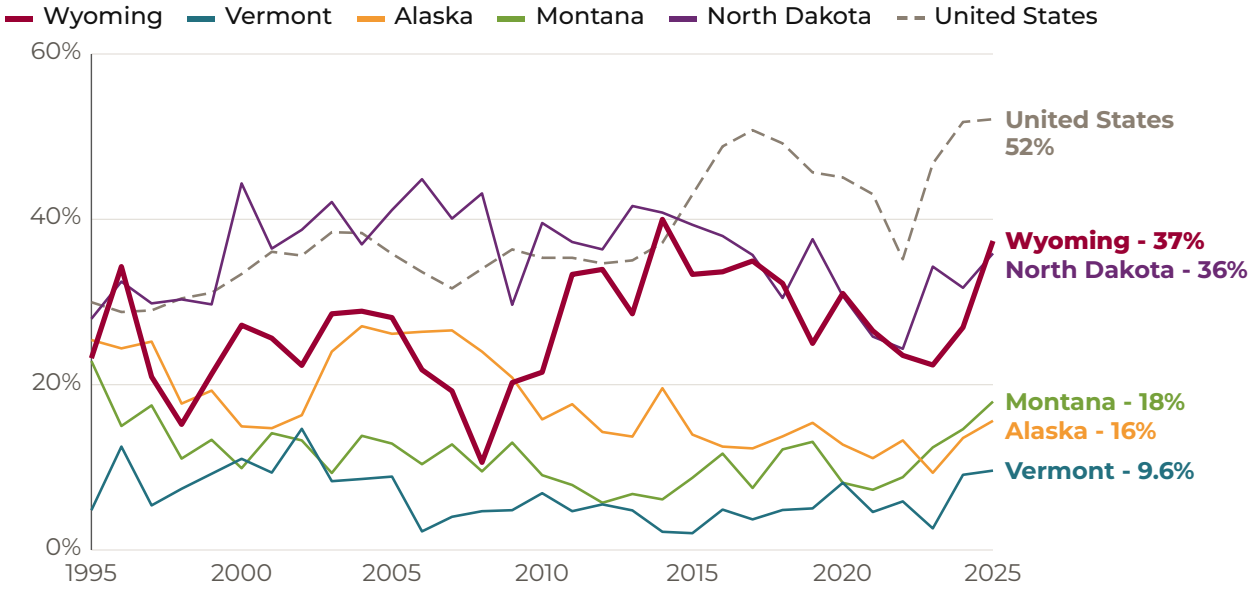
U.S. **17%** · **18th** of 51 · −10.5 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

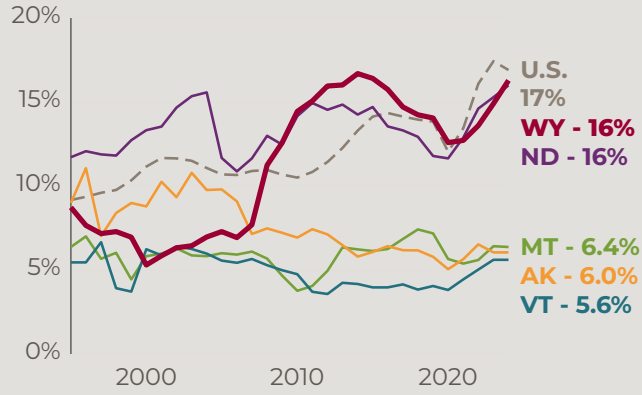
The four states closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally (a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size), are Vermont, Alaska, Montana, and North Dakota. Wyoming ranks 1st of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Wyoming is the most dependent at 37%.

Figure 20 How Dependent Are Wyoming and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



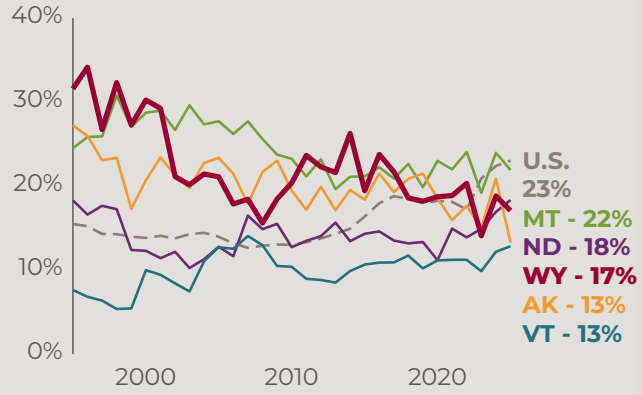
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Figure 21 Int. share of grad students



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 22 STEM share of master's



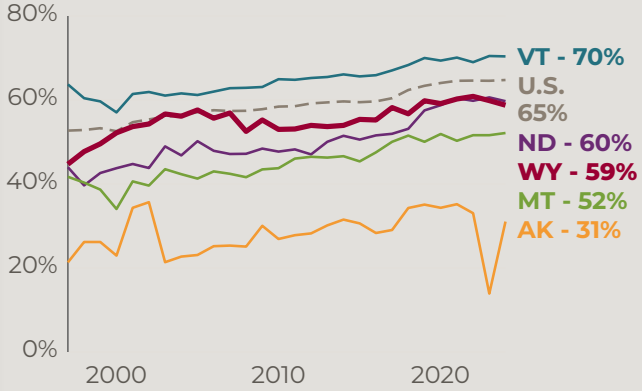
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Table 4 How Does Wyoming Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	WY	VT	AK	MT	ND	U.S.
Students enrolled, 2024	**31.1K**	38.3K	22.7K	48.4K	53.5K	19.7M
Graduate share of students, 2024	**8.6%**	15%	9.0%	12%	15%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025	**22%**	34%	22%	32%	21%	24%
STEM share of master's, 2025	**17%**	13%	13%	22%	18%	23%
International STEM master's, 2025	**37**	20	10	56	122	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025	**0.0%**	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.1%	–
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025	**37%**	9.6%	16%	18%	36%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates, 2025	**37%**	20%	9.1%	12%	57%	43%
Int. share of grad students, 2024	**16%**	5.6%	6.0%	6.4%	16%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment, 2024	**1.7%**	3.0%	1.2%	1.1%	2.7%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024	**59%**	70%	31%	52%	60%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023	**$5.82K**	$17.5K	$8.04K	$7.93K	$9.87K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student, 2024	**$21.3K**	$5.33K	$28K	$9.29K	$11.9K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024	**$85.4K**	$94K	$90K	$82K	$82.6K	$106K
First-time students from in state, 2024	**65%**	29%	77%	58%	50%	–
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024	**+6**	+55	−27	+21	+42	–

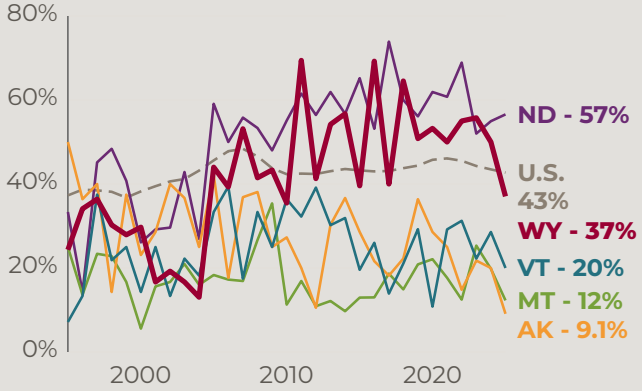
Latest year for each measure, given after its name. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 Int. share of STEM doctorates

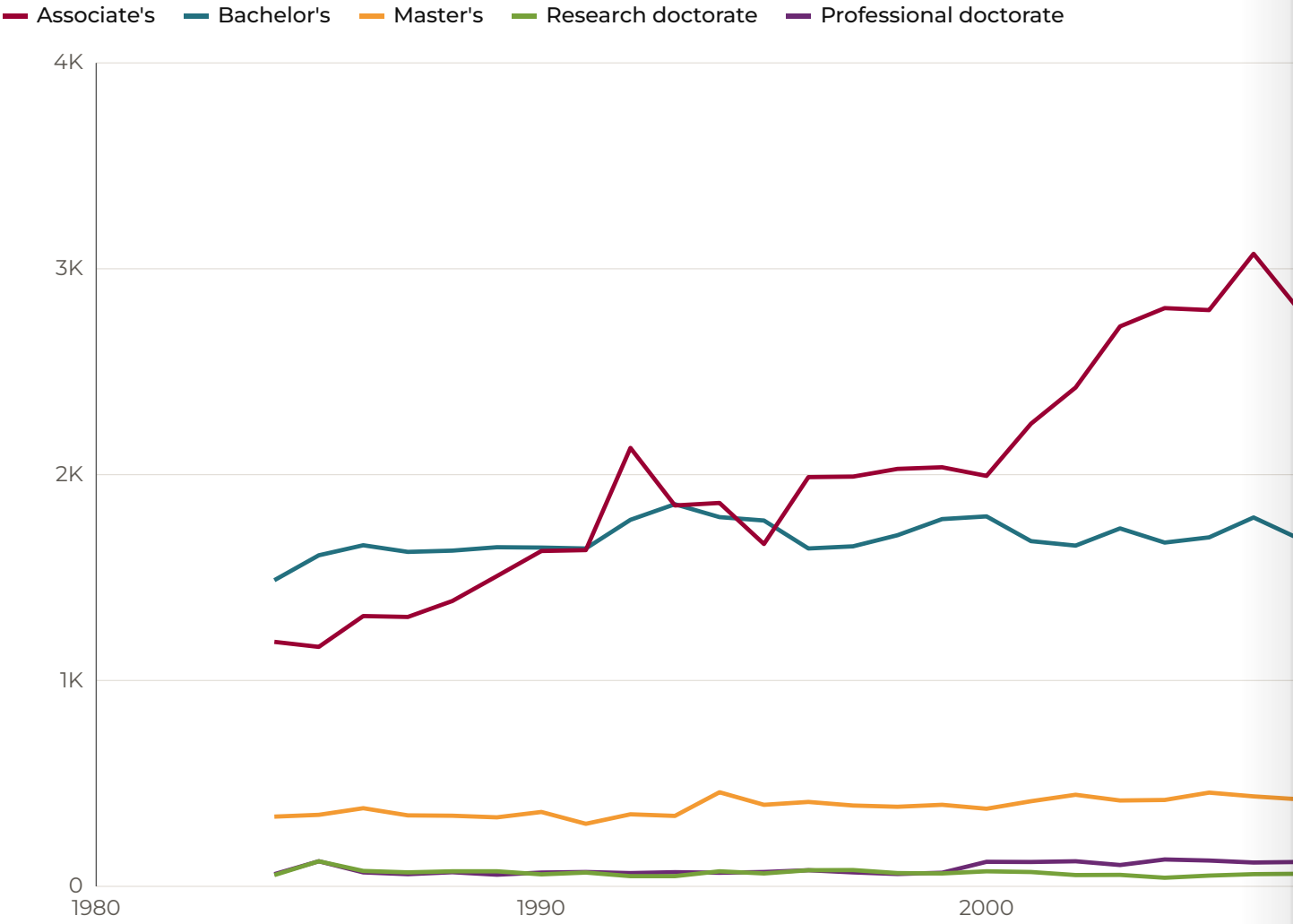


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

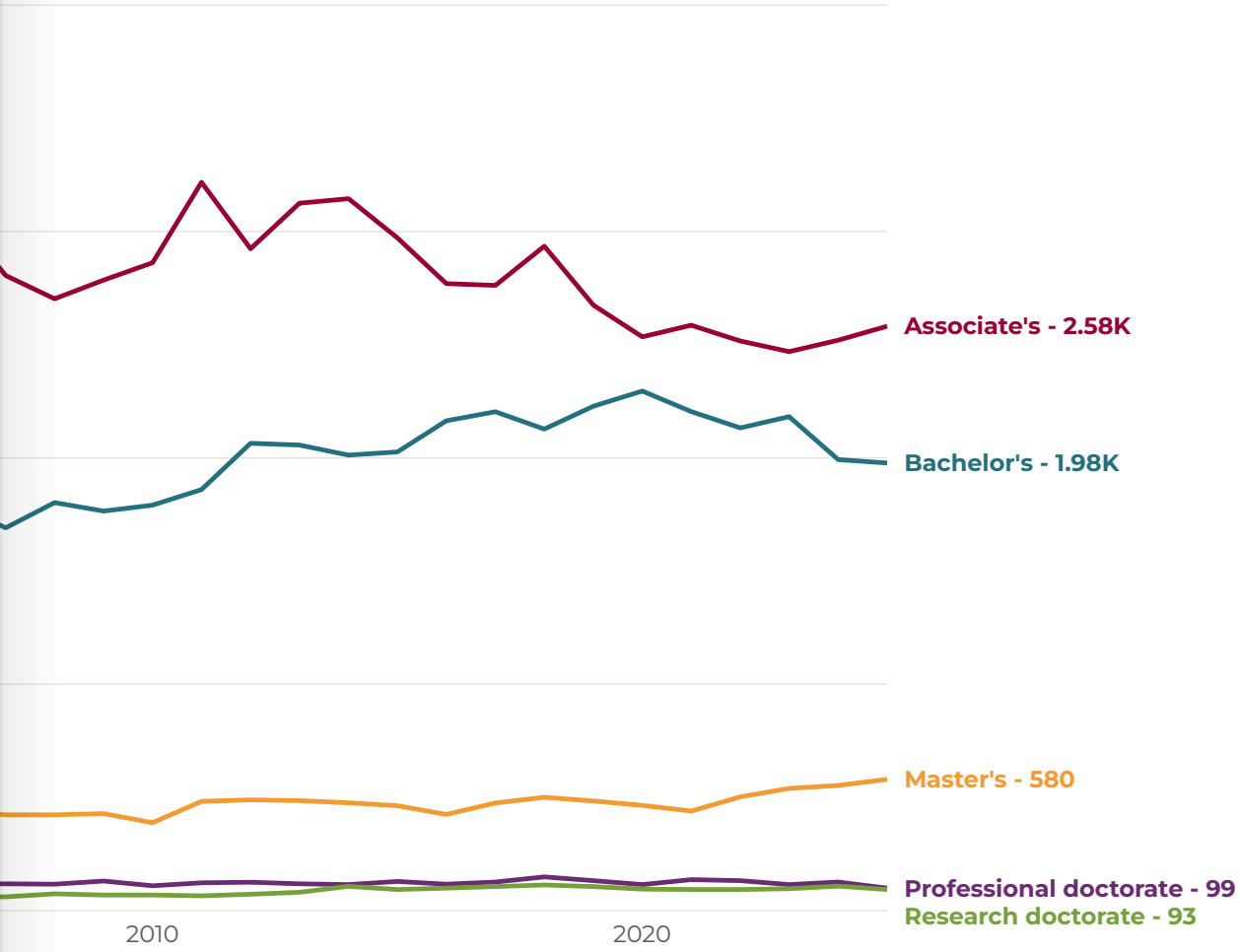
Fields of Study

Figure 25 How Many Degrees Does Wyoming Award?



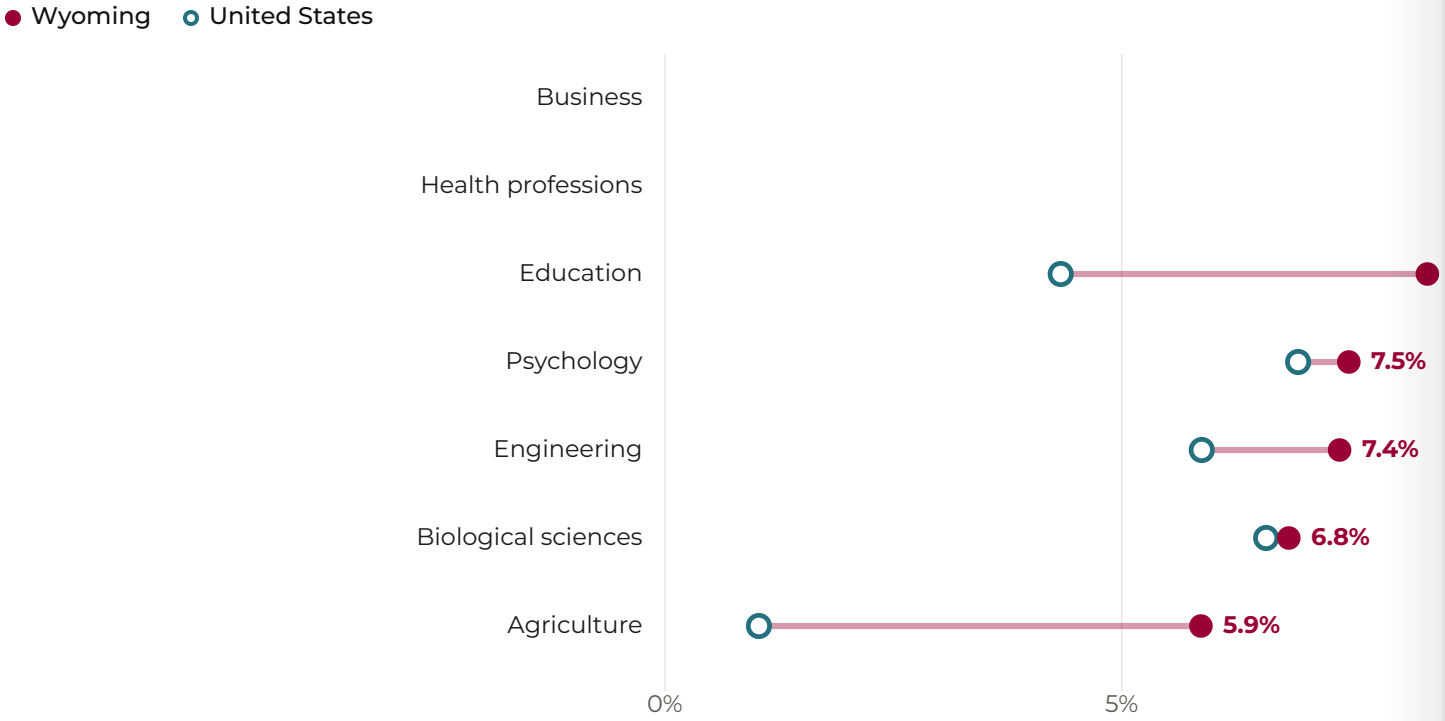
Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, Wyoming's institutions awarded 2.58K associate's degrees, 1.98K bachelor's degrees, 580 master's degrees, 93 research doctorate degrees, 99 professional doctorate degrees.



Since 2015: associate's down 13%; bachelor's down 2%; master's up 25%; research doctorate roughly flat; professional doctorate down 23%. The state awards 7.0 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

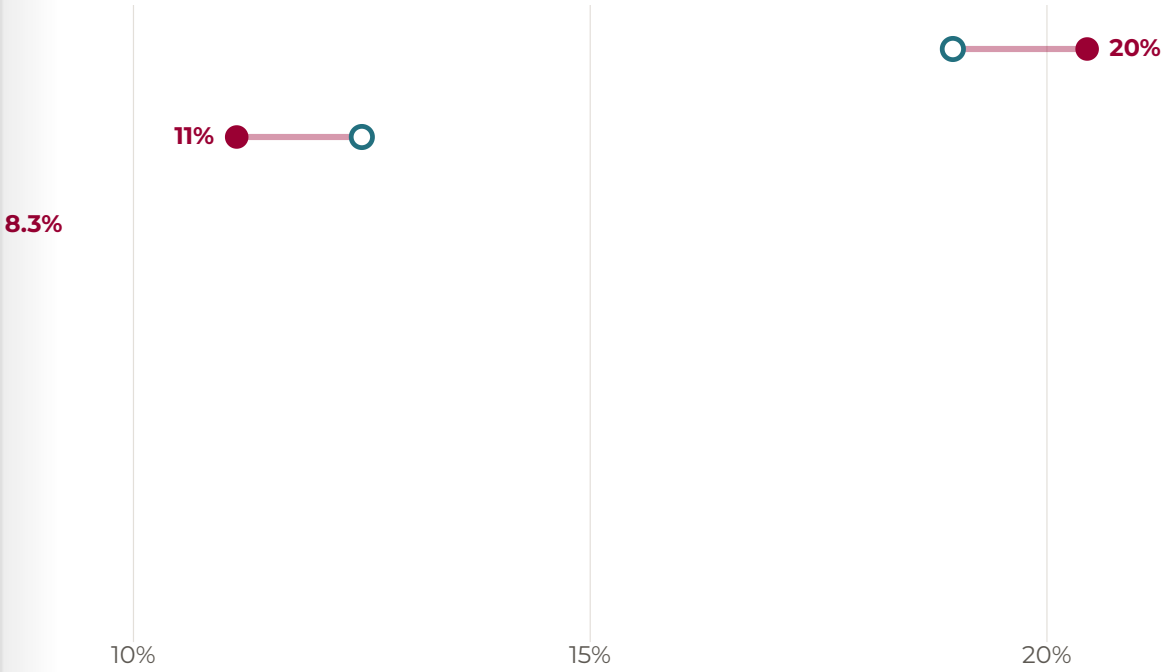
Figure 26 What Do Wyoming's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Wyoming's largest bachelor's fields are business (20%; U.S. 19%), health professions (11%; U.S. 13%), education (8.3%; U.S. 4.3%).

Relative to the nation, Wyoming's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in agriculture (5.71× the U.S. share), education (1.93× the U.S. share), engineering (1.26× the U.S. share).



1.9%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **51st** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

7.4%

Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025

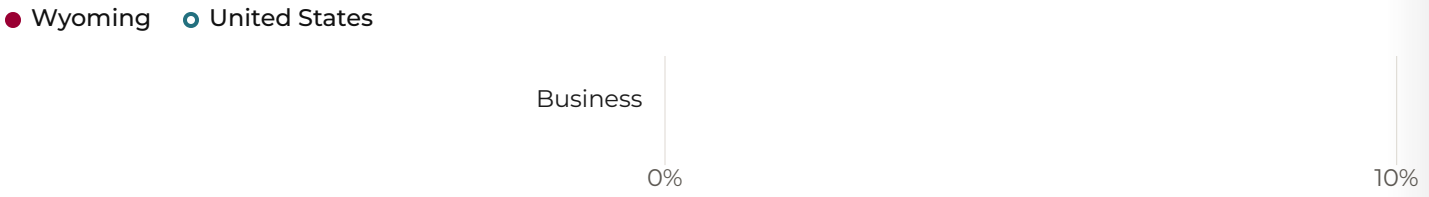
U.S. **6.8%** · **18th** of 51 · −2.3 pp since 2015

20%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **20th** of 51 · +7.3 pp since 2015

Figure 27 What Do Wyoming's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Wyoming's largest master's fields are business (26%; U.S. 21%).

International students earn 14% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 17% of them.



17%

STEM share of master's, 2025

U.S. **23%** · **34th** of 51 · −2.4 pp since 2015

14%

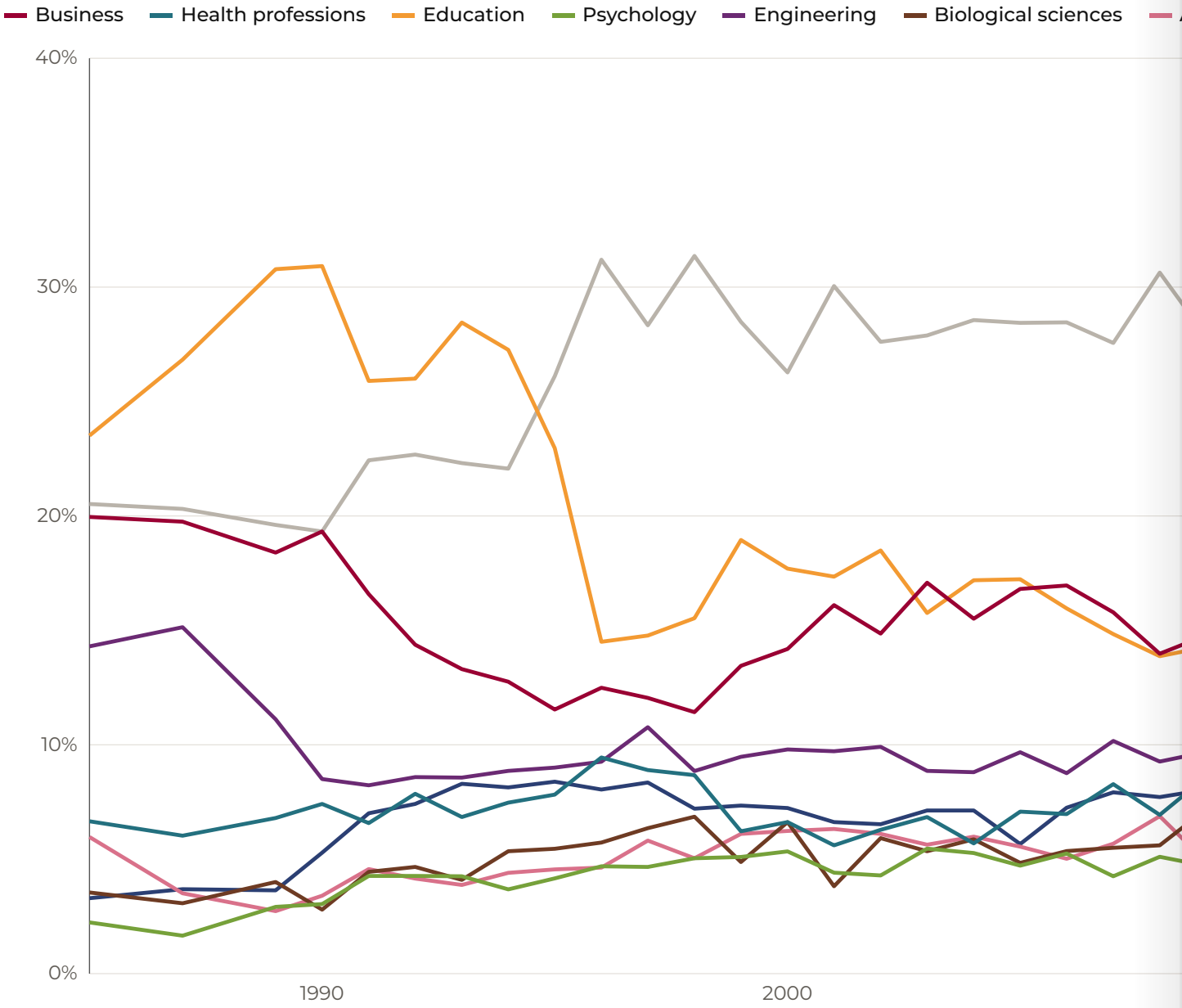
Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **27th** of 51 · −0.5 pp since 2015

–

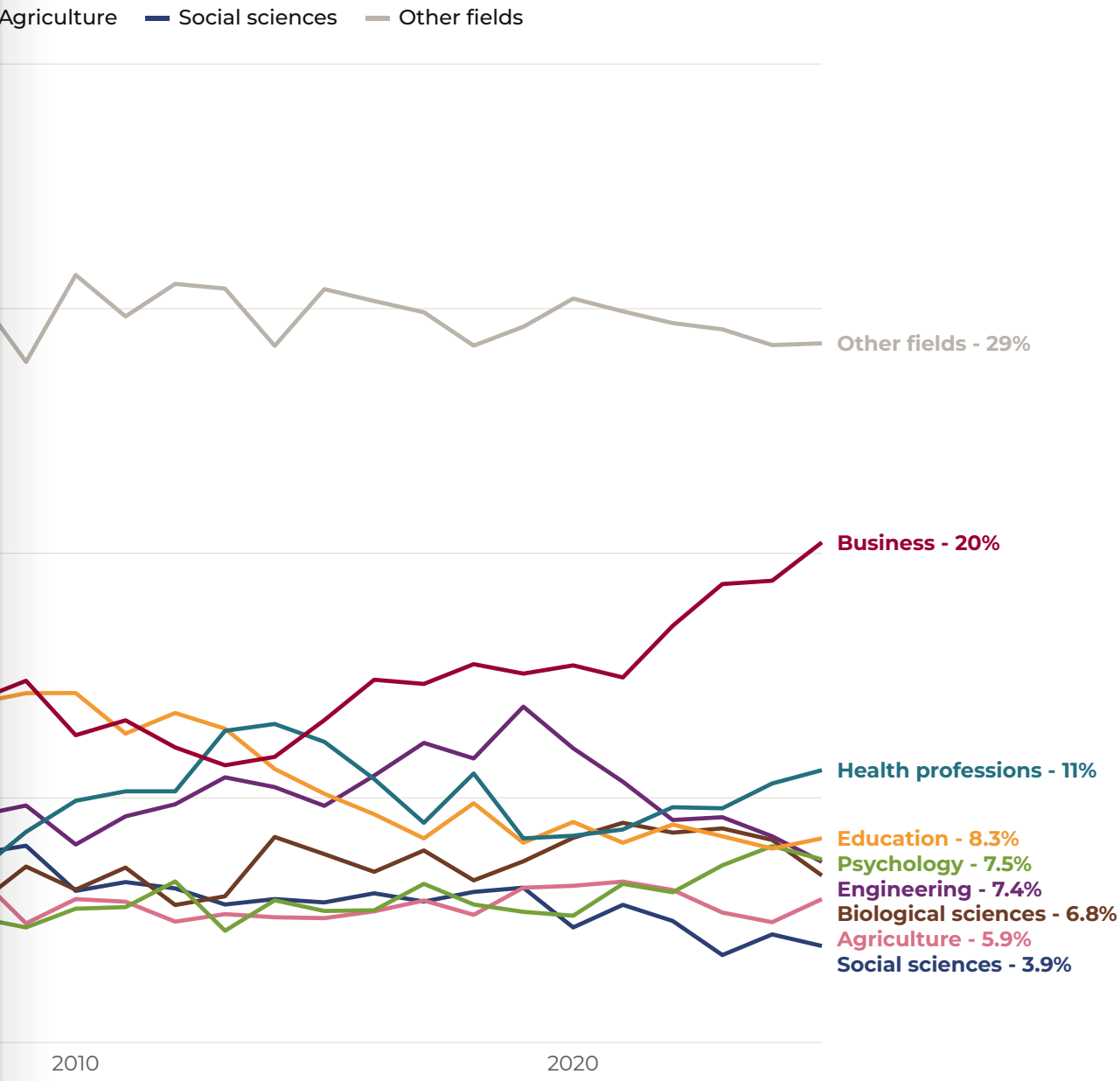
Int. share of CS master's, null

Figure 28 How Has Wyoming's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, business has gained the most ground, 7.3 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while engineering lost the most (2.3 points).



The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is Wyoming Most Specialized?

The location quotient divides a field's share of Wyoming's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 7 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Agriculture (5.71, with 5.9% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 1.0% for the U.S.), education (1.93, with 8.3% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 4.3% for the U.S.), and engineering (1.26, with 7.4% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 5.9% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 5 Where Is Wyoming Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Agriculture	**5.71**	5.9%	1.0%	116
Education	**1.93**	8.3%	4.3%	165
Engineering	**1.26**	7.4%	5.9%	146
Psychology	**1.08**	7.5%	6.9%	148
Business	**1.08**	20%	19%	404
Biological sciences	**1.04**	6.8%	6.6%	135
Health professions	**0.89**	11%	13%	220

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

22%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **33rd** of 51

1.9%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **51st** of 51

7.4%
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **18th** of 51

Engineering & eng. technology. The share was 7.4% in 2025, against 6.8% for the U.S., 18th among the states, down 1.0 point from 8.4% in 2024 and down 2.3 points since 2015, when it was 9.7%.

Health professions. The share was 11% in 2025, against 12% for the U.S., 29th among the states, up 0.5 points from 11% in 2024 and down 1.2 points since 2015, when it was 12%.

Table 6 Wyoming at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
STEM share of bachelor's	23%	23% 2024	**22% 2025**	−1.3 pp	24%	33rd
Bachelor's in computer science	1.2%	1.7% 2024	**1.9% 2025**	+0.6 pp	6.9%	51st
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	9.7%	8.4% 2024	**7.4% 2025**	−2.3 pp	6.8%	18th
Bachelor's in business	13%	19% 2024	**20% 2025**	+7.3 pp	19%	20th

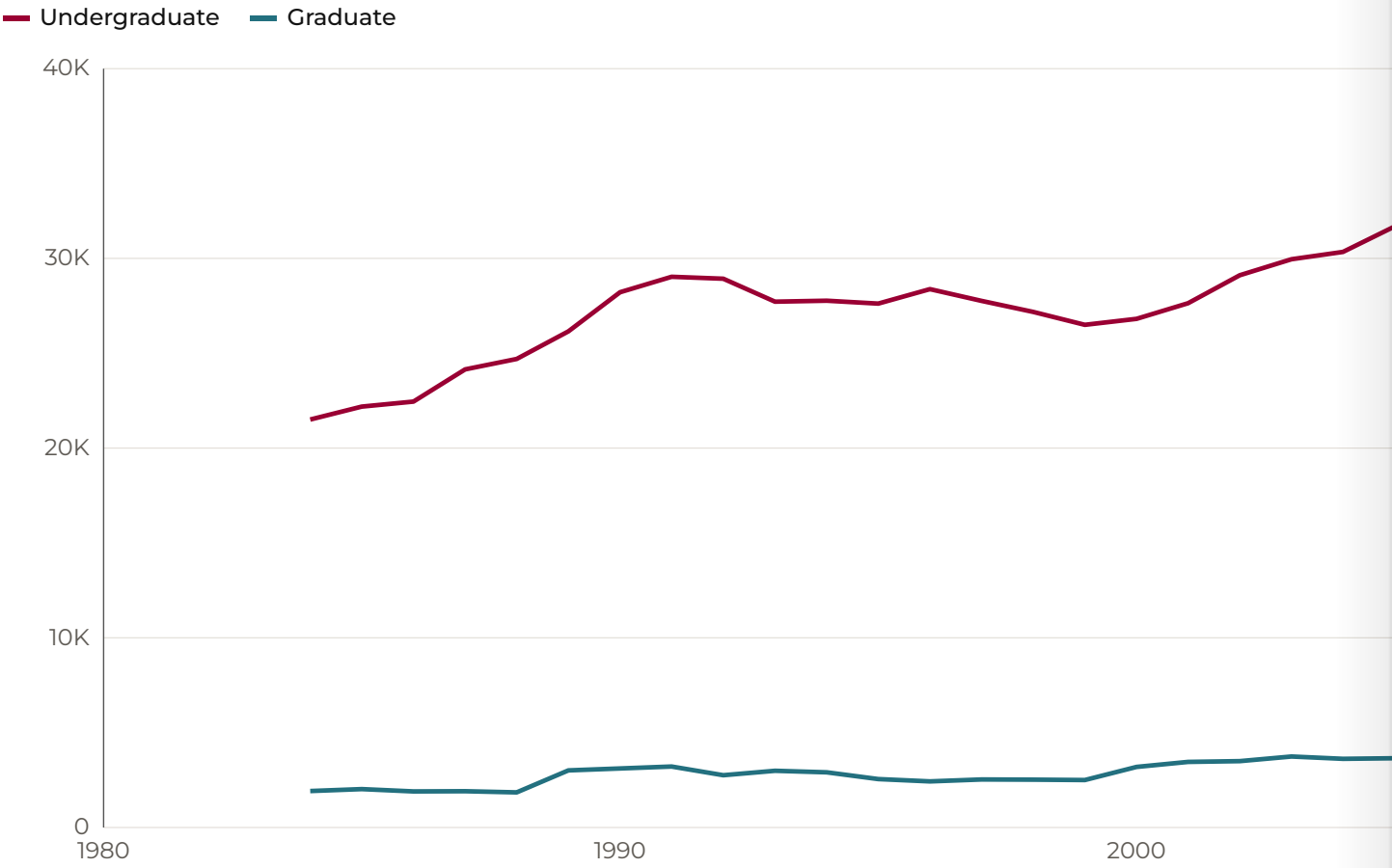
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

Wyoming ranks 50th of 51 on fall enrollment, at 31.1K in 2024 against 19.7M for the U.S.

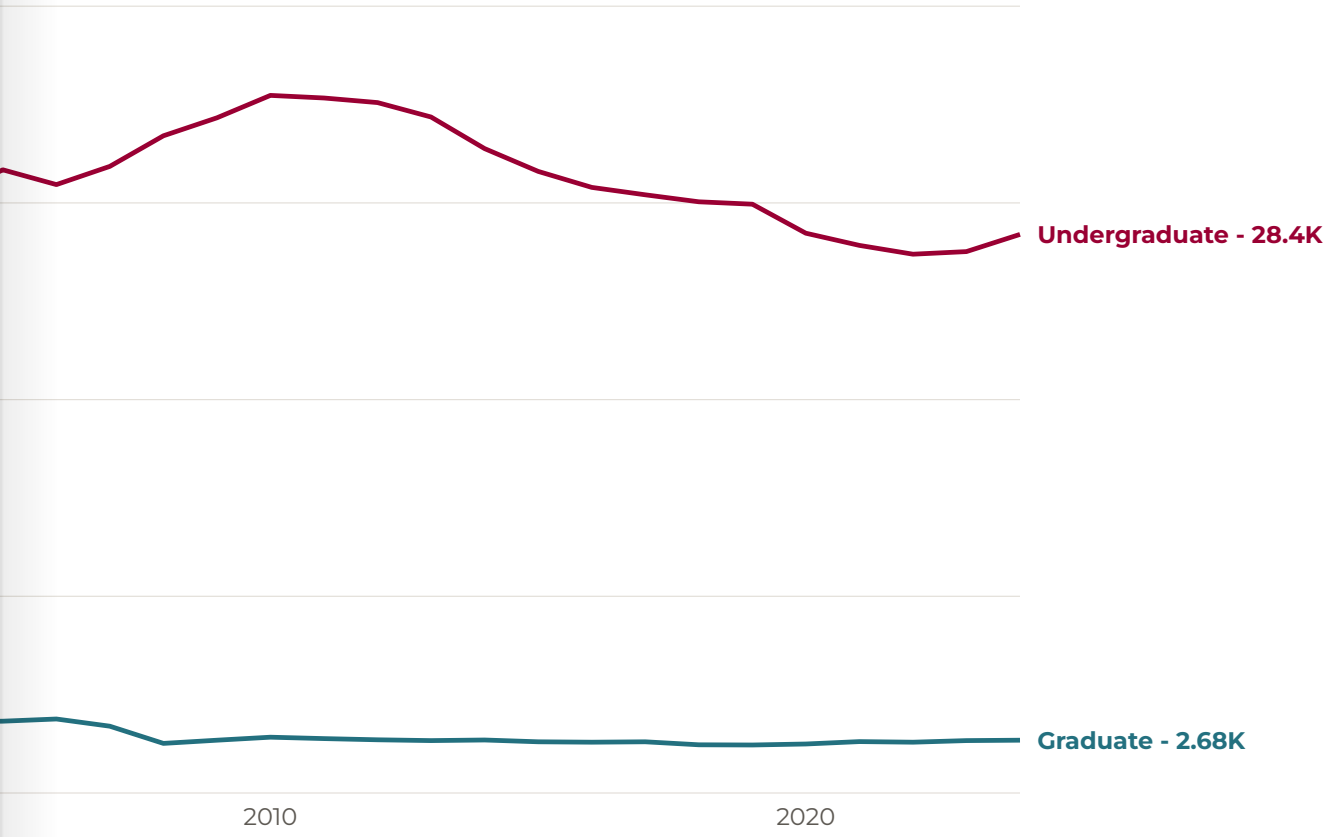
Figure 29 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Wyoming enrolled 28.4K undergraduates and 2.68K graduate students, 31.1K in all (50th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 10% since 2015 and graduate enrollment up 3% since 2015. Graduate students are 8.6% of all students (U.S. 17%).



31.1K

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **50th** of 51 · −9.1% since 2015

8.6%

Graduate share of students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **50th** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2015

46%

Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **9th** of 51 · +1.1 pp since 2015

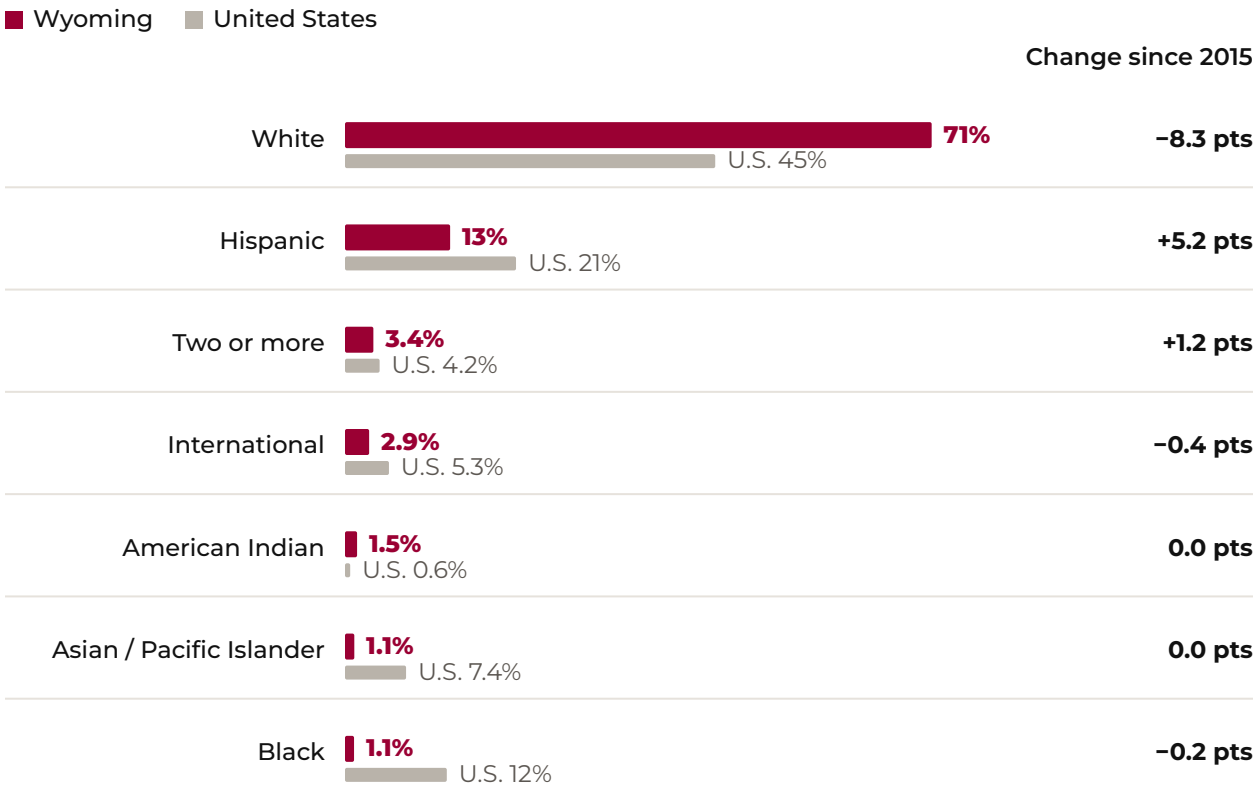
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

Who Enrolls in Wyoming, and Where?

In fall 2024, White students were the largest group at Wyoming's degree-granting institutions, **71%** of enrollment against 45% nationally, down 8.3 points since 2015.

Hispanic students were **13%** (U.S. 21%), up 5.2 points since 2015, and students of two or more races were **3.4%** (U.S. 4.2%), up 1.2 points since 2015.

Figure 30 Who Enrolls in Wyoming?



Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

71%
White students
U.S. **45%** · −8.3 pp since 2015

13%
Hispanic students
U.S. **21%** · +5.2 pp since 2015

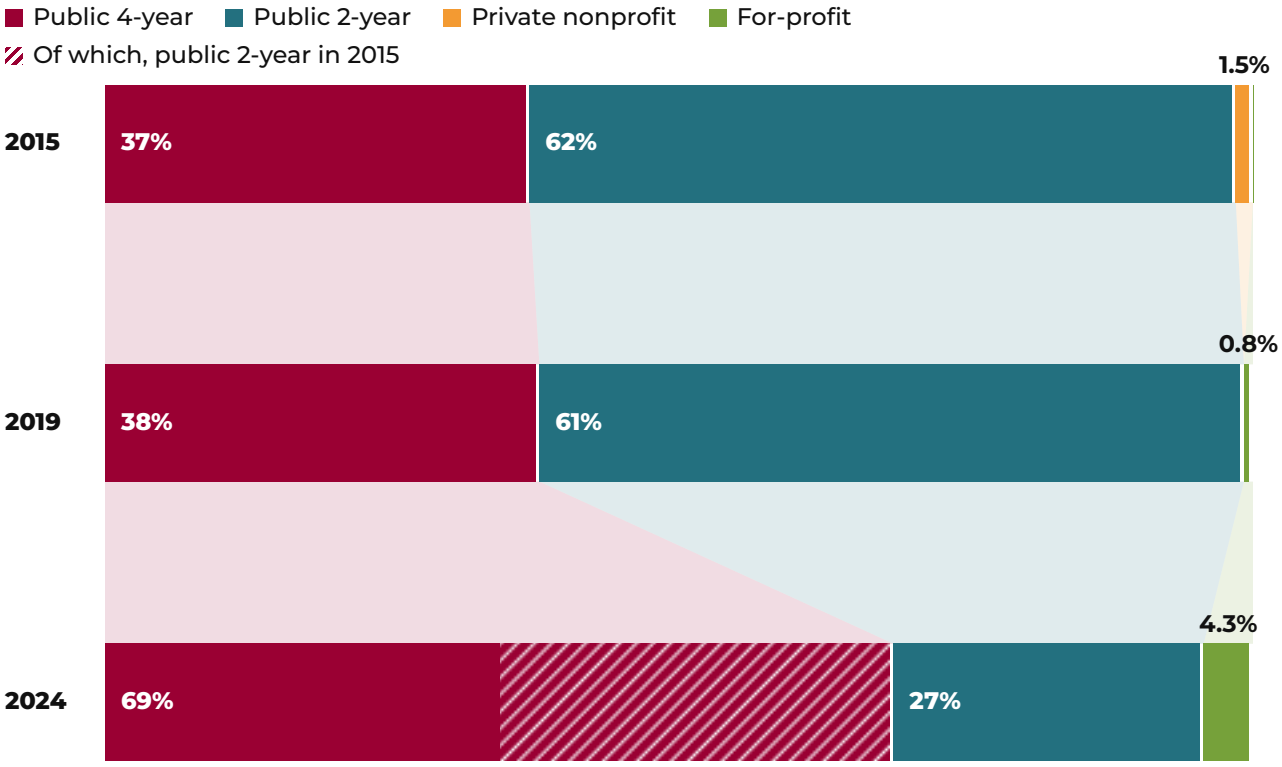
69%
At public 4-year institutions
+31.7 pp since 2015

27%
At public 2-year institutions
−34.5 pp since 2015

In fall 2024, public 4-year institutions enrolled **69%** of students, up 31.7 points from 37% in 2015. Public 2-year institutions enrolled **27%** of students, down 34.5 points from 62% in 2015.

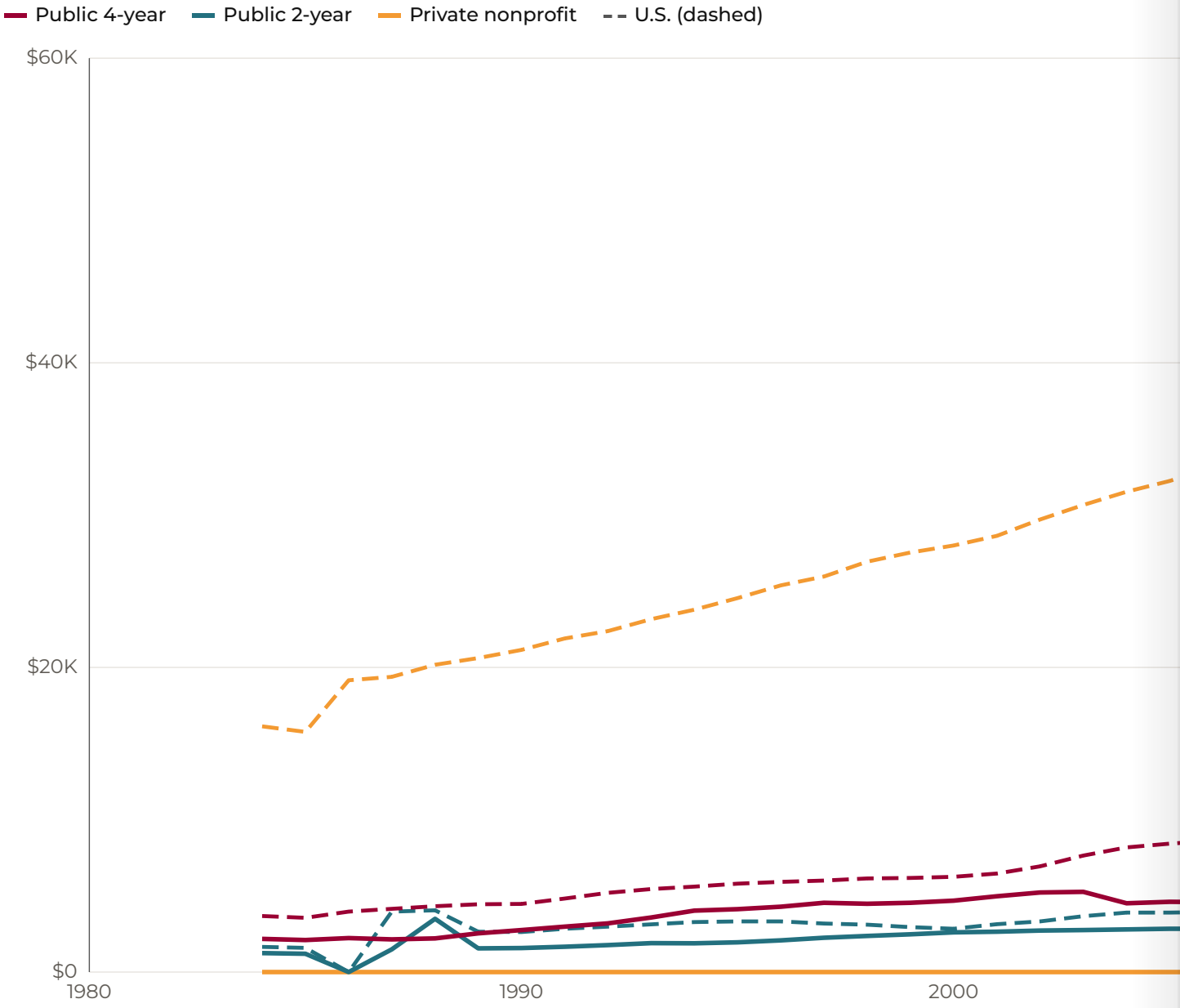
Part of the shift between public sectors is a change of label: 4 community colleges that IPEDS counted as public 2-year in 2015 are counted as public 4-year in 2024 because they began awarding bachelor's degrees. They enrolled **10.5K** students, 34% of the state's total, the largest being Laramie County Community College, Western Wyoming Community College, and Central Wyoming College.

Figure 31 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Sectors as IPEDS classifies them each year; 4 colleges that were public 2-year in 2015 (hatched; 34% of 2024 enrollment) count as public 4-year after they began awarding bachelor's degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

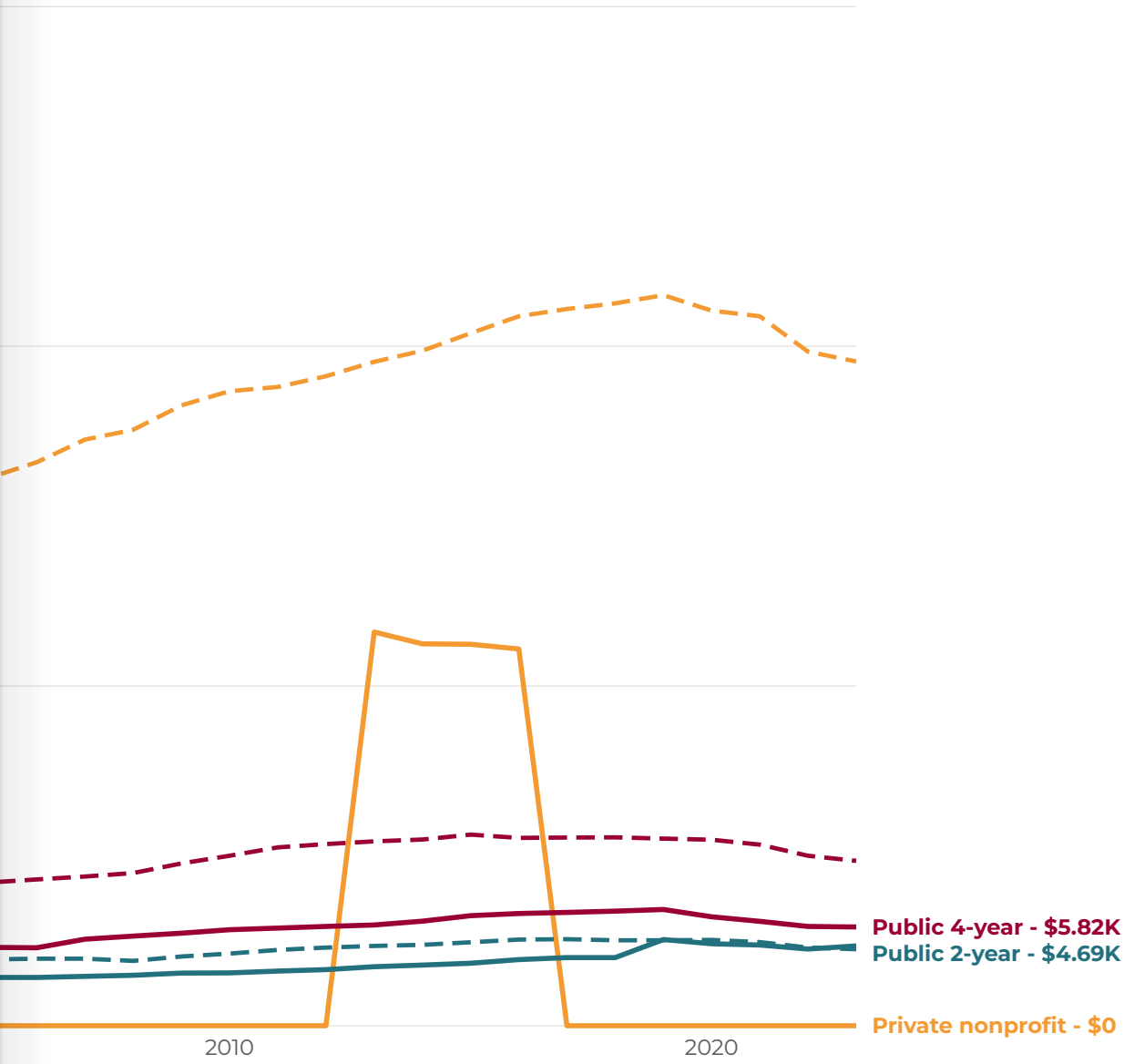
Figure 32 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Wyoming's public four-year institutions are $5.82K (2023, 2024 dollars), 40% below the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 50th of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $21.3K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (4th of 51), and net tuition makes up 22% of net tuition plus state and local appropriations (U.S. 43%).



$5.82K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **50th** of 51 · −10% since 2015

$21.3K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **4th** of 51 · −6.7% since 2015

22%

Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **49th** of 51 · +4.9 pp since 2015

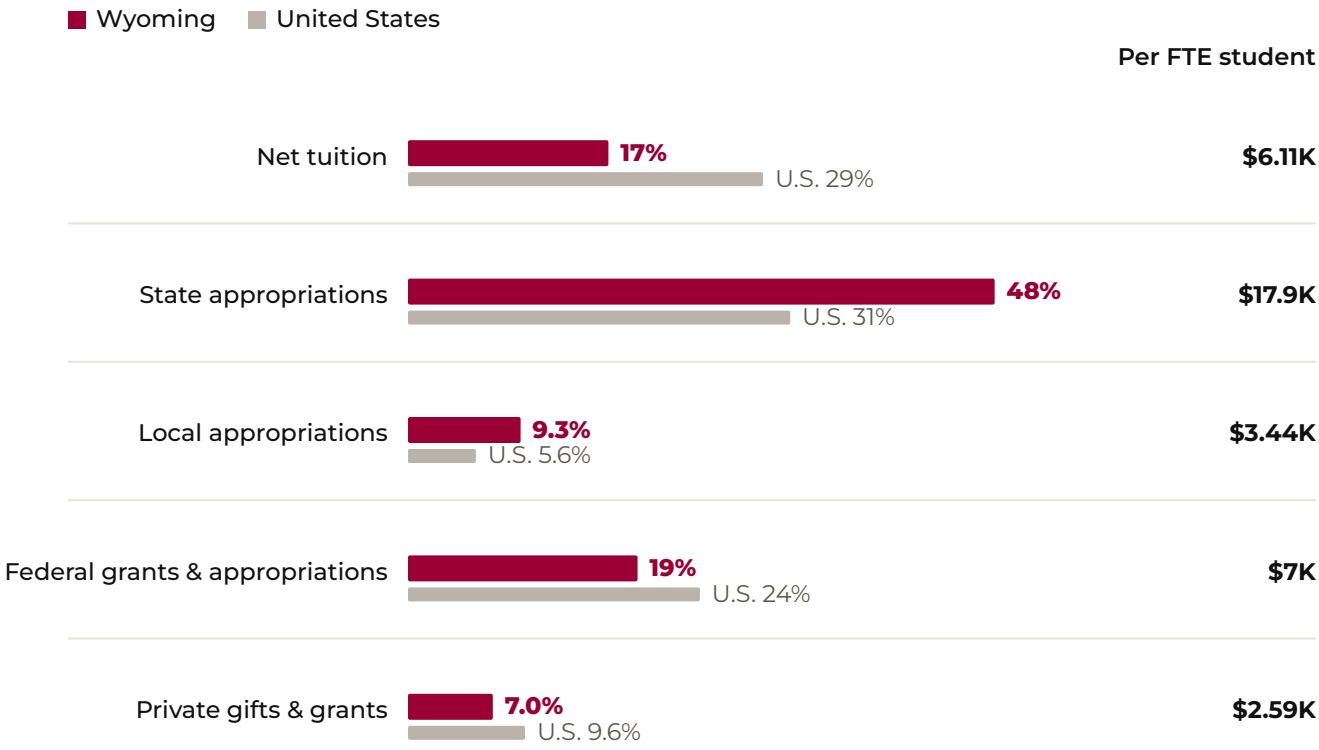
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are Wyoming's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of Wyoming's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $6.11K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., down 2.0% from $6.24K in FY2023 and up 27% since FY2015, when it was $4.8K.

Figure 33 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Shares are of all five sources; the tuition share elsewhere in this profile divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations only. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$5.82K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **50th** of 51

$21.3K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **4th** of 51

22%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **49th** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Wyoming: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $5.82K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 50th among the states, down 0.5% from $5.85K in 2022 and down 10% since 2015, when it was $6.47K.

Table 7 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Wyoming	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$5.82K**	$9.71K	50th of 51	−10%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$21.3K**	$11.4K	4th of 51	−6.7%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations	2024	**22%**	43%	49th of 51	+4.9 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**59%**	65%	34th of 51	+3.4 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$85.4K**	$106K	38th of 51	−11%

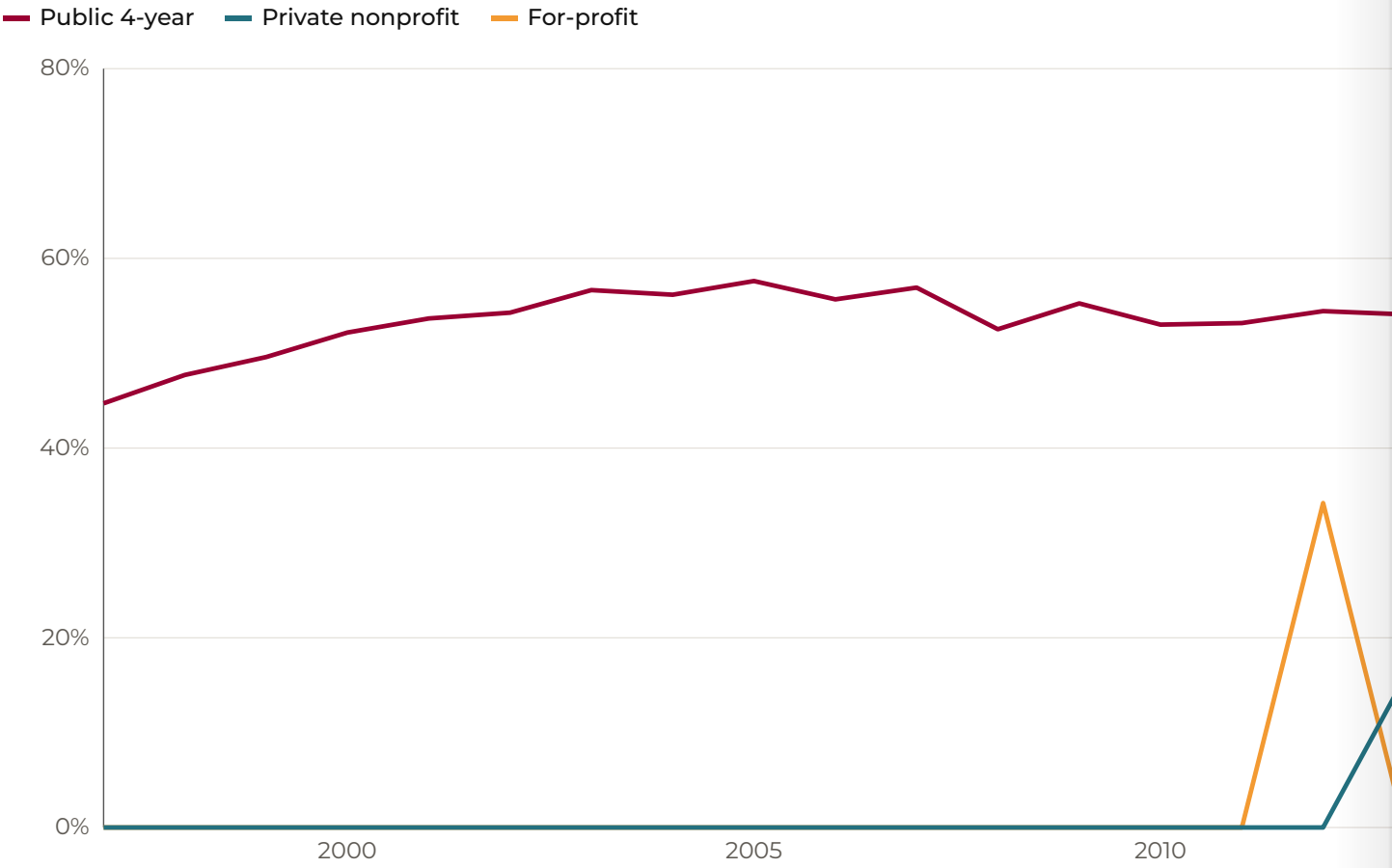
Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

Wyoming ranks 50th of 51 on bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates, at 7.0 in 2025 against 12.3 for the U.S.

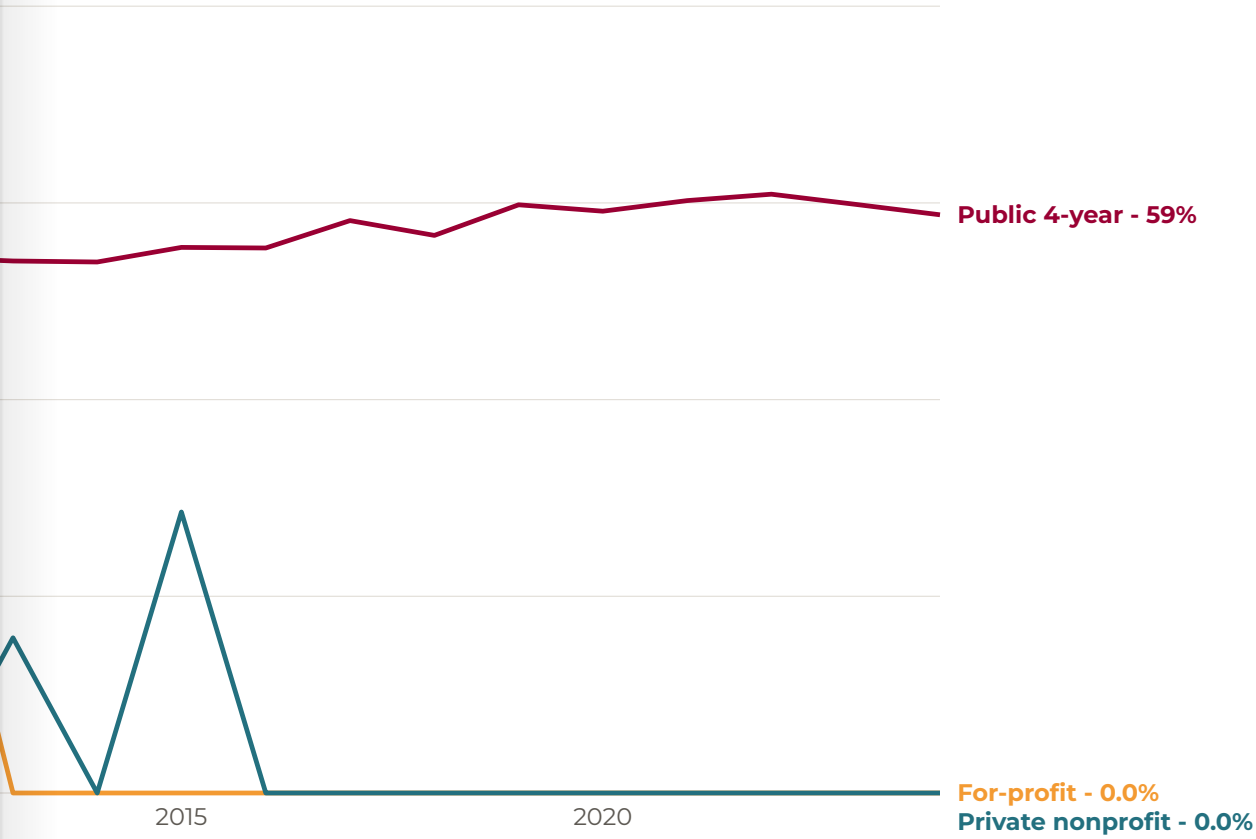
Figure 34 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

59% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Wyoming graduated within six years (2024), 6.0 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 34th of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 59%, private nonprofit 0.0%, for-profit 0.0%. At two-year institutions, 61% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).



59%

Six-year graduation rate, 2024

U.S. **65%** · **34th** of 51 · +3.4 pp since 2015

61%

Two-year completion rate, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **6th** of 50 · +13.9 pp since 2015

7.0

Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025

U.S. **12.3** · **50th** of 51 · +0.8 since 2015

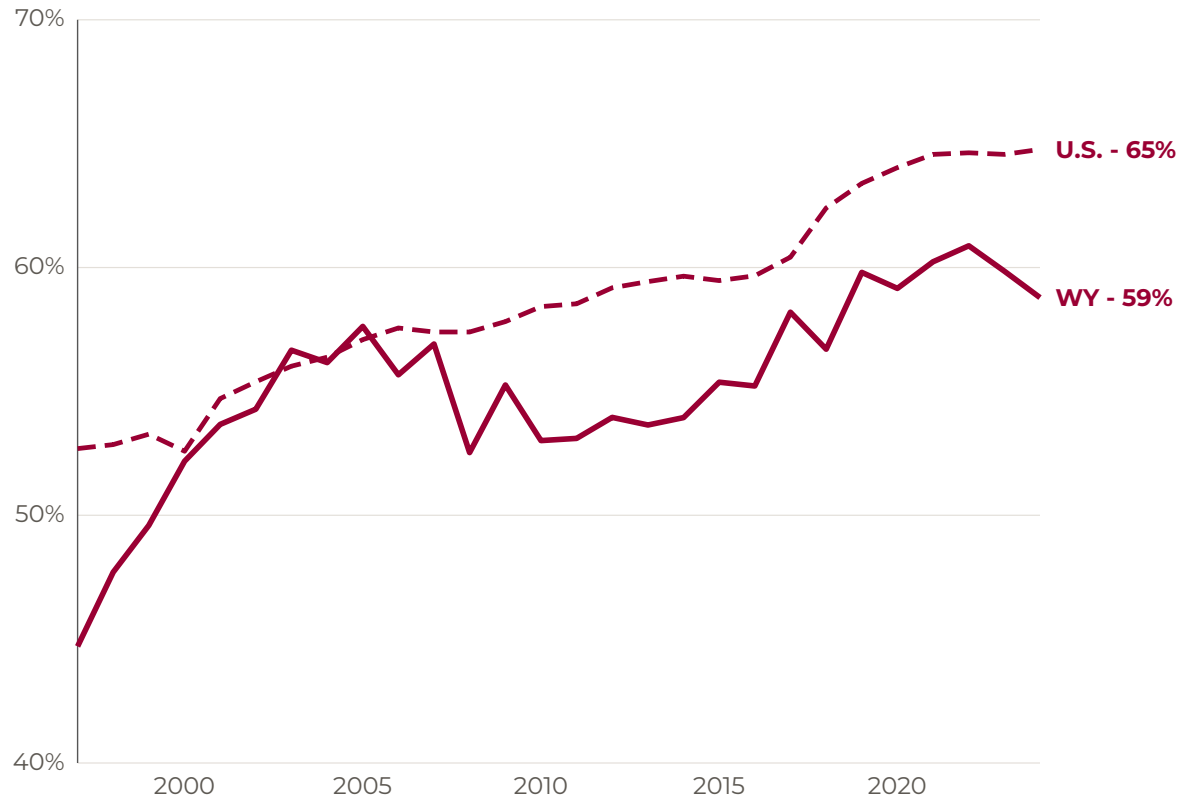
SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

How Many of Wyoming's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Wyoming's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The rate leaves out students who start part-time (46% of the state's students attend part-time, against 39% nationally) and students who transfer and finish elsewhere. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 59% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., down 1.1 points from 60% in 2023 and up 3.4 points since 2015, when it was 55%.

Figure 35 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

59%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **34th** of 51

61%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **6th** of 50

7.0
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **50th** of 51

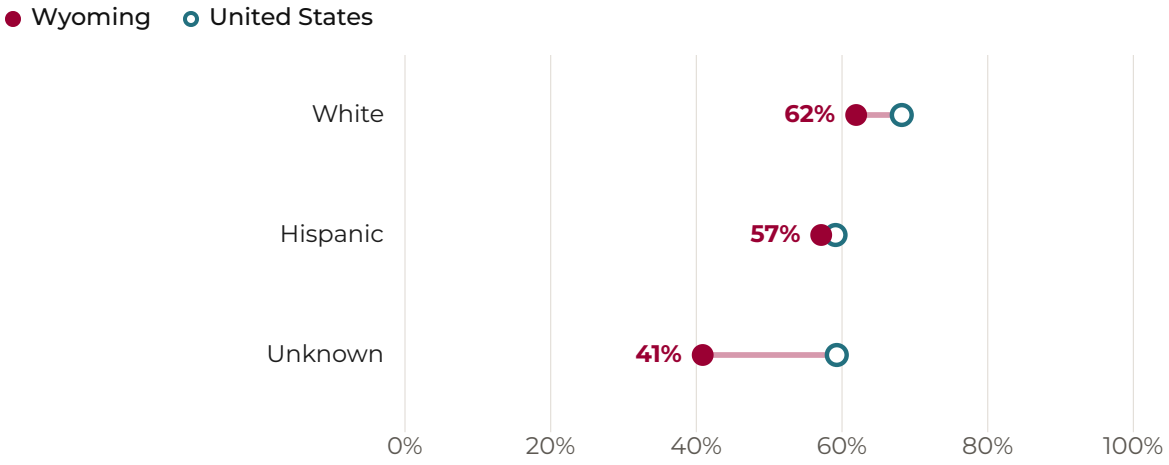
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Wyoming's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 62% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 57% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Students of unknown race. The six-year rate was 41% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Figure 36 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



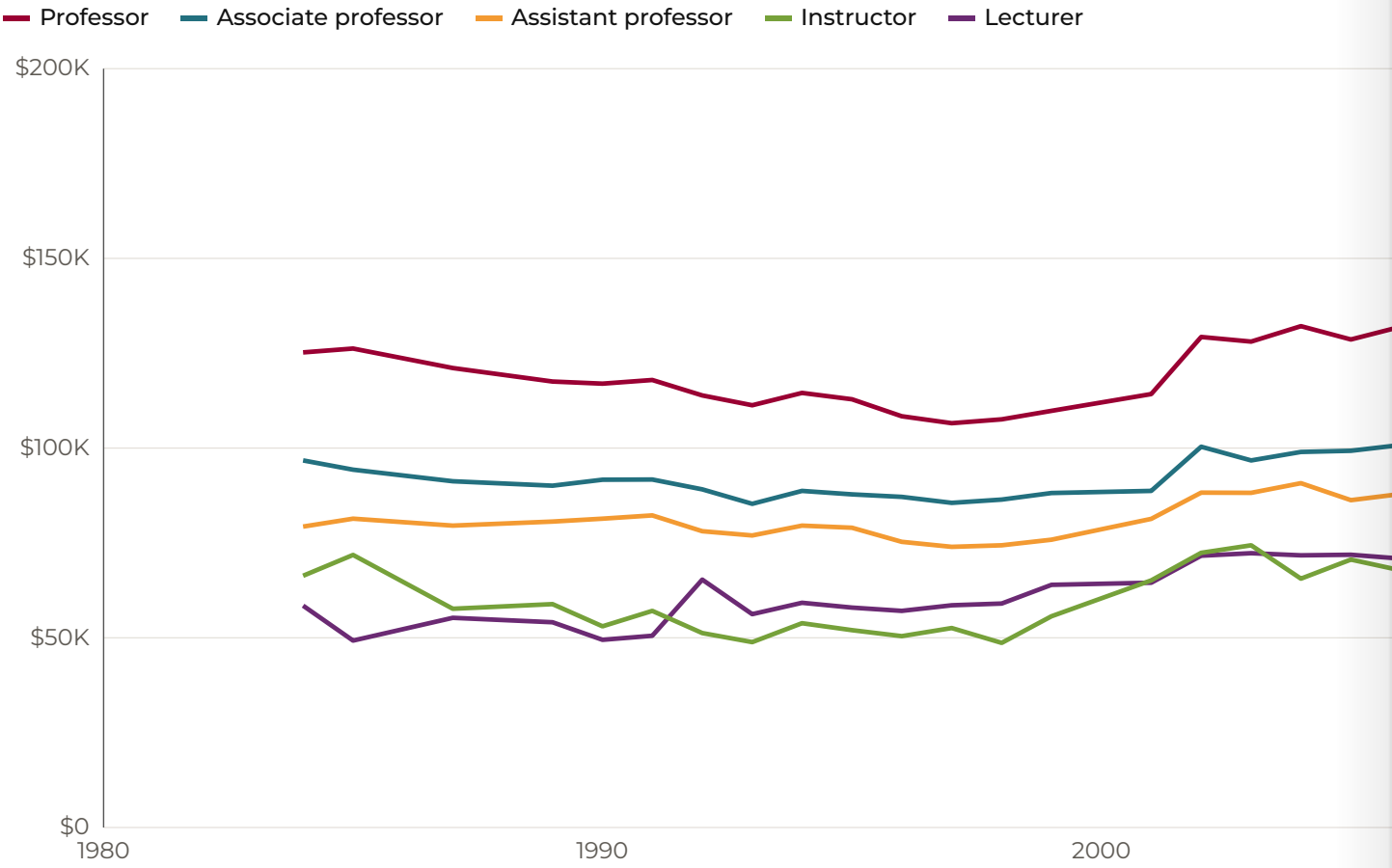
Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 15

Faculty

Wyoming ranks 38th of 51 on the average full-time faculty salary, at $85.4K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

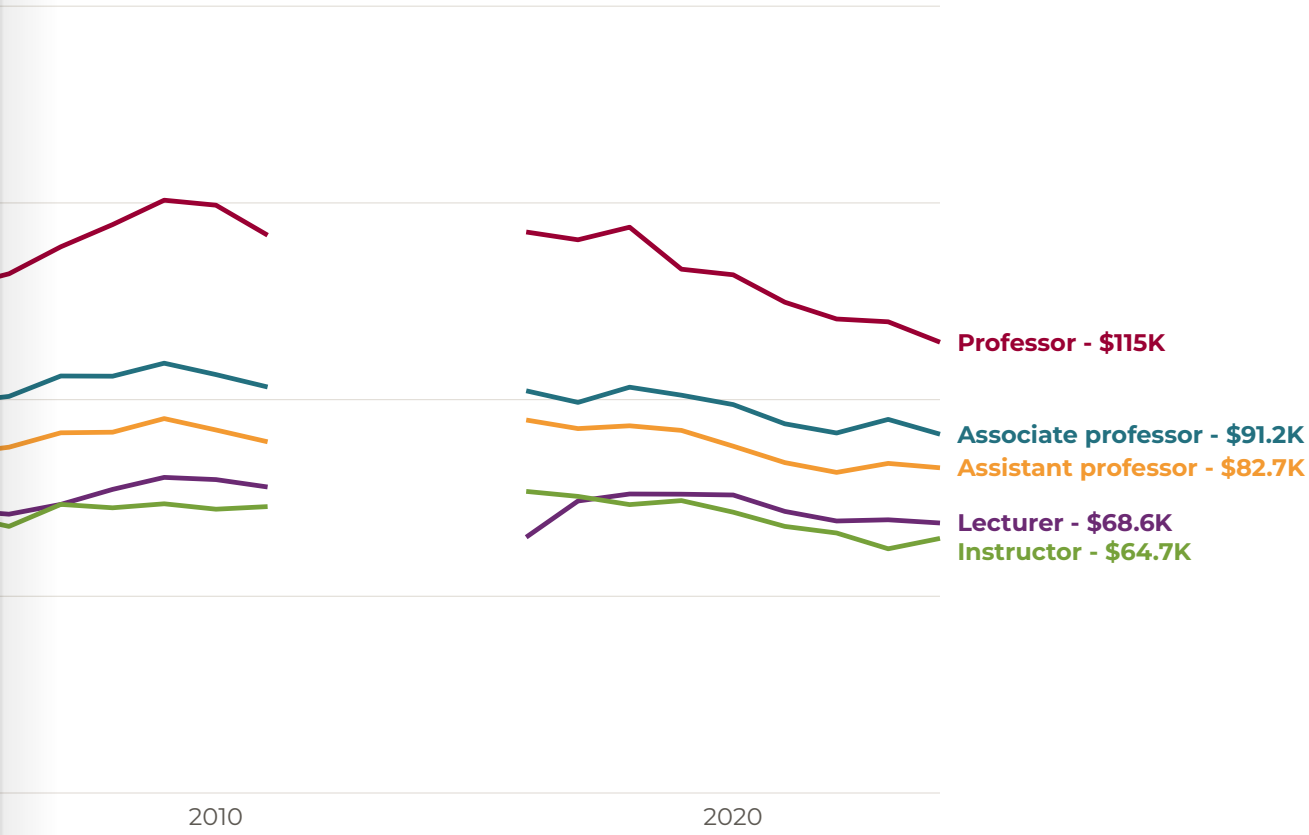
Figure 37 What Do Wyoming's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data fro

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Wyoming's institutions earned an average of $85.4K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 19% below the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 38th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $115K, associate professors $91.2K, assistant professors $82.7K, instructors $64.7K, lecturers $68.6K.

Wyoming's institutions had 1.32K full-time instructional staff in 2024, down 7% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 11% since 2016.



m NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

$85.4K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **38th** of 51 · −11% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

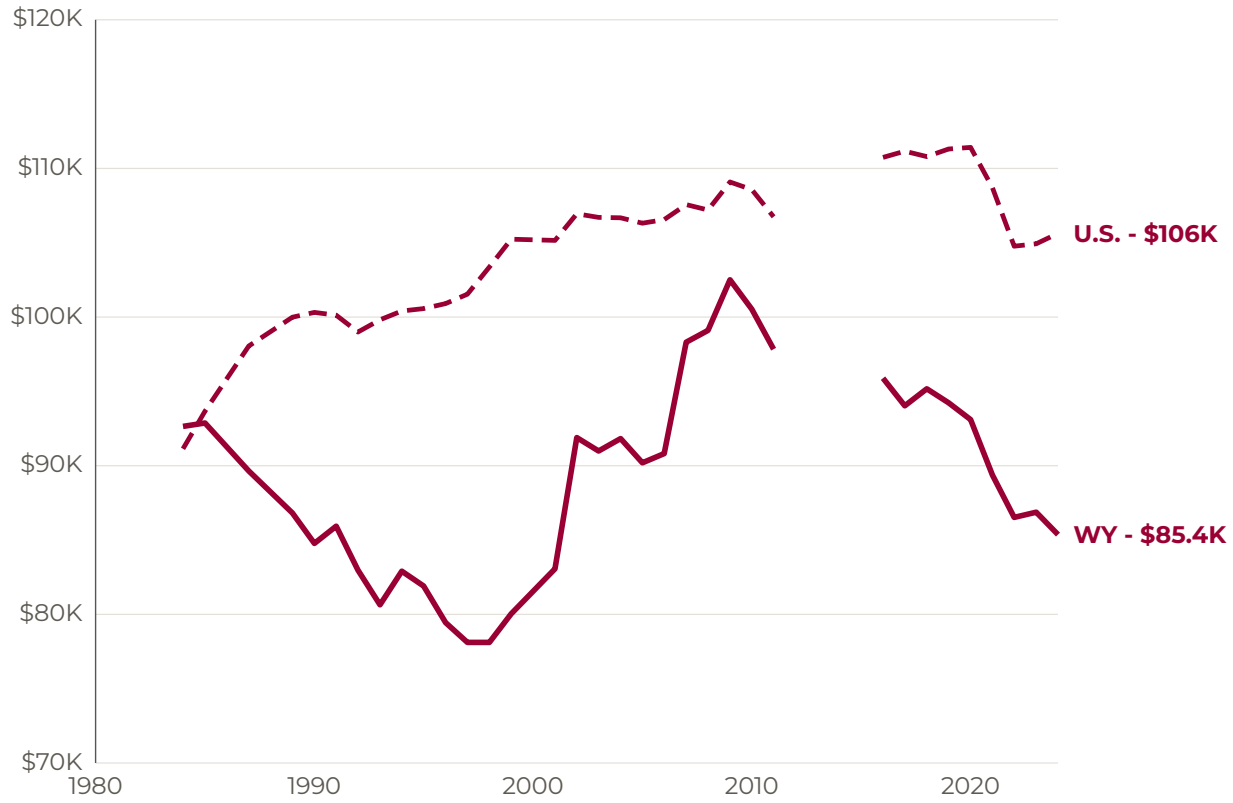
What Do Wyoming's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Wyoming's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $85.4K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 38th among the states, down 1.7% from $86.9K in 2023 and down 11% since 2016, when it was $95.9K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 1.32K in 2024, up 1.0% from 1.31K in 2023 and down 7.2% since 2015, when it was 1.42K.

Figure 38 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$85.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **38th** of 51

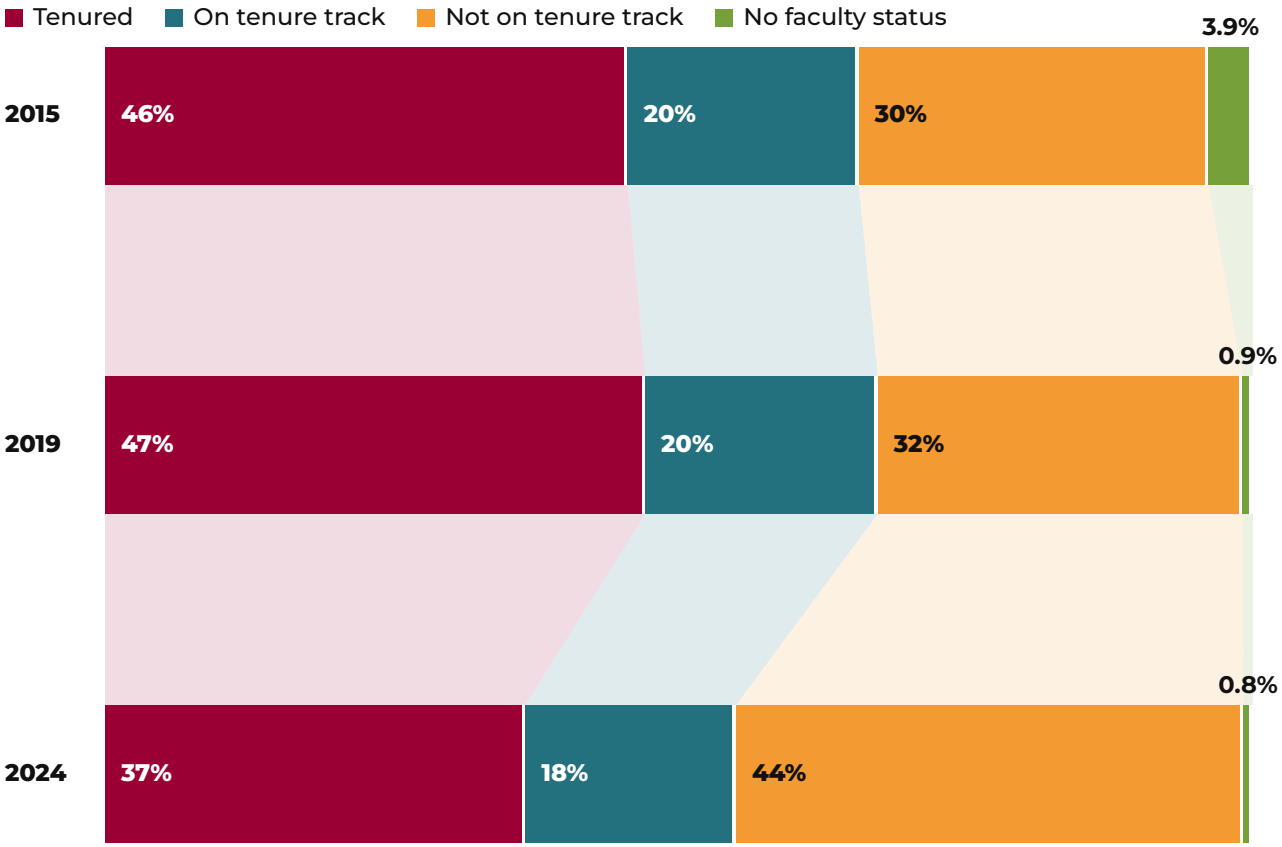
1.32K
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

37%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide Wyoming's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 37% in 2024, down 2.8 points from 39% in 2023 and down 8.9 points since 2015, when it was 46%.

Figure 39 Tenure Status



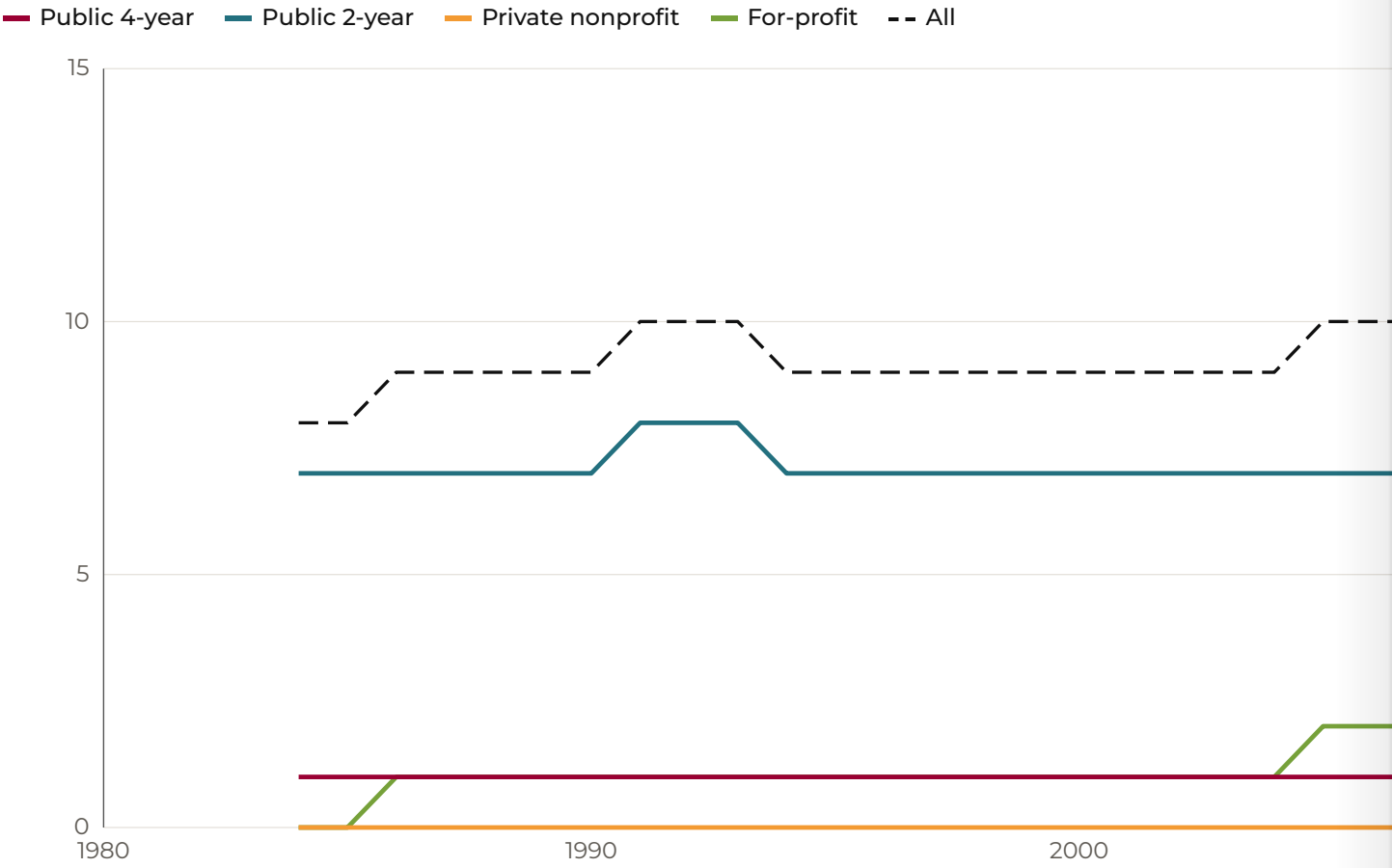
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

Wyoming ranks 2nd of 51 on the share of enrollment at public institutions, at 96% in 2024 against 73% for the U.S.

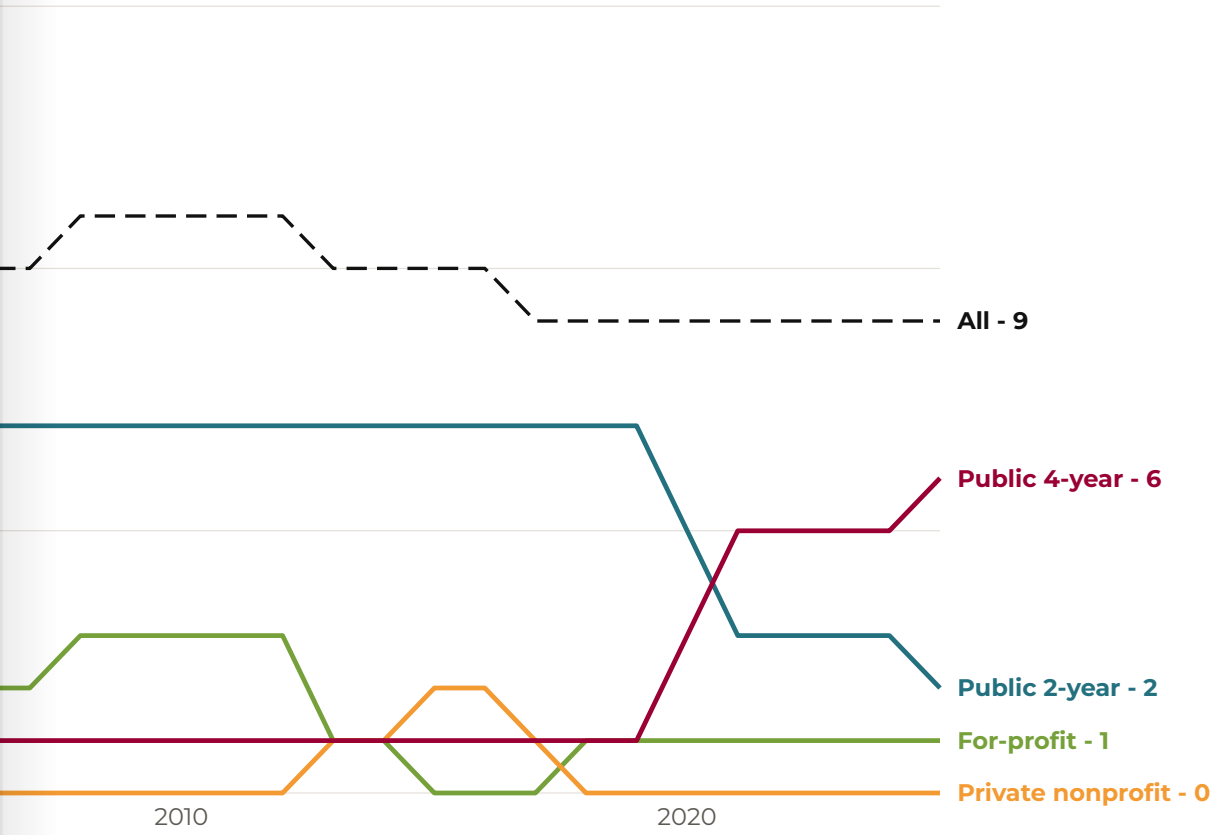
Figure 40 How Many Institutions Does Wyoming Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Wyoming has 9 degree-granting institutions:6 public 4-year, 2 public 2-year, 0 private nonprofit, 1 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 10% since 2015. 96% of students attend public institutions and 4.3% attend for-profit ones.



96%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **2nd** of 51 · −2.8 pp since 2015

4.3%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **14th** of 51 · +4.3 pp since 2015

20%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **41st** of 51 · +7.8 pp since 2015

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in Wyoming?

The table lists Wyoming's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were University of Wyoming (10.8K students), Laramie County Community College (4.19K students), and Northern Wyoming Community College District (3.53K students).

Table 8 What Are Wyoming's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
University of Wyoming	**10.8K**	16%	428	59%	97%
Laramie County Community College	**4.19K**	–	–	–	–
Northern Wyoming Community College District	**3.53K**	–	–	–	–
Casper College	**3.4K**	–	–	–	–
Western Wyoming Community College	**2.65K**	–	–	–	–
Central Wyoming College	**2.21K**	–	–	–	–
Northwest College	**1.49K**	–	–	–	–
Eastern Wyoming College	**1.46K**	–	–	–	–
WyoTech	**1.33K**	–	–	–	–

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

9
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

96%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **2nd** of 51

4.3%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **14th** of 51

20%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **41st** of 51

Share of students at public institutions. The share was 96% in 2024, against 73% for the U.S., 2nd among the states, down 0.3 points from 96% in 2023 and down 2.8 points since 2015, when it was 99%.

Share at for-profit institutions. The share was 4.3% in 2024, against 5.5% for the U.S., 14th among the states, up 0.3 points from 4.0% in 2023 and up 4.3 points since 2015, when it was 0.0%.

Table 9 Wyoming at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
Students at public institutions	99%	96% 2023	**96% 2024**	−2.8 pp	73%	2nd
Students at for-profit institutions	0.0%	4.0% 2023	**4.3% 2024**	+4.3 pp	5.5%	14th
Students fully online	12%	19% 2023	**20% 2024**	+7.8 pp	27%	41st

Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

Tuition, appropriations, revenue and faculty salaries are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Research funding (HERD, Federal Funds, USAspending), wages and the NAFSA economic contribution are nominal dollars, and are labeled so. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions; the tuition share divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts. Year-to-year comparisons use one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November).

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally: a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size.

Sources

IPEDS (National Center for Education Statistics) is the backbone: Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. The profile also draws on NAEP, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates, Survey of Earned Doctorates, HERD and Federal Funds surveys, USAspending.gov, DHS SEVIS by the Numbers and ICE SEVIS releases, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification and BLS wage data, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, USPTO PatentsView, and other federal sources; every figure names its source, and the Sources page lists them in full. Generated November 2026.

NOTES

How the Numbers Are Counted

Ranks

Ranks are among the 50 states and the District of Columbia (1 = highest value, whether or not a high value is good). Where fewer than 51 report, the count is given ("23rd of 33").

Sectors

Sectors are as IPEDS classifies institutions each year. IPEDS moves a whole institution to "public, 4-year or above" once it awards any bachelor's degree, so community colleges that began offering applied bachelor's degrees carry all of their students into the public 4-year sector. In Wyoming, 4 institutions counted as public 2-year in 2015 are counted as public 4-year in 2024; they enrolled 10.5K students (34% of the state's total, 49% of its public 4-year enrollment). Sector series (enrollment shares, public 4-year tuition, graduation rates by sector) reflect these moves.

Research doctorates

Two counts appear. IPEDS counts degrees institutions report as "doctor's degree, research/scholarship", which includes some practice-oriented degrees such as many Ed.D.s; the NSF Survey of Earned Doctorates counts research doctorate recipients and is smaller. Each figure names which it uses. "STEM master's per STEM research doctorate" divides IPEDS STEM master's degrees by IPEDS STEM research doctorates.

Engineering

"Engineering" alone is CIP 14. Where engineering technology (CIP 15) is added, the label says "engineering & eng. technology".

Graduation rates

IPEDS graduation rates follow first-time, full-time students and count only those who finish at the institution where they started, so they leave out part-time starters and students who transfer and finish elsewhere.

International students in SEVIS

SEVIS counts active F-1 and M-1 records, which include graduates on Optional Practical Training (up to 36 months for STEM graduates, 12 for others), so STEM shares run high. STEM follows the DHS STEM Designated Degree Program List, which is broader than the eight CIP families above, and DHS draws its STEM pages on a different basis from its all-student pages, so a country's STEM count can exceed its all-level count.

Visas and green cards

DOL labor condition applications (H-1B positions) are counted by worksite and include renewals and job changes; USCIS approvals are counted by the employer's address and split into new and continuing. PERM certifications are the employer's step toward a green card.

Patents

Patents are counted by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live; a company headquartered in another state takes its patents there.

Years

Each measure uses its latest year, so years differ across a page; every figure, table and statement gives its year, and lines that stop early are labeled with their last year.

Wyoming – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	287	**278**[2024]	−8.4 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#12	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	35%	**30%**[2024]	−5.2 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#19	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	247	**243**[2024]	−3.4 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#3	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	48%	**46%**[2024]	−2.8 pp ▼	39%	0.0 pp	#2	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	269	**260**[2024]	−8.8 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#15	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	36%	**29%**[2024]	−6.6 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#21	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	228	**222**[2024]	−6.2 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#2	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**160**[2015]	–	153	–	#10	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$21K	**$21.3K**[2021]	+1.7% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#12	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	79%	**82%**[2022]	+3.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#40	[3]
Public high school graduates	5.57K	**6.34K**[2024]	+14% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#49	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$75.1K	**$66.8K**[2022]	−11% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#22	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	12.4	**12.6**[2022]	+0.2 ▲	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#42	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	94.7K	**89.9K**[2024]	−5.1% ▼	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#50	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	38%	**35%**[2023]	−3.1 pp ▼	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#43	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	3.5%	**2.7%**[2022]	−0.8 pp ▼	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#48	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	0.5%	**0.7%**[2023]	+0.2 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#39	[3]
High schools offering calculus	48%[2016]	**41%**[2024]	−7.2 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#38	[14]
High schools offering physics	64%[2016]	**57%**[2024]	−7.2 pp ▼	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#33	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	76%[2016]	**76%**[2024]	+0.5 pp ▲	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#38	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	90%[2016]	**89%**[2024]	−1.5 pp ▼	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#29	[14]
High schools offering computer science	49%[2021]	**65%**[2024]	+15.1 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#24	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	32%[2016]	**40%**[2024]	+7.4 pp ▲	56%	0.0 pp	#42	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	9.4%[2021]	**14%**[2024]	+4.2 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#38	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

WYOMING – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	70%[2016]	**80%[2024]**	+10.2 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#21	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	10.1[2016]	**11.9[2024]**	+1.8 ▲	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#41	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	3.8[2016]	**2.2[2024]**	−1.5 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#38	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	9.3[2016]	**9.3[2024]**	0.0	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#21	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	22.7[2016]	**28.2[2024]**	+5.4 ▲	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#7	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	4.0[2016]	**2.2[2024]**	−1.8 ▼	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#40	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	22%	**36%[2025]**	+13.6 pp ▲	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#20	[15]
Fall enrollment	34.2K	**31.1K[2024]**	−9.1% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#50	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	99%	**96%[2024]**	−2.8 pp ▼	73%	0.0 pp	#2	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	0.0%	**4.3%[2024]**	+4.3 pp ▲	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#14	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	45%	**46%[2024]**	+1.1 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#9	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	7.6%	**8.6%[2024]**	+1.0 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#50	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	12%	**20%[2024]**	+7.8 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#41	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	85	**81[2025]**	−4.7% ▼	59K	+7.3% ▲	#50	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	70	**67[2025]**	−4.3% ▼	44.4K	+14% ▲	#50	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	0.2%	**0.1%[2025]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#50	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	8	**12[2025]**	–	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#48	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	10	**5[2025]**	–	5.07K	+33% ▲	#47	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	1.9	**1.8[2025]**	0.0	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#51	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	23%	**22%[2025]**	−1.3 pp ▼	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#33	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	1.2%	**1.9%[2025]**	+0.6 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#51	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	9.7%	**7.4%[2025]**	−2.3 pp ▼	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#18	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	1.1%	**0.7%[2025]**	−0.5 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#36	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

WYOMING – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	7.7%	**6.8%**[2025]	−0.9 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#20	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	3.2%	**2.3%**[2025]	−0.9 pp ▼	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#2	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	12%	**11%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#29	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	13%	**20%**[2025]	+7.3 pp ▲	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#20	[4]
STEM share of master's	19%	**17%**[2025]	−2.4 pp ▼	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#34	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	2.4%	**0.9%**[2025]	−1.5 pp ▼	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#50	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	7.6%	**5.5%**[2025]	−2.0 pp ▼	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#27	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	1.3%	**1.6%**[2025]	+0.3 pp ▲	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#13	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	2.4%	**2.9%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#16	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	4.8%	**4.7%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#1	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	6.0%	**8.4%**[2025]	+2.4 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#49	[4]
Share of master's in business	12%	**26%**[2025]	+13.2 pp ▲	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#9	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	52%	**58%**[2025]	+6.5 pp ▲	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#3	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	1.1%	**3.2%**[2025]	+2.2 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#27	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	7.5%	**8.6%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#43	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	6.5%	**2.2%**[2025]	−4.3 pp ▼	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#28	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	23%	**24%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#2	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	14%	**20%**[2025]	+6.5 pp ▲	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#2	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#50	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	6.5%	**3.2%**[2025]	−3.2 pp ▼	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#29	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	6.2	**7.0**[2025]	+0.8 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#50	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	2.3%[2016]	**3.6%**[2024]	+1.3 pp ▲	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#14	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	30	**37**[2025]	–	117K	2.18× ▲	#48	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	0.1%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#48	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

WYOMING – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	2.2%	**1.7%**[2024]	−0.6 pp ▼	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#42	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	16%	**16%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#18	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	3.4%	**1.2%**[2025]	−2.2 pp ▼	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#50	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	8.6%	**1.9%**[2025]	−6.7 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#48	[4]
International share of all master's	14%	**14%**[2025]	−0.5 pp ▼	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#27	[4]
International share of STEM master's	33%	**37%**[2025]	+4.0 pp ▲	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#33	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	34%	**59%**[2025]	+25.1 pp ▲	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#8	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	–	**0.0%**[1998]	–	28%	–	#33	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	–	**3.1%**[2002]	–	13%	–	#37	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	–	**13%**[2017]	–	30%	–	#37	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	31%	**29%**[2025]	−2.2 pp ▼	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#18	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	40%	**37%**[2025]	−2.5 pp ▼	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#36	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	1.05K	**964**[2026]	−7.8% ▼	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#49	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.1%	**0.1%**[2026]	0.0 pp	–	–	#49	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	7.9%	**3.9%**[2026]	−4.0 pp ▼	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#50	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	19%	**4.1%**[2026]	−15.1 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#42	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	27%	**19%**[2026]	−8.5 pp ▼	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#49	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	106	**96**[2026]	−9.4% ▼	219	−2.7% ▼	#49	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	646	**594**[2026]	−8.0% ▼	749K	+61% ▲	#49	[20]
Active STEM master's students	86	**176**[2026]	2.05× ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#48	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	257	**289**[2026]	+12% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#46	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	34%	**27%**[2026]	−6.4 pp ▼	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#49	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	440[2017]	**549**[2024]	+25% ▲	–	–	#47	[1]
Economic contribution of international students, nominal dollars	$25.8M[2018]	**$25.5M**[2024]	−1.2% ▼	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#50	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	211[2018]	**160**[2024]	−24% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#50	[2]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

WYOMING – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.0%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.3%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#45	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	2.36K	**1.98K**[2025]	−16% ▼	275K	−14% ▼	#34	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	1.02K	**975**[2016]	−4.1% ▼	620K	+0.4% ▲	#49	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	321	**281**[2016]	−12% ▼	241K	+2.3% ▲	#47	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	32%	**29%**[2016]	−2.7 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#35	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	51%	**43%**[2016]	−7.5 pp ▼	57%	0.0 pp	#38	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	54	**60**[2016]	+11% ▲	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#48	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	44%	**50%**[2016]	+5.6 pp ▲	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#32	[9]
University R&D spending, nominal dollars	$57M	**$167M**[2024]	2.94× ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#50	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#50	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	86%	**44%**[2024]	−41.8 pp ▼	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#46	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	3.5%	**2.2%**[2024]	−1.3 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#41	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	5.9%	**4.8%**[2024]	−1.1 pp ▼	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#27	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science, nominal dollars	$1.65M	**$5.16M**[2024]	3.13× ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#48	[6]
University R&D in engineering, nominal dollars	$5.57M	**$32.8M**[2024]	5.89× ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#48	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	1.19K	**1.67K**[2024]	+40% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#51	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$53.5M	**$111M**[2024]	2.08× ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#51	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state, nominal dollars	$32.1M	**$88.5M**[2024]	2.76× ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#48	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$3.64M	**$1.06M**[2024]	−71% ▼	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#51	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$10.4M	**$10.3M**[2024]	−0.3% ▼	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#51	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state, nominal dollars	$27.7M	**$40.7M**[2025]	+47% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#51	[19]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

WYOMING – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state, nominal dollars	$4.54M	**$2.04M[2026]**	−2.5 ▼	$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#51	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$53.8K[2020]	**$55K[2022]**	+2.4% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#7	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$47.9K[2025]**	–	$47.5K	–	#30	[15]
Median debt of completers, nominal dollars	$10.5K	**$11K[2024]**	+5.1% ▲	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#51	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$47.3K[2025]**	–	$68.2K	–	#50	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$47.8K[2025]**	–	$51.9K	–	#36	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$58.8K[2025]**	–	$68.1K	–	#49	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	55%	**59%[2024]**	+3.4 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#34	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	47%	**61%[2024]**	+13.9 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#6	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$6.47K	**$5.82K[2023]**	−10% ▼	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#50	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$22.9K	**$21.3K[2024]**	−6.7% ▼	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#4	[4]
Net tuition share of tuition plus state and local appropriations, public institutions	17%	**22%[2024]**	+4.9 pp ▲	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#49	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$95.9K[2016]	**$85.4K[2024]**	−11% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#38	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	23%	**34%[2016]**	+10.4 pp ▲	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#29	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	33%	**31%[2016]**	−2.3 pp ▼	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#43	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	23%	**33%[2016]**	+10.6 pp ▲	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#25	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	19%	**24%[2016]**	+5.5 pp ▲	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#31	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	1.03	**0.90[2016]**	−0.1 ▼	1.00	0.0	#23	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	27	**15[2016]**	–	41.2K	+51% ▲	#50	[21]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	53%[2016]	**57%[2019]**	+4.7 pp ▲	72%	−0.1 pp ▼	#23	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**43%[2016]**	–	65%	–	#32	[11]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

WYOMING – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 10 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**45%[2010]**	–	64%	–	#30	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	45%[2016]	**49%[2019]**	+3.6 pp ▲	67%	+1.5 pp ▲	#26	[11]
Master's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**51%[2016]**	–	66%	–	#30	[11]
Doctoral graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**39%[2016]**	–	49%	–	#28	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$46.3K[2016]	**$45.4K[2019]**	−1.8% ▼	$48.1K	+2.3% ▲	#22	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$62.2K[2016]**	–	$67.3K	–	#26	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$54.9K[2016]	**$51.6K[2019]**	−6.0% ▼	$59.3K	+0.1% ▲	#32	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	−26.9	**+3.9[2025]**	+30.8 ▲	–	–	#17	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	−1.74K	**+133[2025]**	+1,877.0 ▲	–	–	#29	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	5.3%	**4.1%[2025]**	−1.2 pp ▼	–	–	#5	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	8.0%	**3.7%[2025]**	−4.3 pp ▼	–	–	#7	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	880	**748[2025]**	−15% ▼	–	–	#48	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	68%[2016]	**65%[2024]**	−3.4 pp ▼	–	–	#36	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	+8[2016]	**+6[2024]**	−2.2 ▼	–	–	#26	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	25%[2016]	**27%[2022]**	+1.6 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#20	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	189	**258[2025]**	+37% ▲	914K	−24% ▼	#51	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.0%	**0.0%[2025]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	47%	**61%[2025]**	+14.2 pp ▲	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#30	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$70K	**$82.8K[2025]**	+18% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#46	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	4.2%	**8.9%[2025]**	+4.7 pp ▲	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#41	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	13	**51[2025]**	–	138K	+75% ▲	#51	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	38%	**12%[2024]**	−26.7 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#44	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	0.0%	**7.1%[2024]**	+7.1 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#37	[17]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

WYOMING – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	31%	**12%**[2024]	−19.0 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#48	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	17%	**9.8%**[2025]	−6.9 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#47	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$92K	**$35K**[2025]	−62% ▼	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#47	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	539	**510**[2024]	−5.4% ▼	1.36M	+30% ▲	#51	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.1%	**0.0%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	257	**210**[2024]	−18% ▼	819K	+12% ▲	#51	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.0%	**0.0%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.0%	**0.0%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.0%	**0.0%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.0%	**0.1%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#47	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.0%	**0.0%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#48	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	24	**131**[2026]	–	127K	+14% ▲	#45	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	26	**64**[2026]	–	268K	+52% ▲	#51	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.0%	**0.1%**[2026]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#45	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	14%	**59%**[2026]	+44.9 pp ▲	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#1	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	46%	**7.6%**[2026]	−38.2 pp ▼	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#44	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	25%	**75%**[2026]	+49.8 pp ▲	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#1	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	67%	**46%**[2026]	−20.9 pp ▼	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#14	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	11.7K	**15.8K**[2024]	+35% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#51	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	3.9%	**5.3%**[2024]	+1.4 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#48	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	0.0%	**8.7%**[2024]	+8.7 pp ▲	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#43	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	0.0%	**4.3%**[2024]	+4.3 pp ▲	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#43	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	0.0%	**3.0%**[2024]	+3.0 pp ▲	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#44	[12]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

WYOMING – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
Foreign-born share of residents	3.8%	**3.6%**^{2025}	−0.2 pp ▼	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#48	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	3.3%	**4.0%**^{2025}	+0.6 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#51	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	13.3K	**14K**^{2025}	+5.4% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#51	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	0.79	**0.75**^{2025}	0.0	1.00	0.0	#42	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$66.7K	**$92.5K**^{2025}	+39% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#45	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$72.5K^{2019}	**$115K**^{2025}	+59% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#39	[10]
Software developer jobs	250	**1.51K**^{2025}	6.04× ▲	1.69M	+48% ▲	#49	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal, nominal dollars	$45.9K	**$61.6K**^{2025}	+34% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#36	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	56	**162**^{2025}	2.88× ▲	135K	−0.6% ▼	#43	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.0%	**0.1%**^{2025}	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#43	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	16%	**22%**^{2025}	+5.5 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#28	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	32%	**22%**^{2025}	−10.5 pp ▼	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#18	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	0.0%	**0.0%**^{2025}	0.0 pp	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#44	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	8.1%	**9.5%**^{2025}	+1.4 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#40	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

Sources

[1] Institute of International Education. *Open Doors Report on International Educational Exchange: State Fact Sheets*. Editions 2020–2026. New York: Institute of International Education. https://opendoorsdata.org/. Accessed November 2026.

[2] NAFSA: Association of International Educators. *NAFSA International Student Economic Value Tool*. Academic years 2018–19 to 2024–25. Washington, DC: NAFSA. https://www.nafsa.org/isev. Accessed November 2026.

[3] National Center for Education Statistics. *Digest of Education Statistics*. Editions 1995–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://nces.ed.gov/programs/digest/. Accessed November 2026.

[4] National Center for Education Statistics. *Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS)*. Survey files, 1980–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://nces.ed.gov/ipeds/. Accessed November 2026.

[5] National Center for Education Statistics. *National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP)*. NAEP Data Service, 1990–2024. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://www.nationsreportcard.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[6] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Higher Education Research and Development Survey*. Data tables, FY2003–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/higher-education-research-development. Accessed November 2026.

[7] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Earned Doctorates*. Data tables, 1994–2025. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/earned-doctorates. Accessed November 2026.

[8] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Federal Funds for Research and Development*. Data tables, FY1985–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/federal-funds-research-development. Accessed November 2026.

[9] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates in Science and Engineering*. Data tables, 1994–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/graduate-students-postdoctorates-s-e. Accessed November 2026.

[10] U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. *Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics*. State estimates, 1999–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Labor. https://www.bls.gov/oes/. Accessed November 2026.

[11] U.S. Census Bureau, Center for Economic Studies. *Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes (PSEO)*. Release R2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Commerce. https://lehd.ces.census.gov/data/pseo_experimental.html. Accessed November 2026.

[12] U.S. Census Bureau. *American Community Survey*. 1-year estimates and Public Use Microdata Sample, 2010–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Commerce. https://data.census.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[13] U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services. *H-1B Employer Data Hub*. Fiscal years 2009–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://www.uscis.gov/tools/reports-and-studies/h-1b-employer-data-hub. Accessed November 2026.

[14] U.S. Department of Education, Office for Civil Rights. *Civil Rights Data Collection*. School years 1980–81 to 2023–24. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education. https://civilrightsdata.ed.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[15] U.S. Department of Education. *College Scorecard*. Institution and field-of-study data, 1996–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education. https://collegescorecard.ed.gov/data/. Accessed November 2026.

[16] U.S. Department of Homeland Security, Office of Homeland Security Statistics. *Yearbook of Immigration Statistics*. Fiscal years 1996–2024. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://ohss.dhs.gov/topics/immigration/yearbook. Accessed November 2026.

[17] U.S. Department of Labor, Employment and Training Administration, Office of Foreign Labor Certification. *LCA and PERM Disclosure Data*. Fiscal years 2008–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Labor. https://www.dol.gov/agencies/eta/foreign-labor/performance. Accessed November 2026.

[18] U.S. Department of State, Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs. *BridgeUSA: Exchange Visitor Program Participants by State*. 2015–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of State. https://j1visa.state.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[19] U.S. Department of the Treasury, Bureau of the Fiscal Service. *USAspending.gov*. Award data, FY2008–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of the Treasury. https://www.usaspending.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[20] U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement, Student and Exchange Visitor Program. *SEVIS by the Numbers: Data Mapping Tool*. Monthly data, 2014–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://studyinthestates.dhs.gov/sevis-data-mapping-tool. Accessed November 2026.

[21] U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement. *Student and Exchange Visitor Information System (SEVIS) Data*. Freedom of Information Act releases, 2008–2016. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://www.ice.gov/foia/library. Accessed November 2026.

[22] U.S. Patent and Trademark Office. *PatentsView*. Annualized patent data, grant years 1976–2025. Alexandria, VA: U.S. Patent and Trademark Office. https://patentsview.org/. Accessed November 2026.